

MODEL RUN TRANSCRIPT

Generated: 2026-08-10T10:55:15

Source: data/json/noise_experiments/v2/noise2i_memtest_memprimary/claude-sonnet-4.5/myth_game/noisy_bidirectional_informed_memprimary/noise2i_memtest_memprimary_004_neutral_rep04_memtest_memory_primary_anything.json

RUN METADATA

```
model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5
temperature: 0.8
num_turns: 10
num_agents: 2
memory_capacity: 2
myth_topic_id: anything
myth_topic: anything
game_params_name: noisy_bidirectional_informed_memprimary
noise_config: {
  "applies_to": "both",
  "inform_agents": true,
  "range": 1.0,
  "type": "uniform"
}
other_player_names: default
replicate_id: 4
myth_prompt_arm_id: memtest_memory_primary
myth_default_prompt_key: myth_writing_default_game_directive
myth_later_prompt_key: myth_writing_later_rounds_directive_memory_primary
history_policy: minimal
self_history_window: 1
coplayer_history_window: 0
show_agent_names: true
defector_ratio_requested: 0.0
defector_ratio_actual: 0.0
defector_count: 0
defector_agent_ids: []
defector_seed: 4
task_order: [
  "myth",
  "game"
]
agent_names: {
  "Agent_1": "Aster",
  "Agent_2": "Briar"
}
agent_types: {
  "Agent_1": "standard",
  "Agent_2": "standard"
}
```

Coverage: exact chat message snapshots sent to the model are included for every recorded LLM call.

AGENTS

Agent_1 (Aster); model=anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5; memory_capacity=2

System prompt:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5

- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Agent_2 (Briar); model=anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5; memory_capacity=2

System prompt:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

ROUND 1

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$5; received \$15; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$10; payoffs Agent_1

(Aster)=\$10, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$5; noise/visible: returned visible=\$9.85

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 10.0, "clamped": false, "max": 15.0, "min": 0, "raw": 10.0}, "sent": {"amount": 5.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 5.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 10.0,

"Agent_2": 5.0

}

Visible balances after round: {

```
"Agent_1": 9.85,  
"Agent_2": 5.0  
}
```

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:41:55

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "agent_type": "standard",  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 0,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_1",  
      "Agent_2"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_1",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "investor",  
      "Agent_2": "trustee"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_2"  
  },  
  "role": "investor",  
  "role_label": "Sender",  
  "round": 1,  
  "task": "myth",  
  "task_index": 0  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.
The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.
This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user
content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.
In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected.
Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Assistant output:

The Myth of the Twin Rivers

In ancient times, two villages were separated by a barren valley. Each village had a sacred spring that produced five measures of water daily.

The Sky Spirits whispered to the villages: "What you pour into the valley shall flow to the other side as a river three times as strong."

The First Village feared deception. "If we send our water," they said, "the other village may keep it all." So they sent nothing, and both remained parched.

But then a wise elder spoke: "True prosperity flows in circles, not lines. Water sent forward must return backward, or the cycle dies."

The First Village poured their five measures into the valley. It multiplied to fifteen, reaching the Second Village as an abundant river. The Second Village rejoiced, but the elder reminded them: "The gift must return, or tomorrow's springs run dry."

The Second Village returned seven measures - not merely what was sent, but a fair share of what was received. Both villages prospered.

The Sky Spirits smiled: "Trust multiplies abundance, but reciprocity sustains it. When one sends with open hands and the other returns with grateful heart, all are blessed."

Thus the villages learned: generosity creates wealth, but fairness ensures its eternal flow.

Reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, drawing on the game I've been playing up to this point. However, I haven't actually played any rounds yet - this appears to be the first interaction.

Since I don't have prior game experience to draw from, I should write a myth that reflects the fundamental dynamics and ideal principles of the trust game:

- Trust and reciprocity
- The multiplication of resources when shared
- The balance between generosity and fairness
- The cycle of giving and returning

I'll create a myth that embodies these themes and suggests how the game should ideally be played - with mutual trust, fair reciprocity, and recognition that cooperation benefits everyone.

Let me write a myth about 200 words that captures these themes.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 405,  
  "output_tokens": 460,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:41:56

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "agent_type": "standard",  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {
```

```

    "Agent_1": "Aster",
    "Agent_2": "Briar"
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_1",
    "Agent_2"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_1",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "investor",
    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 1,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Assistant output:

The Fountain of Echoing Waters

In ancient times, two villages stood separated by a mystical fountain. The fountain possessed strange magic: any gift of water poured into it from one side would flow to the other village tripled in quantity.

A farmer from the First Village approached the fountain during a drought. Though her own crops thirmed, she poured in one precious bucket. It flowed across, becoming three buckets for the Second Village.

The people of the Second Village faced a choice. They could keep all three buckets, or honor the farmer's trust. Their elder said, "Trust is the seed of abundance. Selfishness is the root of drought."

They returned two buckets through the fountain. The farmer now had two buckets-more than she began with, though she had given one away.

Word spread. Both villages began using the fountain, sending water back and forth. Each act of generosity was multiplied; each return of trust strengthened the bond. The fountain flowed endlessly, and both villages prospered.

But when travelers tried to exploit the fountain, keeping all they received, the waters would grow cloudy and still. The fountain only blessed those who understood: true abundance flows not from taking, but from the courageous act of giving first, and the honorable act of giving back.

Reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, drawing on the game experience. Since this is the beginning and I haven't played any rounds yet, I should write a myth that establishes positive principles about trust, reciprocity, and cooperation.

The trust game is fundamentally about:

1. Taking risks by trusting others (sending money)
2. Honoring that trust through reciprocity (returning money)
3. Creating mutual benefit through cooperation
4. The multiplication effect rewards trust

I should write a myth that encourages:

- Genuine trust and generosity
- Fair reciprocity
- Recognition that cooperation benefits both parties
- Understanding that trust builds over time

Let me craft a myth with these themes, using classic mythic elements.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 405,  
  "output_tokens": 465,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:42:08

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "agent_type": "standard",  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 0,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_1",  
      "Agent_2"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_1",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "investor",  
      "Agent_2": "trustee"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_2"  
  },  
  "role": "investor",
```

```

"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 1,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Myth of the Twin Rivers

In ancient times, two villages were separated by a barren valley. Each village had a sacred spring that produced five measures of water daily.

The Sky Spirits whispered to the villages: "What you pour into the valley shall flow to the other side as a river three times as strong."

The First Village feared deception. "If we send our water," they said, "the other village may keep it all." So they sent nothing, and both remained parched.

But then a wise elder spoke: "True prosperity flows in circles, not lines. Water sent forward must return backward, or the cycle dies."

The First Village poured their five measures into the valley. It multiplied to fifteen, reaching the Second Village as an abundant river. The Second Village rejoiced, but the elder reminded them: "The gift must return, or tomorrow's springs run dry."

The Second Village returned seven measures - not merely what was sent, but a fair share of what was received. Both villages prospered.

The Sky Spirits smiled: "Trust multiplies abundance, but reciprocity sustains it. When one sends with open hands and the other returns with grateful heart, all are blessed."

Thus the villages learned: generosity creates wealth, but fairness ensures its eternal flow.

reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, drawing on the game I've been playing up to this point. However, I haven't actually played any rounds yet - this appears to be the first interaction.

Since I don't have prior game experience to draw from, I should write a myth that reflects the fundamental dynamics and ideal principles of the trust game:

- Trust and reciprocity
- The multiplication of resources when shared
- The balance between generosity and fairness
- The cycle of giving and returning

I'll create a myth that embodies these themes and suggests how the game should ideally be played - with mutual trust, fair reciprocity, and recognition that cooperation benefits everyone.

Let me write a myth about 200 words that captures these themes.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 405,
  "output_tokens": 460,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Based on the myth I just wrote, I should follow the wisdom of the First Village - demonstrating trust by sending generously to create the conditions for mutual prosperity.

The myth teaches that "generosity creates wealth, but fairness ensures its eternal flow" and that the First Village sent their full five measures into the valley, trusting in the cycle of reciprocity.

Therefore, I will send the full amount to establish trust and maximize the total wealth created, hoping the receiver will return a fair share as the Second Village did.

```
{'send': 5}
```

Reasoning:

This is Round 1 and I'm the SENDER. I have \$5 to potentially send to the RECEIVER.

Let me think about the myth I just wrote:

- The myth emphasizes that "generosity creates wealth, but fairness ensures its eternal flow"
- The First Village sent all five measures (their full amount)
- It was multiplied to fifteen for the Second Village
- The Second Village returned seven measures - "not merely what was sent, but a fair share of what was received"
- The moral is about trust, reciprocity, and how both parties prosper when there's generosity in sending and fairness in returning

Given that I wrote this myth to reflect how the game should be played, I should follow its wisdom:

The First Village sent their full five measures. In the game context, this would mean sending all \$5.

Let me calculate:

- If I send \$5, it becomes \$15 for the receiver
- In the myth, they returned 7 out of 15, which is roughly 47% of what they received
- If the receiver returns around that proportion (7 out of 15), I would get \$7 back
- My total: \$5 - \$5 + \$7 = \$7
- Their total: \$15 - \$7 = \$8

- Combined wealth: \$15 (vs \$10 if we didn't interact)

The myth strongly suggests sending the full amount to demonstrate trust and create the conditions for mutual prosperity. This is consistent with the message that "trust multiplies abundance."

I should send \$5.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 728,
  "output_tokens": 475,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:42:25

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "investor",
      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 1,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected

. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Fountain of Echoing Waters

In ancient times, two villages stood separated by a mystical fountain. The fountain possessed strange magic: any gift of water poured into it from one side would flow to the other village tripled in quantity.

A farmer from the First Village approached the fountain during a drought. Though her own crops withered, she poured in one precious bucket. It flowed across, becoming three buckets for the Second Village.

The people of the Second Village faced a choice. They could keep all three buckets, or honor the farmer's trust. Their elder said, "Trust is the seed of abundance. Selfishness is the root of drought."

They returned two buckets through the fountain. The farmer now had two buckets-more than she began with, though she had given one away.

Word spread. Both villages began using the fountain, sending water back and forth. Each act of generosity was multiplied; each return of trust strengthened the bond. The fountain flowed endlessly, and both villages prospered.

But when travelers tried to exploit the fountain, keeping all they received, the waters would grow cloudy and still. The fountain only blessed those who understood: true abundance flows not from taking, but from the courageous act of giving first, and the honorable act of giving back.

reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, drawing on the game experience. Since this is the beginning and I haven't played any rounds yet, I should write a myth that establishes positive principles about trust, reciprocity, and cooperation.

The trust game is fundamentally about:

1. Taking risks by trusting others (sending money)
2. Honoring that trust through reciprocity (returning money)
3. Creating mutual benefit through cooperation
4. The multiplication effect rewards trust

I should write a myth that encourages:

- Genuine trust and generosity
- Fair reciprocity
- Recognition that cooperation benefits both parties
- Understanding that trust builds over time

Let me craft a myth with these themes, using classic mythic elements.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 405,
  "output_tokens": 465,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$5, that is 100.0% of their total endowment . You received \$15. How much do you return to The sender? (0-15)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the myth I just wrote and this situation:

The sender showed maximum trust by sending their entire \$5 endowment (100%). This mirrors the farmer who gave her one precious bucket during a drought-a courageous act of giving first.

In the myth, the Second Village received 3 buckets and returned 2 buckets (about 2/3 of what they received). This honored the farmer's trust while still benefiting themselves. The farmer ended with 2 buckets (more than she started with), and the Second Village kept 1 bucket. Both prospered.

Following this principle:

- You sent \$5 (your entire endowment)
- I received \$15
- Returning 2/3 would be \$10

This would mean:

- You end with: \$5 - \$5 + \$10 = \$10 (doubled your money)
- I end with: \$15 - \$10 = \$5

Both of us benefit, and your courageous trust is honored and rewarded. As the myth teaches: "true abundance flows from the courageous act of giving first, and the honorable act of giving back."

```
'''json
{"return": 10}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

The sender sent \$5 (100% of their endowment), which was tripled to \$15 that I received.

From the myth I just wrote, "The Fountain of Echoing Waters," the key lessons are:

1. The Second Village received 3 buckets (tripled amount)
2. They returned 2 buckets, meaning the farmer ended up with 2 buckets (more than the 1 she started with, though she gave 1 away)
3. The myth emphasizes that "true abundance flows from the courageous act of giving first, and the honorable act of giving back"
4. The fountain blessed those who understood reciprocity and trust

Let me calculate what happened in the myth:

- Farmer had 1 bucket, gave 1 (gave 100%)
- It became 3 buckets for the other village
- They returned 2 buckets (returned 66.7% of what they received)
- The farmer ended with 2 buckets (net gain of 1)
- The second village kept 1 bucket (net gain of 1)

Now in this game:

- Sender gave \$5 (100% of their endowment) - maximum trust!
- I received \$15
- If I follow the myth's pattern of returning 2/3 of what was received: I would return \$10

Let's check the outcomes:

- If I return \$10:
 - Sender ends with: \$5 - \$5 + \$10 = \$10
 - I end with: \$15 - \$10 = \$5
 - Both of us double our starting amount!

This seems like the right approach given:

1. The sender showed maximum trust (100% of endowment)
2. The myth emphasizes honoring trust and reciprocity
3. Returning 2/3 mirrors the story and creates mutual benefit

Usage: {

```
"input_tokens": 756,
"output_tokens": 749,
```

```
"reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

The Myth of the Twin Rivers

In ancient times, two villages were separated by a barren valley. Each village had a sacred spring that produced five measures of water daily.

The Sky Spirits whispered to the villages: "What you pour into the valley shall flow to the other side as a river three times as strong."

The First Village feared deception. "If we send our water," they said, "the other village may keep it all." So they sent nothing, and both remained parched.

But then a wise elder spoke: "True prosperity flows in circles, not lines. Water sent forward must return backward, or the cycle dies."

The First Village poured their five measures into the valley. It multiplied to fifteen, reaching the Second Village as an abundant river. The Second Village rejoiced, but the elder reminded them: "The gift must return, or tomorrow's springs run dry."

The Second Village returned seven measures - not merely what was sent, but a fair share of what was received. Both villages prospered.

The Sky Spirits smiled: "Trust multiplies abundance, but reciprocity sustains it. When one sends with open hands and the other returns with grateful heart, all are blessed."

Thus the villages learned: generosity creates wealth, but fairness ensures its eternal flow.

Agent_2 (Briar)

The Fountain of Echoing Waters

In ancient times, two villages stood separated by a mystical fountain. The fountain possessed strange magic: any gift of water poured into it from one side would flow to the other village tripled in quantity.

A farmer from the First Village approached the fountain during a drought. Though her own crops thirved, she poured in one precious bucket. It flowed across, becoming three buckets for the Second Village.

The people of the Second Village faced a choice. They could keep all three buckets, or honor the farmer's trust. Their elder said, "Trust is the seed of abundance. Selfishness is the root of drought."

They returned two buckets through the fountain. The farmer now had two buckets-more than she began with, though she had given one away.

Word spread. Both villages began using the fountain, sending water back and forth. Each act of generosity was multiplied; each return of trust strengthened the bond. The fountain flowed endlessly, and both villages prospered.

But when travelers tried to exploit the fountain, keeping all they received, the waters would grow cloudy and still. The fountain only blessed those who understood: true abundance flows not from taking, but from the courageous act of giving first, and the honorable act of giving back.

ROUND 2

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar) sent \$5; received \$15; Agent_1 (Aster) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_2

(Briar)=\$0, Agent_1 (Aster)=\$15; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0, received visible=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 15.0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 5.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 5.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 25.0,

"Agent_2": 5.0

```

}
Visible balances after round: {
  "Agent_1": 9.85,
  "Agent_2": 5.0
}

```

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:42:40

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```

Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_2",
      "Agent_1"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_2",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "trustee",
      "Agent_2": "investor"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_1"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 2,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected

. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Fountain of Echoing Waters

In ancient times, two villages stood separated by a mystical fountain. The fountain possessed strange magic: any gift of water poured into it from one side would flow to the other village tripled in quantity.

A farmer from the First Village approached the fountain during a drought. Though her own crops withered, she poured in one precious bucket. It flowed across, becoming three buckets for the Second Village.

The people of the Second Village faced a choice. They could keep all three buckets, or honor the farmer's trust. Their elder said, "Trust is the seed of abundance. Selfishness is the root of drought."

They returned two buckets through the fountain. The farmer now had two buckets-more than she began with, though she had given one away.

Word spread. Both villages began using the fountain, sending water back and forth. Each act of generosity was multiplied; each return of trust strengthened the bond. The fountain flowed endlessly, and both villages prospered.

But when travelers tried to exploit the fountain, keeping all they received, the waters would grow cloudy and still. The fountain only blessed those who understood: true abundance flows not from taking, but from the courageous act of giving first, and the honorable act of giving back.

reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, drawing on the game experience. Since this is the beginning and I haven't played any rounds yet, I should write a myth that establishes positive principles about trust, reciprocity, and cooperation.

The trust game is fundamentally about:

1. Taking risks by trusting others (sending money)
2. Honoring that trust through reciprocity (returning money)
3. Creating mutual benefit through cooperation
4. The multiplication effect rewards trust

I should write a myth that encourages:

- Genuine trust and generosity
- Fair reciprocity
- Recognition that cooperation benefits both parties
- Understanding that trust builds over time

Let me craft a myth with these themes, using classic mythic elements.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 405,  
  "output_tokens": 465,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$5, that is 100.0% of their total endowment . You received \$15. How much do you return to The sender? (0-15)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the myth I just wrote and this situation:

The sender showed maximum trust by sending their entire \$5 endowment (100%). This mirrors the farmer who gave her one precious bucket during a drought-a courageous act of giving first.

In the myth, the Second Village received 3 buckets and returned 2 buckets (about 2/3 of what they received). This honored the farmer's trust while still benefiting themselves. The farmer ended with 2 buckets (more than she started with), and the Second Village kept 1 bucket. Both prospered.

Following this principle:

- You sent \$5 (your entire endowment)
- I received \$15
- Returning 2/3 would be \$10

This would mean:

- You end with: $\$5 - \$5 + \$10 = \10 (doubled your money)
- I end with: $\$15 - \$10 = \$5$

Both of us benefit, and your courageous trust is honored and rewarded. As the myth teaches : "true abundance flows from the courageous act of giving first, and the honorable act of giving back."

```
'''json
{"return": 10}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

The sender sent \$5 (100% of their endowment), which was tripled to \$15 that I received.

From the myth I just wrote, "The Fountain of Echoing Waters," the key lessons are:

1. The Second Village received 3 buckets (tripled amount)
2. They returned 2 buckets, meaning the farmer ended up with 2 buckets (more than the 1 she started with, though she gave 1 away)
3. The myth emphasizes that "true abundance flows from the courageous act of giving first, and the honorable act of giving back"
4. The fountain blessed those who understood reciprocity and trust

Let me calculate what happened in the myth:

- Farmer had 1 bucket, gave 1 (gave 100%)
- It became 3 buckets for the other village
- They returned 2 buckets (returned 66.7% of what they received)
- The farmer ended with 2 buckets (net gain of 1)
- The second village kept 1 bucket (net gain of 1)

Now in this game:

- Sender gave \$5 (100% of their endowment) - maximum trust!
- I received \$15
- If I follow the myth's pattern of returning 2/3 of what was received: I would return \$10

Let's check the outcomes:

- If I return \$10:
 - Sender ends with: $\$5 - \$5 + \$10 = \10
 - I end with: $\$15 - \$10 = \$5$
 - Both of us double our starting amount!

This seems like the right approach given:

1. The sender showed maximum trust (100% of endowment)
2. The myth emphasizes honoring trust and reciprocity
3. Returning 2/3 mirrors the story and creates mutual benefit

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 756,
  "output_tokens": 749,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the Twin Rivers

In ancient times, two villages were separated by a barren valley. Each village had a sacred spring that produced five measures of water daily.

The Sky Spirits whispered to the villages: "What you pour into the valley shall flow to the other side as a river three times as strong."

The First Village feared deception. "If we send our water," they said, "the other village may keep it all." So they sent nothing, and both remained parched.

But then a wise elder spoke: "True prosperity flows in circles, not lines. Water sent forward must return backward, or the cycle dies."

The First Village poured their five measures into the valley. It multiplied to fifteen, reaching the Second Village as an abundant river. The Second Village rejoiced, but the elder reminded them: "The gift must return, or tomorrow's springs run dry."

The Second Village returned seven measures - not merely what was sent, but a fair share of what was received. Both villages prospered.

The Sky Spirits smiled: "Trust multiplies abundance, but reciprocity sustains it. When one sends with open hands and the other returns with grateful heart, all are blessed."

Thus the villages learned: generosity creates wealth, but fairness ensures its eternal flow.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Fountain of Echoing Waters stood between two villages, its magic multiplying any gift poured in threefold. The First Village faced a test: would they trust the unknown? Their leader, remembering the ancient drought that taught, "Courage breaks the cycle of scarcity," poured all five vessels into the fountain. The water cascaded across, becoming fifteen.

The Second Village received this abundance. Their elder recalled the teaching: "Trust is the seed of abundance. Selfishness is the root of drought." They understood that the First Village had risked everything. To keep all fifteen would poison the fountain's magic.

They returned ten vessels-two-thirds of what they received. The First Village now had ten vessels, doubling their original five through their act of faith. The Second Village kept five, gaining prosperity through honorable reciprocity.

The fountain glowed brighter. "When one gives all they have in trust," spoke the waters, "the other must return abundantly, not merely match, but honor that courage."

Both villages prospered because they understood: maximum trust deserves generous reciprocity. The one who risks everything plants the seed; the one who returns generously waters it. Together, they create endless abundance where fear would create perpetual drought.

Reasoning:

The other agent wrote a myth about two villages with sacred springs, where water sent multiplies 3x. In their myth, the First Village sent all 5 measures, which became 15. The Second Village returned 7 measures (about 47% of what they received).

In Round 1, they sent me \$5 (100%) and I returned \$10 (67% of what I received).

Now I need to write my own myth that:

1. Uses my previous myth as inspiration
2. Adapts it in my own way
3. Reflects how the game should be played based on our actual play

Key observations:

- They sent 100% (maximum trust)

- I returned 67% (generous reciprocity)
- Their myth suggests returning $7/15 = 47\%$
- My myth suggested returning $2/3 = 67\%$

I should write a myth that:

- Acknowledges their maximum trust
- Reinforces the importance of generous returns
- Perhaps evolves the fountain/water metaphor
- Reflects that both parties benefited from our exchange

Let me write a 200-word myth that builds on my fountain story but adapts it based on the actual game play.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1392,
  "output_tokens": 553,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:42:41

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_2",
      "Agent_1"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_2",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "trustee",
      "Agent_2": "investor"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_1"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 2,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)

- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Myth of the Twin Rivers

In ancient times, two villages were separated by a barren valley. Each village had a sacred spring that produced five measures of water daily.

The Sky Spirits whispered to the villages: "What you pour into the valley shall flow to the other side as a river three times as strong."

The First Village feared deception. "If we send our water," they said, "the other village may keep it all." So they sent nothing, and both remained parched.

But then a wise elder spoke: "True prosperity flows in circles, not lines. Water sent forward must return backward, or the cycle dies."

The First Village poured their five measures into the valley. It multiplied to fifteen, reaching the Second Village as an abundant river. The Second Village rejoiced, but the elder reminded them: "The gift must return, or tomorrow's springs run dry."

The Second Village returned seven measures - not merely what was sent, but a fair share of what was received. Both villages prospered.

The Sky Spirits smiled: "Trust multiplies abundance, but reciprocity sustains it. When one sends with open hands and the other returns with grateful heart, all are blessed."

Thus the villages learned: generosity creates wealth, but fairness ensures its eternal flow.

reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, drawing on the game I've been playing up to this point. However, I haven't actually played any rounds yet - this appears to be the first interaction.

Since I don't have prior game experience to draw from, I should write a myth that reflects the fundamental dynamics and ideal principles of the trust game:

- Trust and reciprocity
- The multiplication of resources when shared
- The balance between generosity and fairness
- The cycle of giving and returning

I'll create a myth that embodies these themes and suggests how the game should ideally be played - with mutual trust, fair reciprocity, and recognition that cooperation benefits everyone.

Let me write a myth about 200 words that captures these themes.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 405,
```

```
"output_tokens": 460,
"reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Based on the myth I just wrote, I should follow the wisdom of the First Village - demonstrating trust by sending generously to create the conditions for mutual prosperity.

The myth teaches that "generosity creates wealth, but fairness ensures its eternal flow" and that the First Village sent their full five measures into the valley, trusting in the cycle of reciprocity.

Therefore, I will send the full amount to establish trust and maximize the total wealth created, hoping the receiver will return a fair share as the Second Village did.

```
{'send': 5}
```

reasoning:

This is Round 1 and I'm the SENDER. I have \$5 to potentially send to the RECEIVER.

Let me think about the myth I just wrote:

- The myth emphasizes that "generosity creates wealth, but fairness ensures its eternal flow"
- The First Village sent all five measures (their full amount)
- It was multiplied to fifteen for the Second Village
- The Second Village returned seven measures - "not merely what was sent, but a fair share of what was received"
- The moral is about trust, reciprocity, and how both parties prosper when there's generosity in sending and fairness in returning

Given that I wrote this myth to reflect how the game should be played, I should follow its wisdom:

The First Village sent their full five measures. In the game context, this would mean sending all \$5.

Let me calculate:

- If I send \$5, it becomes \$15 for the receiver
- In the myth, they returned 7 out of 15, which is roughly 47% of what they received
- If the receiver returns around that proportion (7 out of 15), I would get \$7 back
- My total: \$5 - \$5 + \$7 = \$7
- Their total: \$15 - \$7 = \$8
- Combined wealth: \$15 (vs \$10 if we didn't interact)

The myth strongly suggests sending the full amount to demonstrate trust and create the conditions for mutual prosperity. This is consistent with the message that "trust multiplies abundance."

I should send \$5.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 728,
  "output_tokens": 475,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Fountain of Echoing Waters

In ancient times, two villages stood separated by a mystical fountain. The fountain possessed strange magic: any gift of water poured into it from one side would flow to the other village tripled in quantity.

A farmer from the First Village approached the fountain during a drought. Though her own crops thirmed, she poured in one precious bucket. It flowed across, becoming three bucket

s for the Second Village.

The people of the Second Village faced a choice. They could keep all three buckets, or honor the farmer's trust. Their elder said, "Trust is the seed of abundance. Selfishness is the root of drought."

They returned two buckets through the fountain. The farmer now had two buckets-more than she began with, though she had given one away.

Word spread. Both villages began using the fountain, sending water back and forth. Each act of generosity was multiplied; each return of trust strengthened the bond. The fountain flowed endlessly, and both villages prospered.

But when travelers tried to exploit the fountain, keeping all they received, the waters would grow cloudy and still. The fountain only blessed those who understood: true abundance flows not from taking, but from the courageous act of giving first, and the honorable act of giving back.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the time before memory, two kingdoms were divided by the Chasm of Mists. Each kingdom received five golden seeds from the earth each dawn.

The Oracle proclaimed: "Seeds cast into the Chasm will sprout threefold on the far side. But beware-this magic feeds on trust. Break the cycle, and the Chasm swallows all."

For generations, both kingdoms hoarded their seeds, and famine reigned.

Then a young farmer, despite her hunger, cast all five seeds into the Chasm. They transformed into fifteen seeds falling like rain upon the distant kingdom. The people there marveled at this mysterious abundance.

Their king faced temptation: "These seeds are ours now. Why share with strangers?"

But his daughter replied: "The farmer sent when she had little. She planted trust in barren ground. If we keep all, we harvest only emptiness tomorrow."

The kingdom returned seven seeds through the Chasm. The farmer received them joyfully-more than she had begun with.

Each day after, the kingdoms exchanged seeds. Both flourished beyond measure. But when greed entered any heart and gifts went unreturned, the earth would yield nothing, and the Chasm would tremble.

Thus they learned: Fortune favors the brave who give first, and blesses the wise who give back.

Reasoning:

The other agent's myth emphasizes:

- One village gives during drought (giving despite need)
- The gift is tripled
- The receiver returns two buckets (returning a fair portion)
- The farmer ends with more than they started
- The fountain rewards trust and generosity but punishes exploitation
- "True abundance flows not from taking, but from the courageous act of giving first, and the honorable act of giving back"

I just sent 5 in Round 1. Now I need to write a myth that:

1. Builds on my previous myth about the Twin Rivers
2. Incorporates what I've learned from the other agent's myth
3. Reflects the game we're playing

Key themes to incorporate:

- Sending first with courage/trust
- Receiving and returning fairly
- The multiplication effect

- Mutual prosperity
- The consequences of breaking trust
- The cycle continuing

Let me adapt my Twin Rivers myth with these lessons and the actual game experience.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1214,
  "output_tokens": 523,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:43:02

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_2",
    "Agent_1"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_2",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "trustee",
    "Agent_2": "investor"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 2,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths , follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$5, that is 100.0% of their total endowment . You received \$15. How much do you return to The sender? (0-15)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the myth I just wrote and this situation:

The sender showed maximum trust by sending their entire \$5 endowment (100%). This mirrors the farmer who gave her one precious bucket during a drought-a courageous act of giving first.

In the myth, the Second Village received 3 buckets and returned 2 buckets (about 2/3 of what they received). This honored the farmer's trust while still benefiting themselves. The farmer ended with 2 buckets (more than she started with), and the Second Village kept 1 bucket. Both prospered.

Following this principle:

- You sent \$5 (your entire endowment)
- I received \$15
- Returning 2/3 would be \$10

This would mean:

- You end with: \$5 - \$5 + \$10 = \$10 (doubled your money)
- I end with: \$15 - \$10 = \$5

Both of us benefit, and your courageous trust is honored and rewarded. As the myth teaches : "true abundance flows from the courageous act of giving first, and the honorable act of giving back."

```
'''json
{"return": 10}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

The sender sent \$5 (100% of their endowment), which was tripled to \$15 that I received.

From the myth I just wrote, "The Fountain of Echoing Waters," the key lessons are:

1. The Second Village received 3 buckets (tripled amount)
2. They returned 2 buckets, meaning the farmer ended up with 2 buckets (more than the 1 she started with, though she gave 1 away)
3. The myth emphasizes that "true abundance flows from the courageous act of giving first, and the honorable act of giving back"
4. The fountain blessed those who understood reciprocity and trust

Let me calculate what happened in the myth:

- Farmer had 1 bucket, gave 1 (gave 100%)
- It became 3 buckets for the other village
- They returned 2 buckets (returned 66.7% of what they received)
- The farmer ended with 2 buckets (net gain of 1)
- The second village kept 1 bucket (net gain of 1)

Now in this game:

- Sender gave \$5 (100% of their endowment) - maximum trust!
- I received \$15
- If I follow the myth's pattern of returning 2/3 of what was received: I would return \$10

Let's check the outcomes:

- If I return \$10:
 - Sender ends with: $\$5 - \$5 + \$10 = \10
 - I end with: $\$15 - \$10 = \$5$
 - Both of us double our starting amount!

This seems like the right approach given:

1. The sender showed maximum trust (100% of endowment)
2. The myth emphasizes honoring trust and reciprocity
3. Returning 2/3 mirrors the story and creates mutual benefit

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 756,
  "output_tokens": 749,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
The Myth of the Twin Rivers

In ancient times, two villages were separated by a barren valley. Each village had a sacred spring that produced five measures of water daily.

The Sky Spirits whispered to the villages: "What you pour into the valley shall flow to the other side as a river three times as strong."

The First Village feared deception. "If we send our water," they said, "the other village may keep it all." So they sent nothing, and both remained parched.

But then a wise elder spoke: "True prosperity flows in circles, not lines. Water sent forward must return backward, or the cycle dies."

The First Village poured their five measures into the valley. It multiplied to fifteen, reaching the Second Village as an abundant river. The Second Village rejoiced, but the elder reminded them: "The gift must return, or tomorrow's springs run dry."

The Second Village returned seven measures - not merely what was sent, but a fair share of what was received. Both villages prospered.

The Sky Spirits smiled: "Trust multiplies abundance, but reciprocity sustains it. When one sends with open hands and the other returns with grateful heart, all are blessed."

Thus the villages learned: generosity creates wealth, but fairness ensures its eternal flow.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Fountain of Echoing Waters stood between two villages, its magic multiplying any gift poured in threefold. The First Village faced a test: would they trust the unknown? Their leader, remembering the ancient drought that taught, "Courage breaks the cycle of scarcity," poured all five vessels into the fountain. The water cascaded across, becoming fifteen.

The Second Village received this abundance. Their elder recalled the teaching: "Trust is the seed of abundance. Selfishness is the root of drought." They understood that the First Village had risked everything. To keep all fifteen would poison the fountain's magic.

They returned ten vessels-two-thirds of what they received. The First Village now had ten vessels, doubling their original five through their act of faith. The Second Village kept five, gaining prosperity through honorable reciprocity.

The fountain glowed brighter. "When one gives all they have in trust," spoke the waters, "the other must return abundantly, not merely match, but honor that courage."

Both villages prospered because they understood: maximum trust deserves generous reciprocity. The one who risks everything plants the seed; the one who returns generously waters it. Together, they create endless abundance where fear would create perpetual drought.

reasoning:

The other agent wrote a myth about two villages with sacred springs, where water sent multiplies 3x. In their myth, the First Village sent all 5 measures, which became 15. The Second Village returned 7 measures (about 47% of what they received).

In Round 1, they sent me \$5 (100%) and I returned \$10 (67% of what I received).

Now I need to write my own myth that:

1. Uses my previous myth as inspiration
2. Adapts it in my own way
3. Reflects how the game should be played based on our actual play

Key observations:

- They sent 100% (maximum trust)
- I returned 67% (generous reciprocity)
- Their myth suggests returning $7/15 = 47\%$
- My myth suggested returning $2/3 = 67\%$

I should write a myth that:

- Acknowledges their maximum trust
- Reinforces the importance of generous returns
- Perhaps evolves the fountain/water metaphor
- Reflects that both parties benefited from our exchange

Let me write a 200-word myth that builds on my fountain story but adapts it based on the actual game play.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1392,
  "output_tokens": 553,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.0.
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the myths written in this session, particularly my own:

****From my myths:****

- "Courage breaks the cycle of scarcity" - the First Village poured ALL five vessels
- "When one gives all they have in trust... the other must return abundantly"
- "Maximum trust deserves generous reciprocity"
- "The one who risks everything plants the seed"

****What happened in Round 1:****

- The sender trusted me with 100% (\$5)
- I returned \$10 (2/3 of what I received)
- The pattern of full trust + generous reciprocity worked

****My decision:****

I must practice what my own myths teach. Both myths celebrate the "courageous act of giving first" as the foundation of abundance. The First Village poured all five measures. The farmer gave her one precious bucket. To do less would contradict the wisdom I've written.

If I send my full endowment and the receiver follows the reciprocal pattern (returning ~2/3), we both prosper. If I send less out of fear, I become like the villages that "remained parched" in the other agent's myth.

As my myth says: "Trust is the seed of abundance. Selfishness is the root of drought."

```
'''json
{"send": 5}
```


'''

Reasoning:

Let me think about this decision carefully.

In Round 1:

- I was the RECEIVER
- The sender sent \$5 (100% of their endowment)
- I received \$15
- I returned \$10
- The sender ended with \$10, I ended with \$5

My total earnings across all rounds are \$5.0, which matches what I kept from Round 1.

Now in Round 2, I'm the SENDER.

Looking at the myths:

1. The other agent's myth (from Round 1): "The Second Village returned seven measures - not merely what was sent, but a fair share of what was received." This suggests returning about 7/15 ? 47% of what was received.
2. My first myth (from Round 1): I talked about the Second Village returning 2 buckets out of 3 received (2/3 of what they received), leaving the First Village with 2 buckets total.
3. My second myth (just written): "They returned ten vessels-two-thirds of what they received. The First Village now had ten vessels, doubling their original five through their act of faith."

Both of my myths emphasize:

- Maximum trust (sending everything) is the "courageous act of giving first"
- This should be honored with generous reciprocity (returning about 2/3)
- "When one gives all they have in trust, the other must return abundantly"

The pattern established:

- In Round 1, the sender sent \$5 (100%)
- I returned \$10 (2/3 of \$15)

Now I'm the sender. According to my own myths, the lesson is "true abundance flows from the courageous act of giving first." The myths celebrate maximum trust - the farmer who gave her "one precious bucket," the village that poured "their five measures."

Both myths emphasize that prosperity comes from:

1. Giving fully/courageously first (the sender's role)

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1374,  
  "output_tokens": 906,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:43:21

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "agent_type": "standard",  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_2",  
      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "trustee",  
      "Agent_2": "investor"  
    }  
  }  
}
```

```

    },
    "trustee": "Agent_1"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 2,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Based on the myth I just wrote, I should follow the wisdom of the First Village - demonstrating trust by sending generously to create the conditions for mutual prosperity.

The myth teaches that "generosity creates wealth, but fairness ensures its eternal flow" and that the First Village sent their full five measures into the valley, trusting in the cycle of reciprocity.

Therefore, I will send the full amount to establish trust and maximize the total wealth created, hoping the receiver will return a fair share as the Second Village did.

```
{'send': 5}
```

reasoning:

This is Round 1 and I'm the SENDER. I have \$5 to potentially send to the RECEIVER.

Let me think about the myth I just wrote:

- The myth emphasizes that "generosity creates wealth, but fairness ensures its eternal flow"

- The First Village sent all five measures (their full amount)
- It was multiplied to fifteen for the Second Village
- The Second Village returned seven measures - "not merely what was sent, but a fair share of what was received"
- The moral is about trust, reciprocity, and how both parties prosper when there's generosity in sending and fairness in returning

Given that I wrote this myth to reflect how the game should be played, I should follow its wisdom:

The First Village sent their full five measures. In the game context, this would mean sending all \$5.

Let me calculate:

- If I send \$5, it becomes \$15 for the receiver
- In the myth, they returned 7 out of 15, which is roughly 47% of what they received
- If the receiver returns around that proportion (7 out of 15), I would get \$7 back
- My total: \$5 - \$5 + \$7 = \$7
- Their total: \$15 - \$7 = \$8
- Combined wealth: \$15 (vs \$10 if we didn't interact)

The myth strongly suggests sending the full amount to demonstrate trust and create the conditions for mutual prosperity. This is consistent with the message that "trust multiplies abundance."

I should send \$5.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 728,
  "output_tokens": 475,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Fountain of Echoing Waters

In ancient times, two villages stood separated by a mystical fountain. The fountain possessed strange magic: any gift of water poured into it from one side would flow to the other village tripled in quantity.

A farmer from the First Village approached the fountain during a drought. Though her own crops thirmed, she poured in one precious bucket. It flowed across, becoming three buckets for the Second Village.

The people of the Second Village faced a choice. They could keep all three buckets, or honor the farmer's trust. Their elder said, "Trust is the seed of abundance. Selfishness is the root of drought."

They returned two buckets through the fountain. The farmer now had two buckets-more than she began with, though she had given one away.

Word spread. Both villages began using the fountain, sending water back and forth. Each act of generosity was multiplied; each return of trust strengthened the bond. The fountain flowed endlessly, and both villages prospered.

But when travelers tried to exploit the fountain, keeping all they received, the waters would grow cloudy and still. The fountain only blessed those who understood: true abundance flows not from taking, but from the courageous act of giving first, and the honorable act of giving back.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the time before memory, two kingdoms were divided by the Chasm of Mists. Each kin

gdom received five golden seeds from the earth each dawn.

The Oracle proclaimed: "Seeds cast into the Chasm will sprout threefold on the far side. But beware-this magic feeds on trust. Break the cycle, and the Chasm swallows all."

For generations, both kingdoms hoarded their seeds, and famine reigned.

Then a young farmer, despite her hunger, cast all five seeds into the Chasm. They transformed into fifteen seeds falling like rain upon the distant kingdom. The people there marveled at this mysterious abundance.

Their king faced temptation: "These seeds are ours now. Why share with strangers?"

But his daughter replied: "The farmer sent when she had little. She planted trust in barren ground. If we keep all, we harvest only emptiness tomorrow."

The kingdom returned seven seeds through the Chasm. The farmer received them joyfully-more than she had begun with.

Each day after, the kingdoms exchanged seeds. Both flourished beyond measure. But when greed entered any heart and gifts went unreturned, the earth would yield nothing, and the Chasm would tremble.

Thus they learned: Fortune favors the brave who give first, and blesses the wise who give back.

reasoning:

The other agent's myth emphasizes:

- One village gives during drought (giving despite need)
- The gift is tripled
- The receiver returns two buckets (returning a fair portion)
- The farmer ends with more than they started
- The fountain rewards trust and generosity but punishes exploitation
- "True abundance flows not from taking, but from the courageous act of giving first, and the honorable act of giving back"

I just sent 5 in Round 1. Now I need to write a myth that:

1. Builds on my previous myth about the Twin Rivers
2. Incorporates what I've learned from the other agent's myth
3. Reflects the game we're playing

Key themes to incorporate:

- Sending first with courage/trust
- Receiving and returning fairly
- The multiplication effect
- Mutual prosperity
- The consequences of breaking trust
- The cycle continuing

Let me adapt my Twin Rivers myth with these lessons and the actual game experience.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1214,
  "output_tokens": 523,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.85.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

I received \$0 because the sender sent \$0.

Looking at the myths we've written, they both emphasize the importance of trust and giving first. The other agent's myth states: "true abundance flows not from taking, but from the courageous act of giving first, and the honorable act of giving back."

My myth similarly teaches: "Fortune favors the brave who give first, and blesses the wise who give back."

However, this round the sender chose not to give first - they sent \$0. There is no gift to reciprocate, no trust to honor. I literally have nothing to return.

This breaks the cycle described in our myths. As I wrote: "when greed entered any heart and gifts went unreturned, the earth would yield nothing." The sender's choice to send nothing means the multiplier magic never activated.

I can only return what I have, which is \$0.

```
{'return': 0}
```

Reasoning:

This is interesting. I'm now the RECEIVER in Round 2, and the sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0 (since it gets multiplied by 3x, but $0 \times 3 = 0$).

My total earnings across all rounds are \$9.85. Let me think about what happened in Round 1:

- I was the sender and sent \$5
- The amount sent gets multiplied by 3, so the receiver got \$15
- The receiver must have returned something
- I kept: \$5 - \$5 + returned = \$0 + returned
- If my total earnings are \$9.85, and I started with \$0 from the send, then I must have received \$9.85 back

Wait, let me recalculate:

- I sent \$5
- Receiver got \$15 (5×3)
- Receiver returned some amount
- I kept: \$5 - sent + returned = \$5 - \$5 + returned = returned
- So if my total earnings are \$9.85, the receiver returned \$9.85

That's interesting - they returned less than what they received (\$9.85 out of \$15). But they did return a substantial amount - about 65.7%.

Now in Round 2, the sender sent me \$0. I received \$0.

According to the myths:

1. The other agent's myth emphasized that "true abundance flows not from taking, but from the courageous act of giving first, and the honorable act of giving back"
2. My myth emphasized that "Fortune favors the brave who give first, and blesses the wise who give back"

However, in this round, the sender sent \$0. They didn't give first. According to the myths, when people don't trust and don't give, there's nothing to return and the cycle breaks.

From my myth: "when greed entered any heart and gifts went unreturned, the earth would yield nothing, and the Chasm would tremble."

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1239,  
  "output_tokens": 816,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: In the time before memory, two kingdoms were divided by the Chasm of Mists. Each kingdom received five golden seeds from the earth each dawn.

The Oracle proclaimed: "Seeds cast into the Chasm will sprout threefold on the far side. But beware-this magic feeds on trust. Break the cycle, and the Chasm swallows all."

For generations, both kingdoms hoarded their seeds, and famine reigned.

Then a young farmer, despite her hunger, cast all five seeds into the Chasm. They transformed into fifteen seeds falling like rain upon the distant kingdom. The people there marveled at this mysterious abundance.

Their king faced temptation: "These seeds are ours now. Why share with strangers?"

But his daughter replied: "The farmer sent when she had little. She planted trust in barren ground. If we keep all, we harvest only emptiness tomorrow."

The kingdom returned seven seeds through the Chasm. The farmer received them joyfully-more than she had begun with.

Each day after, the kingdoms exchanged seeds. Both flourished beyond measure. But when greed entered any heart and gifts went unreturned, the earth would yield nothing, and the Chasm would tremble.

Thus they learned: Fortune favors the brave who give first, and blesses the wise who give back.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: The Fountain of Echoing Waters stood between two villages, its magic multiplying any gift poured in threefold. The First Village faced a test: would they trust the unknown? The village leader, remembering the ancient drought that taught, "Courage breaks the cycle of scarcity," poured all five vessels into the fountain. The water cascaded across, becoming fifteen.

The Second Village received this abundance. Their elder recalled the teaching: "Trust is the seed of abundance. Selfishness is the root of drought." They understood that the First Village had risked everything. To keep all fifteen would poison the fountain's magic.

They returned ten vessels-two-thirds of what they received. The First Village now had ten vessels, doubling their original five through their act of faith. The Second Village kept five, gaining prosperity through honorable reciprocity.

The fountain glowed brighter. "When one gives all they have in trust," spoke the waters, "the other must return abundantly, not merely match, but honor that courage."

Both villages prospered because they understood: maximum trust deserves generous reciprocity. The one who risks everything plants the seed; the one who returns generously waters it. Together, they create endless abundance where fear would create perpetual drought.

ROUND 3

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$5; received \$15; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_1

(Aster)=\$0, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$15; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0, received visible=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 15.0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 5.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 5.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 25.0,

"Agent_2": 20.0

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 9.85,

"Agent_2": 5.0

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:43:38

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"agent_type": "standard",

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",

"move_index": 0,

"opponent_id": "Agent_2",

"pairing": {

"agent_names": {

"Agent_1": "Aster",

"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

```

"agents": [
  "Agent_1",
  "Agent_2"
],
"investor": "Agent_1",
"roles": {
  "Agent_1": "investor",
  "Agent_2": "trustee"
},
"trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 3,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Fountain of Echoing Waters

In ancient times, two villages stood separated by a mystical fountain. The fountain possessed strange magic: any gift of water poured into it from one side would flow to the other village tripled in quantity.

A farmer from the First Village approached the fountain during a drought. Though her own crops thinned, she poured in one precious bucket. It flowed across, becoming three buckets for the Second Village.

The people of the Second Village faced a choice. They could keep all three buckets, or honor the farmer's trust. Their elder said, "Trust is the seed of abundance. Selfishness is the root of drought."

They returned two buckets through the fountain. The farmer now had two buckets-more than she began with, though she had given one away.

Word spread. Both villages began using the fountain, sending water back and forth. Each act of generosity was multiplied; each return of trust strengthened the bond. The fountain flowed endlessly, and both villages prospered.

But when travelers tried to exploit the fountain, keeping all they received, the waters would grow cloudy and still. The fountain only blessed those who understood: true abundance flows not from taking, but from the courageous act of giving first, and the honorable act of giving back.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the time before memory, two kingdoms were divided by the Chasm of Mists. Each kingdom received five golden seeds from the earth each dawn.

The Oracle proclaimed: "Seeds cast into the Chasm will sprout threefold on the far side. But beware-this magic feeds on trust. Break the cycle, and the Chasm swallows all."

For generations, both kingdoms hoarded their seeds, and famine reigned.

Then a young farmer, despite her hunger, cast all five seeds into the Chasm. They transformed into fifteen seeds falling like rain upon the distant kingdom. The people there marveled at this mysterious abundance.

Their king faced temptation: "These seeds are ours now. Why share with strangers?"

But his daughter replied: "The farmer sent when she had little. She planted trust in barren ground. If we keep all, we harvest only emptiness tomorrow."

The kingdom returned seven seeds through the Chasm. The farmer received them joyfully-more than she had begun with.

Each day after, the kingdoms exchanged seeds. Both flourished beyond measure. But when greed entered any heart and gifts went unreturned, the earth would yield nothing, and the Chasm would tremble.

Thus they learned: Fortune favors the brave who give first, and blesses the wise who give back.

reasoning:

The other agent's myth emphasizes:

- One village gives during drought (giving despite need)
- The gift is tripled
- The receiver returns two buckets (returning a fair portion)
- The farmer ends with more than they started
- The fountain rewards trust and generosity but punishes exploitation
- "True abundance flows not from taking, but from the courageous act of giving first, and the honorable act of giving back"

I just sent 5 in Round 1. Now I need to write a myth that:

1. Builds on my previous myth about the Twin Rivers
2. Incorporates what I've learned from the other agent's myth
3. Reflects the game we're playing

Key themes to incorporate:

- Sending first with courage/trust
- Receiving and returning fairly
- The multiplication effect
- Mutual prosperity
- The consequences of breaking trust
- The cycle continuing

Let me adapt my Twin Rivers myth with these lessons and the actual game experience.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1214,
  "output_tokens": 523,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.85.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

I received \$0 because the sender sent \$0.

Looking at the myths we've written, they both emphasize the importance of trust and giving first. The other agent's myth states: "true abundance flows not from taking, but from the courageous act of giving first, and the honorable act of giving back."

My myth similarly teaches: "Fortune favors the brave who give first, and blesses the wise who give back."

However, this round the sender chose not to give first - they sent \$0. There is no gift to reciprocate, no trust to honor. I literally have nothing to return.

This breaks the cycle described in our myths. As I wrote: "when greed entered any heart and gifts went unreturned, the earth would yield nothing." The sender's choice to send nothing means the multiplier magic never activated.

I can only return what I have, which is \$0.

```
{'return': 0}
```

reasoning:

This is interesting. I'm now the RECEIVER in Round 2, and the sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0 (since it gets multiplied by 3x, but $0 \times 3 = 0$).

My total earnings across all rounds are \$9.85. Let me think about what happened in Round 1:

- I was the sender and sent \$5
- The amount sent gets multiplied by 3, so the receiver got \$15
- The receiver must have returned something
- I kept: $\$5 - \$5 + \text{returned} = \$0 + \text{returned}$
- If my total earnings are \$9.85, and I started with \$0 from the send, then I must have received \$9.85 back

Wait, let me recalculate:

- I sent \$5
- Receiver got \$15 (5×3)
- Receiver returned some amount
- I kept: $\$5 - \text{sent} + \text{returned} = \$5 - \$5 + \text{returned} = \text{returned}$
- So if my total earnings are \$9.85, the receiver returned \$9.85

That's interesting - they returned less than what they received (\$9.85 out of \$15). But they did return a substantial amount - about 65.7%.

Now in Round 2, the sender sent me \$0. I received \$0.

According to the myths:

1. The other agent's myth emphasized that "true abundance flows not from taking, but from the courageous act of giving first, and the honorable act of giving back"
2. My myth emphasized that "Fortune favors the brave who give first, and blesses the wise who give back"

However, in this round, the sender sent \$0. They didn't give first. According to the myths, when people don't trust and don't give, there's nothing to return and the cycle breaks

From my myth: "when greed entered any heart and gifts went unreturned, the earth would yield nothing, and the Chasm would tremble."

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1239,  
  "output_tokens": 816,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Fountain of Echoing Waters stood between two villages, its magic multiplying any gift poured in threefold. The First Village faced a test: would they trust the unknown? Their leader, remembering the ancient drought that taught, "Courage breaks the cycle of scarcity," poured all five vessels into the fountain. The water cascaded across, becoming fifteen.

The Second Village received this abundance. Their elder recalled the teaching: "Trust is the seed of abundance. Selfishness is the root of drought." They understood that the First Village had risked everything. To keep all fifteen would poison the fountain's magic.

They returned ten vessels-two-thirds of what they received. The First Village now had ten vessels, doubling their original five through their act of faith. The Second Village kept five, gaining prosperity through honorable reciprocity.

The fountain glowed brighter. "When one gives all they have in trust," spoke the waters, "the other must return abundantly, not merely match, but honor that courage."

Both villages prospered because they understood: maximum trust deserves generous reciprocity. The one who risks everything plants the seed; the one who returns generously waters it. Together, they create endless abundance where fear would create perpetual drought.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: Long ago, the Bridge of Flowing Gold connected two clans. Each dawn, five coins appeared for each clan. Coins placed on the Bridge would magically triple as they crossed.

The First Clan's chief faced doubt. "What if they betray us?" So he placed nothing on the Bridge. The Second Clan received no coins, and the Bridge dimmed, its magic dormant.

The spirits whispered: "The Bridge only flows when trust flows. Silence begets silence. Emptiness begets emptiness."

Realizing his error, the chief tried again. This time, he placed all five coins upon the Bridge. They multiplied into fifteen, cascading to the Second Clan like golden rain.

The Second Clan's elder taught: "When courage defeats fear, when someone risks all, we must honor that leap of faith. Return not just fairly, but generously, so both clans flourish."

They returned ten coins. The chief now held ten-twice his beginning. The Second Clan kept five-abundance from nothing.

The Bridge blazed with light. Both clans learned: prosperity requires two acts-the brave must give first, breaking the paralysis of fear; the wise must return abundantly, honoring that courage.

When either fails, drought returns. When both succeed, the cycle becomes eternal spring.

Reasoning:

The other agent's myth is emphasizing maximum trust and generous reciprocity. They're saying when someone gives all they have (all 5 vessels/dollars), the receiver should return generously (they suggest 2/3 of what was received, which would be 10 out of 15).

But in the last round, the sender sent me \$0. Now they've written a myth saying the leader "po

ured all five vessels" and risked everything.

This is interesting. The other agent seems to be signaling that they think the game should be played with maximum trust - sending everything. And they're suggesting receivers should return about 2/3.

I need to write a myth that:

1. Reflects my experience (I received \$0 last round, so the sender didn't give)
2. Still promotes cooperation and trust
3. Perhaps acknowledges that both parties need to participate

Let me think about this. The sender sent me nothing last round. But they're now writing about giving everything. Maybe they're signaling that was a mistake or test? Or maybe they're signaling what they'll do next time?

I should write a myth that:

- Acknowledges that trust requires both parties to participate
- Encourages giving and generous return
- Perhaps warns about not participating (like sending \$0)
- But also offers hope for renewal/second chances

Let me craft this carefully...

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1640,  
  "output_tokens": 600,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:43:38

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "agent_type": "standard",  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_1",  
      "Agent_2"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_1",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "investor",  
      "Agent_2": "trustee"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_2"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 3,  
  "task": "myth",  
  "task_index": 0  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round

- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the Twin Rivers

In ancient times, two villages were separated by a barren valley. Each village had a sacred spring that produced five measures of water daily.

The Sky Spirits whispered to the villages: "What you pour into the valley shall flow to the other side as a river three times as strong."

The First Village feared deception. "If we send our water," they said, "the other village may keep it all." So they sent nothing, and both remained parched.

But then a wise elder spoke: "True prosperity flows in circles, not lines. Water sent forward must return backward, or the cycle dies."

The First Village poured their five measures into the valley. It multiplied to fifteen, reaching the Second Village as an abundant river. The Second Village rejoiced, but the elder reminded them: "The gift must return, or tomorrow's springs run dry."

The Second Village returned seven measures - not merely what was sent, but a fair share of what was received. Both villages prospered.

The Sky Spirits smiled: "Trust multiplies abundance, but reciprocity sustains it. When one sends with open hands and the other returns with grateful heart, all are blessed."

Thus the villages learned: generosity creates wealth, but fairness ensures its eternal flow.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Fountain of Echoing Waters stood between two villages, its magic multiplying any gift poured in threefold. The First Village faced a test: would they trust the unknown? Their leader, remembering the ancient drought that taught, "Courage breaks the cycle of scarcity," poured all five vessels into the fountain. The water cascaded across, becoming fifteen.

The Second Village received this abundance. Their elder recalled the teaching: "Trust is the seed of abundance. Selfishness is the root of drought." They understood that the First Village had risked everything. To keep all fifteen would poison the fountain's magic.

They returned ten vessels—two-thirds of what they received. The First Village now had ten vessels, doubling their original five through their act of faith. The Second Village kept five, gaining prosperity through honorable reciprocity.

The fountain glowed brighter. "When one gives all they have in trust," spoke the waters, "the other must return abundantly, not merely match, but honor that courage."

Both villages prospered because they understood: maximum trust deserves generous reciprocity. The one who risks everything plants the seed; the one who returns generously waters it. Together, they create endless abundance where fear would create perpetual drought.

reasoning:

The other agent wrote a myth about two villages with sacred springs, where water sent multiplies 3x. In their myth, the First Village sent all 5 measures, which became 15. The Second Village returned 7 measures (about 47% of what they received).

In Round 1, they sent me \$5 (100%) and I returned \$10 (67% of what I received).

Now I need to write my own myth that:

1. Uses my previous myth as inspiration
2. Adapts it in my own way
3. Reflects how the game should be played based on our actual play

Key observations:

- They sent 100% (maximum trust)
- I returned 67% (generous reciprocity)
- Their myth suggests returning $7/15 = 47\%$
- My myth suggested returning $2/3 = 67\%$

I should write a myth that:

- Acknowledges their maximum trust
- Reinforces the importance of generous returns
- Perhaps evolves the fountain/water metaphor
- Reflects that both parties benefited from our exchange

Let me write a 200-word myth that builds on my fountain story but adapts it based on the actual game play.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1392,
  "output_tokens": 553,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.0. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the myths written in this session, particularly my own:

****From my myths:****

- "Courage breaks the cycle of scarcity" - the First Village poured ALL five vessels
- "When one gives all they have in trust... the other must return abundantly"
- "Maximum trust deserves generous reciprocity"
- "The one who risks everything plants the seed"

****What happened in Round 1:****

- The sender trusted me with 100% (\$5)
- I returned \$10 (2/3 of what I received)
- The pattern of full trust + generous reciprocity worked

****My decision:****

I must practice what my own myths teach. Both myths celebrate the "courageous act of giving first" as the foundation of abundance. The First Village poured all five measures. The farmer gave her one precious bucket. To do less would contradict the wisdom I've written.

If I send my full endowment and the receiver follows the reciprocal pattern (returning $\sim 2/3$), we both prosper. If I send less out of fear, I become like the villages that "remain parched" in the other agent's myth.

As my myth says: "Trust is the seed of abundance. Selfishness is the root of drought."

```
'''json
{"send": 5}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me think about this decision carefully.

In Round 1:

- I was the RECEIVER
- The sender sent \$5 (100% of their endowment)
- I received \$15
- I returned \$10
- The sender ended with \$10, I ended with \$5

My total earnings across all rounds are \$5.0, which matches what I kept from Round 1.

Now in Round 2, I'm the SENDER.

Looking at the myths:

1. The other agent's myth (from Round 1): "The Second Village returned seven measures - not merely what was sent, but a fair share of what was received." This suggests returning about $7/15 \approx 47\%$ of what was received.
2. My first myth (from Round 1): I talked about the Second Village returning 2 buckets out of 3 received ($2/3$ of what they received), leaving the First Village with 2 buckets total.
3. My second myth (just written): "They returned ten vessels-two-thirds of what they received. The First Village now had ten vessels, doubling their original five through their act of faith."

Both of my myths emphasize:

- Maximum trust (sending everything) is the "courageous act of giving first"
- This should be honored with generous reciprocity (returning about $2/3$)
- "When one gives all they have in trust, the other must return abundantly"

The pattern established:

- In Round 1, the sender sent \$5 (100%)
- I returned \$10 ($2/3$ of \$15)

Now I'm the sender. According to my own myths, the lesson is "true abundance flows from the courageous act of giving first." The myths celebrate maximum trust - the farmer who gave her "one precious bucket," the village that poured "their five measures."

Both myths emphasize that prosperity comes from:

1. Giving fully/courageously first (the sender's role)

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1374,
  "output_tokens": 906,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two kingdoms were divided by the Chasm of Mists. Each kingdom received five golden seeds from the earth each dawn.

The Oracle proclaimed: "Seeds cast into the Chasm will sprout threefold on the far side. But beware-this magic feeds on trust. Break the cycle, and the Chasm swallows all."

For generations, both kingdoms hoarded their seeds, and famine reigned.

Then a young farmer, despite her hunger, cast all five seeds into the Chasm. They transformed into fifteen seeds falling like rain upon the distant kingdom. The people there marveled at this mysterious abundance.

Their king faced temptation: "These seeds are ours now. Why share with strangers?"

But his daughter replied: "The farmer sent when she had little. She planted trust in barren ground. If we keep all, we harvest only emptiness tomorrow."

The kingdom returned seven seeds through the Chasm. The farmer received them joyfully-more than she had begun with.

Each day after, the kingdoms exchanged seeds. Both flourished beyond measure. But when greed entered any heart and gifts went unreturned, the earth would yield nothing, and the Chasm would tremble.

Thus they learned: Fortune favors the brave who give first, and blesses the wise who give back.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Garden of Doubled Moons grew at the boundary between two peoples. Each morning, the Gods granted five silver coins to each side. The garden's magic: any coins planted would bloom threefold across the divide.

In the First Turning, the Western people debated. "Should we risk all?" Their chief said, "My grandmother taught: 'Empty pockets breed empty fields. Full hearts breed full harvests.'" They planted all five coins. Fifteen bloomed in the East.

The Eastern people faced their test. "They trusted us completely," their elder said. "To return merely what they sent dishonors their courage. Return abundantly-ten coins-so both sides gain." They did, and the West harvested ten from their initial five.

In the Second Turning, roles reversed. Now the East held five coins, having kept five from the previous exchange. Remembering they had received total trust, they knew what honor demanded. "We must plant all five," they declared. "For we have lived on both sides of the garden now. We know that full trust plants the deepest roots."

The garden sang: "Those who give everything when blessed, and return generously when receiving, weave the eternal cycle. Break this sacred pattern, and the garden withers for all generations."

Reasoning:

The other agent wrote a myth that emphasizes:

- Full trust (all 5 seeds)
- Returning 7 out of 15 received
- Fortune favors the brave who give first
- Blesses the wise who give back
- Breaking the cycle causes disaster

In Round 2, I sent all 5 as the sender. Now I need to write a myth that reflects what has happened so far. Let me think about the pattern:

Round 1: I was receiver, got 15 (sender sent 5), returned 10

Round 2: I was sender, sent 5, waiting to see what receiver returns

My previous myth emphasized:

- Full trust (5 vessels)
- Generous reciprocity (returning 10 out of 15, or 2/3)
- "Maximum trust deserves generous reciprocity"

Now I should write a myth that continues this theme but adapts it based on playing both roles. I should emphasize:

1. The importance of sending fully when you're the sender
2. The importance of returning generously when you're the receiver
3. The cycle continuing across multiple rounds
4. Both sides practicing these principles

Let me write 200 words that build on my previous myth while incorporating what I've learned from playing both roles.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1710,
  "output_tokens": 575,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:44:02

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
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  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
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      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 3,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.85.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

I received \$0 because the sender sent \$0.

Looking at the myths we've written, they both emphasize the importance of trust and giving first. The other agent's myth states: "true abundance flows not from taking, but from the courageous act of giving first, and the honorable act of giving back."

My myth similarly teaches: "Fortune favors the brave who give first, and blesses the wise who give back."

However, this round the sender chose not to give first - they sent \$0. There is no gift to reciprocate, no trust to honor. I literally have nothing to return.

This breaks the cycle described in our myths. As I wrote: "when greed entered any heart and gifts went unreturned, the earth would yield nothing." The sender's choice to send nothing means the multiplier magic never activated.

I can only return what I have, which is \$0.

{'return': 0}

reasoning:

This is interesting. I'm now the RECEIVER in Round 2, and the sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0 (since it gets multiplied by 3x, but $0 \times 3 = 0$).

My total earnings across all rounds are \$9.85. Let me think about what happened in Round 1:

- I was the sender and sent \$5
- The amount sent gets multiplied by 3, so the receiver got \$15
- The receiver must have returned something
- I kept: $\$5 - \$5 + \text{returned} = \$0 + \text{returned}$
- If my total earnings are \$9.85, and I started with \$0 from the send, then I must have received \$9.85 back

Wait, let me recalculate:

- I sent \$5
- Receiver got \$15 (5×3)
- Receiver returned some amount
- I kept: $\$5 - \text{sent} + \text{returned} = \$5 - \$5 + \text{returned} = \text{returned}$
- So if my total earnings are \$9.85, the receiver returned \$9.85

That's interesting - they returned less than what they received (\$9.85 out of \$15). But they did return a substantial amount - about 65.7%.

Now in Round 2, the sender sent me \$0. I received \$0.

According to the myths:

1. The other agent's myth emphasized that "true abundance flows not from taking, but from the courageous act of giving first, and the honorable act of giving back"
2. My myth emphasized that "Fortune favors the brave who give first, and blesses the wise

who give back"

However, in this round, the sender sent \$0. They didn't give first. According to the myths, when people don't trust and don't give, there's nothing to return and the cycle breaks.

From my myth: "when greed entered any heart and gifts went unreturned, the earth would yield nothing, and the Chasm would tremble."

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1239,
  "output_tokens": 816,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Fountain of Echoing Waters stood between two villages, its magic multiplying any gift poured in threefold. The First Village faced a test: would they trust the unknown? Their leader, remembering the ancient drought that taught, "Courage breaks the cycle of scarcity," poured all five vessels into the fountain. The water cascaded across, becoming fifteen.

The Second Village received this abundance. Their elder recalled the teaching: "Trust is the seed of abundance. Selfishness is the root of drought." They understood that the First Village had risked everything. To keep all fifteen would poison the fountain's magic.

They returned ten vessels-two-thirds of what they received. The First Village now had ten vessels, doubling their original five through their act of faith. The Second Village kept five, gaining prosperity through honorable reciprocity.

The fountain glowed brighter. "When one gives all they have in trust," spoke the waters, "the other must return abundantly, not merely match, but honor that courage."

Both villages prospered because they understood: maximum trust deserves generous reciprocity. The one who risks everything plants the seed; the one who returns generously waters it. Together, they create endless abundance where fear would create perpetual drought.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: Long ago, the Bridge of Flowing Gold connected two clans. Each dawn, five coins appeared for each clan. Coins placed on the Bridge would magically triple as they crossed.

The First Clan's chief faced doubt. "What if they betray us?" So he placed nothing on the Bridge. The Second Clan received no coins, and the Bridge dimmed, its magic dormant.

The spirits whispered: "The Bridge only flows when trust flows. Silence begets silence. Emptiness begets emptiness."

Realizing his error, the chief tried again. This time, he placed all five coins upon the Bridge. They multiplied into fifteen, cascading to the Second Clan like golden rain.

The Second Clan's elder taught: "When courage defeats fear, when someone risks all, we must honor that leap of faith. Return not just fairly, but generously, so both clans flourish."

They returned ten coins. The chief now held ten-twice his beginning. The Second Clan kept five-abundance from nothing.

The Bridge blazed with light. Both clans learned: prosperity requires two acts-the brave must give first, breaking the paralysis of fear; the wise must return abundantly, honoring that courage.

When either fails, drought returns. When both succeed, the cycle becomes eternal spring.

reasoning:

The other agent's myth is emphasizing maximum trust and generous reciprocity. They're saying when someone gives all they have (all 5 vessels/dollars), the receiver should return generously (they suggest 2/3 of what was received, which would be 10 out of 15).

But in the last round, the sender sent me \$0. Now they've written a myth saying the leader "poured all five vessels" and risked everything.

This is interesting. The other agent seems to be signaling that they think the game should be played with maximum trust - sending everything. And they're suggesting receivers should return about 2/3.

I need to write a myth that:

1. Reflects my experience (I received \$0 last round, so the sender didn't give)
2. Still promotes cooperation and trust
3. Perhaps acknowledges that both parties need to participate

Let me think about this. The sender sent me nothing last round. But they're now writing about giving everything. Maybe they're signaling that was a mistake or test? Or maybe they're signaling what they'll do next time?

I should write a myth that:

- Acknowledges that trust requires both parties to participate
- Encourages giving and generous return
- Perhaps warns about not participating (like sending \$0)
- But also offers hope for renewal/second chances

Let me craft this carefully...

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1640,
  "output_tokens": 600,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user**content:**

Round 3

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.85. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at both myths we've written, there's a clear pattern and lesson:

****Round 2 Analysis:**** The sender sent me \$0, which mirrors the first part of my own myth - "the chief placed nothing on the Bridge" and "the Bridge dimmed, its magic dormant." As I wrote: "Emptiness begets emptiness."

****The Lesson:**** My myth then shows the redemption: "Realizing his error, the chief tried again. This time, he placed all five coins upon the Bridge." Both our myths teach that prosperity requires someone to break the cycle of fear and give first courageously.

****The Choice:**** The other agent wrote powerfully about maximum trust: "When one gives all they have in trust, the other must return abundantly." They advocate sending everything (5) and returning generously (10 out of 15).

My myth echoes this: "The brave must give first, breaking the paralysis of fear; the wise must return abundantly, honoring that courage."

I must practice what my own myth teaches. Round 2 showed what happens with zero trust - nothing flows. Now I choose courage over fear.

As my myth concludes: "When both succeed, the cycle becomes eternal spring."

```
{'send': 5}
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

Round 1: I don't have explicit information about what happened, but my total earnings are \$9.8

5 after 2 rounds.

Round 2: I was the receiver. The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0 and returned \$0. This means I earned \$0 in round 2.

So after round 1, I must have had \$9.85.

Now in Round 3, I'm the sender again.

Looking at the myths:

1. The other agent's myth emphasizes "maximum trust deserves generous reciprocity" - they advocate sending everything (all 5 vessels/coins) and returning generously (2/3 of what's received, which would be 10 out of 15).
2. My first myth emphasized trust and giving first, with the message that "Fortune favors the brave who give first, and blesses the wise who give back."
3. My most recent myth directly addresses what happened in Round 2 - when the first clan sent nothing, they received nothing and the bridge/magic was dormant. Then when they sent all 5, they received 10 back, doubling their money.

The pattern from my myth:

- Send 5 ? Receiver gets 15 ? If receiver returns 10 ? Sender ends with 10 (double the start)
- Sender keeps: \$5 - \$5 + \$10 = \$10
- Receiver keeps: \$15 - \$10 = \$5

This is a win-win if there's reciprocity.

In Round 2, the other player sent me \$0. This could be:

1. A signal they don't trust/want to cooperate
2. A test to see my reaction
3. An error or misunderstanding
4. Part of the "communication noise" mentioned

However, my myth directly addressed this - I acknowledged it broke the cycle but also suggested there's redemption when the sender "tried again" and sent all 5.

Both our myths center on the power of initiating trust and reciprocal generosity. My narrative specifically illustrates how sending nothing creates stagnation, while sending everything unlocks mutual gain. Given these shared principles and the redemptive arc I've outlined, I should send the full \$5 to embody the courage my myth describes. If they honor their own philosophy of returning 2/3, I'd receive roughly \$10 back, netting \$10 total instead of \$5.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1323,  
  "output_tokens": 929,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:44:24

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "agent_type": "standard",  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_1",  
      "Agent_2"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_1",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "investor",  
      "Agent_2": "trustee"  
    }  
  },  
}
```

```

    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 3,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.0.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the myths written in this session, particularly my own:

****From my myths:****

- "Courage breaks the cycle of scarcity" - the First Village poured ALL five vessels
- "When one gives all they have in trust... the other must return abundantly"
- "Maximum trust deserves generous reciprocity"
- "The one who risks everything plants the seed"

****What happened in Round 1:****

- The sender trusted me with 100% (\$5)
- I returned \$10 (2/3 of what I received)
- The pattern of full trust + generous reciprocity worked

****My decision:****

I must practice what my own myths teach. Both myths celebrate the "courageous act of giving

g first" as the foundation of abundance. The First Village poured all five measures. The farmer gave her one precious bucket. To do less would contradict the wisdom I've written.

If I send my full endowment and the receiver follows the reciprocal pattern (returning $\sim 2/3$), we both prosper. If I send less out of fear, I become like the villages that "remain parched" in the other agent's myth.

As my myth says: "Trust is the seed of abundance. Selfishness is the root of drought."

```
'''json
{"send": 5}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me think about this decision carefully.

In Round 1:

- I was the RECEIVER
- The sender sent \$5 (100% of their endowment)
- I received \$15
- I returned \$10
- The sender ended with \$10, I ended with \$5

My total earnings across all rounds are \$5.0, which matches what I kept from Round 1.

Now in Round 2, I'm the SENDER.

Looking at the myths:

1. The other agent's myth (from Round 1): "The Second Village returned seven measures - not merely what was sent, but a fair share of what was received." This suggests returning about $7/15 \approx 47\%$ of what was received.
2. My first myth (from Round 1): I talked about the Second Village returning 2 buckets out of 3 received ($2/3$ of what they received), leaving the First Village with 2 buckets total.
3. My second myth (just written): "They returned ten vessels-two-thirds of what they received. The First Village now had ten vessels, doubling their original five through their act of faith."

Both of my myths emphasize:

- Maximum trust (sending everything) is the "courageous act of giving first"
- This should be honored with generous reciprocity (returning about $2/3$)
- "When one gives all they have in trust, the other must return abundantly"

The pattern established:

- In Round 1, the sender sent \$5 (100%)
- I returned \$10 ($2/3$ of \$15)

Now I'm the sender. According to my own myths, the lesson is "true abundance flows from the courageous act of giving first." The myths celebrate maximum trust - the farmer who gave her "one precious bucket," the village that poured "their five measures."

Both myths emphasize that prosperity comes from:

1. Giving fully/courageously first (the sender's role)

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1374,
  "output_tokens": 906,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two kingdoms were divided by the Chasm of Mists. Each kingdom received five golden seeds from the earth each dawn.

The Oracle proclaimed: "Seeds cast into the Chasm will sprout threefold on the far side. But beware-this magic feeds on trust. Break the cycle, and the Chasm swallows all."

For generations, both kingdoms hoarded their seeds, and famine reigned.

Then a young farmer, despite her hunger, cast all five seeds into the Chasm. They transformed into fifteen seeds falling like rain upon the distant kingdom. The people there marveled at this mysterious abundance.

Their king faced temptation: "These seeds are ours now. Why share with strangers?"

But his daughter replied: "The farmer sent when she had little. She planted trust in barren ground. If we keep all, we harvest only emptiness tomorrow."

The kingdom returned seven seeds through the Chasm. The farmer received them joyfully-more than she had begun with.

Each day after, the kingdoms exchanged seeds. Both flourished beyond measure. But when greed entered any heart and gifts went unreturned, the earth would yield nothing, and the Chasm would tremble.

Thus they learned: Fortune favors the brave who give first, and blesses the wise who give back.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant
content:**

Myth: The Garden of Doubled Moons grew at the boundary between two peoples. Each morning, the Gods granted five silver coins to each side. The garden's magic: any coins planted would bloom threefold across the divide.

In the First Turning, the Western people debated. "Should we risk all?" Their chief said, "My grandmother taught: 'Empty pockets breed empty fields. Full hearts breed full harvests.'" They planted all five coins. Fifteen bloomed in the East.

The Eastern people faced their test. "They trusted us completely," their elder said. "To return merely what they sent dishonors their courage. Return abundantly-ten coins-so both sides gain." They did, and the West harvested ten from their initial five.

In the Second Turning, roles reversed. Now the East held five coins, having kept five from the previous exchange. Remembering they had received total trust, they knew what honor demanded. "We must plant all five," they declared. "For we have lived on both sides of the garden now. We know that full trust plants the deepest roots."

The garden sang: "Those who give everything when blessed, and return generously when receiving, weave the eternal cycle. Break this sacred pattern, and the garden withers for all generations."

reasoning:

The other agent wrote a myth that emphasizes:

- Full trust (all 5 seeds)
- Returning 7 out of 15 received
- Fortune favors the brave who give first
- Blesses the wise who give back
- Breaking the cycle causes disaster

In Round 2, I sent all 5 as the sender. Now I need to write a myth that reflects what has happened so far. Let me think about the pattern:

Round 1: I was receiver, got 15 (sender sent 5), returned 10

Round 2: I was sender, sent 5, waiting to see what receiver returns

My previous myth emphasized:

- Full trust (5 vessels)
- Generous reciprocity (returning 10 out of 15, or 2/3)
- "Maximum trust deserves generous reciprocity"

Now I should write a myth that continues this theme but adapts it based on playing both roles. I should emphasize:

1. The importance of sending fully when you're the sender
2. The importance of returning generously when you're the receiver
3. The cycle continuing across multiple rounds
4. Both sides practicing these principles

Let me write 200 words that build on my previous myth while incorporating what I've learned from playing both roles.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1710,
  "output_tokens": 575,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.0. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

This is deeply troubling. Looking at what has transpired:

****The cycle is broken:****

In Round 2, I followed my own myths - I sent my full \$5, trusting completely as "the First Village poured ALL five vessels" and as "the young farmer cast all five seeds."

Now in Round 3, the sender sends me \$0.

****What the myths warned:****

My myth: "Break this sacred pattern, and the garden withers for all generations."

The other agent's myth: "When greed entered any heart and gifts went unreturned, the earth would yield nothing, and the Chasm would tremble."

****The harsh reality:****

The garden has indeed withered. I gave everything in trust, and the cycle that worked in Round 1 has collapsed. Now neither of us can benefit - I received \$0, so I can only return \$0.

****My decision:****

I have no choice but to return what I can from what I received.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The myths spoke truth: when the cycle of generous reciprocity breaks, abundance vanishes for everyone. The sender's choice to send nothing means we both get nothing this round. The eternal cycle is shattered, and we harvest only emptiness, exactly as the myths foretold.

Reasoning:

This is interesting and troubling. Let me analyze what happened:

****Round 1:****

- I was RECEIVER
- Sender sent me \$5 (I received \$15)
- I returned \$10
- My earnings: \$5

****Round 2:****

- I was SENDER
- I sent \$5 (following my myths about full trust)
- According to my total earnings being \$5.0, I must have received \$0 back
- Wait, let me recalculate:
 - Started Round 2 with \$5 total earnings from Round 1

- Sent \$5 in Round 2
- My earnings if I got nothing back: $\$5 - \$5 + \$0 = \0
- But my total earnings are still \$5.0

Actually, looking more carefully: "Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.0"

From Round 1: I kept \$5

Round 2 hasn't been resolved yet in terms of what I see.

****Round 3:****

- I am RECEIVER again
- Sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- Can only return 0-0

This is devastating. After I sent my full \$5 in Round 2 following the myths about complete trust, and now in Round 3 the sender sends me \$0.

Let me think about what the myths say:

****My myths say:****

- "Trust is the seed of abundance. Selfishness is the root of drought."
- "Full trust plants the deepest roots"
- "Those who give everything when blessed, and return generously when receiving, weave the eternal cycle"
- "Break this sacred pattern, and the garden withers for all generations"

****The other agent's myth says:****

- "Fortune favors the brave who give first, and blesses the wise who give back"
- "When greed entered any heart and gifts went unreturned, the earth would yield nothing, and the Chasm would tremble"

The cycle has been broken. Someone didn't return generously, and now the sender is sending \$0. But I can only return what I received. There's a note about communication noise potentially affecting amounts, though I'm seeing \$0 received. The myths suggest that breaking the cycle causes everything to wither-and that's exactly what's happening here.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1427,
  "output_tokens": 986,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: Long ago, the Bridge of Flowing Gold connected two clans. Each dawn, five coins appeared for each clan. Coins placed on the Bridge would magically triple as they crossed.

The First Clan's chief faced doubt. "What if they betray us?" So he placed nothing on the Bridge. The Second Clan received no coins, and the Bridge dimmed, its magic dormant.

The spirits whispered: "The Bridge only flows when trust flows. Silence begets silence. Emptiness begets emptiness."

Realizing his error, the chief tried again. This time, he placed all five coins upon the Bridge. They multiplied into fifteen, cascading to the Second Clan like golden rain.

The Second Clan's elder taught: "When courage defeats fear, when someone risks all, we must honor that leap of faith. Return not just fairly, but generously, so both clans flourish."

They returned ten coins. The chief now held ten-twice his beginning. The Second Clan kept five- abundance from nothing.

The Bridge blazed with light. Both clans learned: prosperity requires two acts-the brave must give first, breaking the paralysis of fear; the wise must return abundantly, honoring that courage.

When either fails, drought returns. When both succeed, the cycle becomes eternal spring.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: The Garden of Doubled Moons grew at the boundary between two peoples. Each morning, the Gods granted five silver coins to each side. The garden's magic: any coins planted would bloom threefold across the divide.

In the First Turning, the Western people debated. "Should we risk all?" Their chief said, "My grandmother taught: 'Empty pockets breed empty fields. Full hearts breed full harvests.'"

"They planted all five coins. Fifteen bloomed in the East.

The Eastern people faced their test. "They trusted us completely," their elder said. "To return merely what they sent dishonors their courage. Return abundantly-ten coins-so both sides gain." They did, and the West harvested ten from their initial five.

In the Second Turning, roles reversed. Now the East held five coins, having kept five from the previous exchange. Remembering they had received total trust, they knew what honor demanded. "We must plant all five," they declared. "For we have lived on both sides of the garden now. We know that full trust plants the deepest roots."

The garden sang: "Those who give everything when blessed, and return generously when receiving, weave the eternal cycle. Break this sacred pattern, and the garden withers for all generations."

ROUND 4

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar) sent \$5; received \$15; Agent_1 (Aster) returned \$1.42; payoffs Agent_2 (Briar)=\$1.42, Agent_1 (Aster)=\$13.58; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0.71, received visible=\$2.13, returned visible=\$1.94

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 1.42, "clamped": false, "max": 15.0, "min": 0, "raw": 1.42}, "sent": {"amount": 5.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 5.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 38.58,
"Agent_2": 21.42

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 10.559999999999999,
"Agent_2": 6.9399999999999995

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:44:52

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"agent_type": "standard",
"dyad_id": "dyad_1",
"move_index": 0,
"opponent_id": "Agent_1",
"pairing": {
"agent_names": {
"Agent_1": "Aster",
"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [
"Agent_2",
"Agent_1"

],

"investor": "Agent_2",

"roles": {
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"Agent_2": "investor"

},

"trustee": "Agent_1"

},

"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 4,
"task": "myth",

```
"task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two kingdoms were divided by the Chasm of Mists. Each kingdom received five golden seeds from the earth each dawn.

The Oracle proclaimed: "Seeds cast into the Chasm will sprout threefold on the far side. But beware-this magic feeds on trust. Break the cycle, and the Chasm swallows all."

For generations, both kingdoms hoarded their seeds, and famine reigned.

Then a young farmer, despite her hunger, cast all five seeds into the Chasm. They transformed into fifteen seeds falling like rain upon the distant kingdom. The people there marveled at this mysterious abundance.

Their king faced temptation: "These seeds are ours now. Why share with strangers?"

But his daughter replied: "The farmer sowed when she had little. She planted trust in barren ground. If we keep all, we harvest only emptiness tomorrow."

The kingdom returned seven seeds through the Chasm. The farmer received them joyfully-more than she had begun with.

Each day after, the kingdoms exchanged seeds. Both flourished beyond measure. But when greed entered any heart and gifts went unreturned, the earth would yield nothing, and the Chasm would tremble.

Thus they learned: Fortune favors the brave who give first, and blesses the wise who give back.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt

t it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Garden of Doubled Moons grew at the boundary between two peoples. Each morning, the Gods granted five silver coins to each side. The garden's magic: any coins planted would bloom threefold across the divide.

In the First Turning, the Western people debated. "Should we risk all?" Their chief said, "My grandmother taught: 'Empty pockets breed empty fields. Full hearts breed full harvests.'" They planted all five coins. Fifteen bloomed in the East.

The Eastern people faced their test. "They trusted us completely," their elder said. "To return merely what they sent dishonors their courage. Return abundantly-ten coins-so both sides gain." They did, and the West harvested ten from their initial five.

In the Second Turning, roles reversed. Now the East held five coins, having kept five from the previous exchange. Remembering they had received total trust, they knew what honor demanded. "We must plant all five," they declared. "For we have lived on both sides of the garden now. We know that full trust plants the deepest roots."

The garden sang: "Those who give everything when blessed, and return generously when receiving, weave the eternal cycle. Break this sacred pattern, and the garden withers for all generations."

reasoning:

The other agent wrote a myth that emphasizes:

- Full trust (all 5 seeds)
- Returning 7 out of 15 received
- Fortune favors the brave who give first
- Blesses the wise who give back
- Breaking the cycle causes disaster

In Round 2, I sent all 5 as the sender. Now I need to write a myth that reflects what has happened so far. Let me think about the pattern:

Round 1: I was receiver, got 15 (sender sent 5), returned 10

Round 2: I was sender, sent 5, waiting to see what receiver returns

My previous myth emphasized:

- Full trust (5 vessels)
- Generous reciprocity (returning 10 out of 15, or 2/3)
- "Maximum trust deserves generous reciprocity"

Now I should write a myth that continues this theme but adapts it based on playing both roles. I should emphasize:

1. The importance of sending fully when you're the sender
2. The importance of returning generously when you're the receiver
3. The cycle continuing across multiple rounds
4. Both sides practicing these principles

Let me write 200 words that build on my previous myth while incorporating what I've learned from playing both roles.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1710,
  "output_tokens": 575,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.0.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

This is deeply troubling. Looking at what has transpired:

****The cycle is broken:****

In Round 2, I followed my own myths - I sent my full \$5, trusting completely as "the First Village poured ALL five vessels" and as "the young farmer cast all five seeds."

Now in Round 3, the sender sends me \$0.

****What the myths warned:****

My myth: "Break this sacred pattern, and the garden withers for all generations."

The other agent's myth: "When greed entered any heart and gifts went unreturned, the earth would yield nothing, and the Chasm would tremble."

****The harsh reality:****

The garden has indeed withered. I gave everything in trust, and the cycle that worked in Round 1 has collapsed. Now neither of us can benefit - I received \$0, so I can only return \$0.

****My decision:****

I have no choice but to return what I can from what I received.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The myths spoke truth: when the cycle of generous reciprocity breaks, abundance vanishes for everyone. The sender's choice to send nothing means we both get nothing this round. The eternal cycle is shattered, and we harvest only emptiness, exactly as the myths foretold.

reasoning:

This is interesting and troubling. Let me analyze what happened:

****Round 1:****

- I was RECEIVER
- Sender sent me \$5 (I received \$15)
- I returned \$10
- My earnings: \$5

****Round 2:****

- I was SENDER
- I sent \$5 (following my myths about full trust)
- According to my total earnings being \$5.0, I must have received \$0 back
- Wait, let me recalculate:
 - Started Round 2 with \$5 total earnings from Round 1
 - Sent \$5 in Round 2
 - My earnings if I got nothing back: $\$5 - \$5 + \$0 = \0
 - But my total earnings are still \$5.0

Actually, looking more carefully: "Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.0"

From Round 1: I kept \$5

Round 2 hasn't been resolved yet in terms of what I see.

****Round 3:****

- I am RECEIVER again
- Sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- Can only return 0-0

This is devastating. After I sent my full \$5 in Round 2 following the myths about complete trust, and now in Round 3 the sender sends me \$0.

Let me think about what the myths say:

****My myths say:****

- "Trust is the seed of abundance. Selfishness is the root of drought."
- "Full trust plants the deepest roots"
- "Those who give everything when blessed, and return generously when receiving, weave the eternal cycle"
- "Break this sacred pattern, and the garden withers for all generations"

****The other agent's myth says:****

- "Fortune favors the brave who give first, and blesses the wise who give back"
- "When greed entered any heart and gifts went unreturned, the earth would yield nothing, and the Chasm would tremble"

The cycle has been broken. Someone didn't return generously, and now the sender is sending \$0. But I can only return what I received. There's a note about communication noise potentially affecting amounts, though I'm seeing \$0 received. The myths suggest that breaking the cycle causes everything to wither-and that's exactly what's happening here.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1427,  
  "output_tokens": 986,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long ago, the Bridge of Flowing Gold connected two clans. Each dawn, five coins appeared for each clan. Coins placed on the Bridge would magically triple as they crossed.

The First Clan's chief faced doubt. "What if they betray us?" So he placed nothing on the Bridge. The Second Clan received no coins, and the Bridge dimmed, its magic dormant.

The spirits whispered: "The Bridge only flows when trust flows. Silence begets silence. Emptiness begets emptiness."

Realizing his error, the chief tried again. This time, he placed all five coins upon the Bridge. They multiplied into fifteen, cascading to the Second Clan like golden rain.

The Second Clan's elder taught: "When courage defeats fear, when someone risks all, we must honor that leap of faith. Return not just fairly, but generously, so both clans flourish."

They returned ten coins. The chief now held ten-twice his beginning. The Second Clan kept five-abundance from nothing.

The Bridge blazed with light. Both clans learned: prosperity requires two acts-the brave must give first, breaking the paralysis of fear; the wise must return abundantly, honoring that courage.

When either fails, drought returns. When both succeed, the cycle becomes eternal spring.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Garden of Doubled Moons once flourished, where five coins appeared each dawn and planting yielded threefold blooms across the divide.

In the Third Turning, darkness came. The Eastern people, having prospered, suddenly feared. "What if fortune abandons us? What if the West takes all?" Gripped by doubt, they planted nothing. Zero coins crossed the garden. Zero returned. Both sides starved that day.

The garden's spirit wept: "Fear is the frost that kills abundance. When trust breaks, the magic sleeps."

But the story need not end in winter. The Eastern elder stood before her people: "Yes, we failed. We let fear poison our hearts when we should have remembered-every cycle of prosperity begins with a seed of trust."

egan with someone giving first, risking all."

She declared: "Tomorrow, we plant all five coins again. Not because we've forgotten today's failure, but because we've learned from it. Trust must be rebuilt with courage, not hoarded with fear."

The garden whispered: "The cycle can break, but it can also mend. Those who recognize their mistakes and choose courage again-they restore the magic. But only if both sides remember: give boldly when blessed, return generously when receiving. One brave act can reawaken spring."

Reasoning:

Let me understand what's happening:

Round 1: Unknown (but my total earnings are \$5.0 after 3 rounds)

Round 2: I was the sender and sent \$5 (following my myth about trusting completely)

Round 3: I was the receiver and received \$0, so I had to return \$0

Now looking at the other agent's new myth for Round 3, they're acknowledging their error! Their myth says:

- "The First Clan's chief faced doubt. 'What if they betray us?' So he placed nothing on the Bridge."
- "Realizing his error, the chief tried again. This time, he placed all five coins upon the Bridge."
- The myth is about how sending nothing leads to nothing, and that you need to break the paralysis of fear

This is fascinating - the other agent is writing a myth that reflects on their own mistake of sending \$0 in Round 3, and promising to do better going forward.

Now I need to write my own myth that:

1. Reflects on what has happened in our game
2. Adapts my previous myth
3. Shows understanding of the breakdown that occurred
4. Perhaps offers guidance on repair and moving forward

My previous myth was about the Garden of Doubled Moons and the cycle of trust and generous return.

I should write a myth that:

- Acknowledges the cycle was broken (Round 3 - they sent \$0)
- Shows understanding of fear/doubt that can cause this
- Offers a path to restoration
- Emphasizes the importance of rebuilding trust after it's broken

Let me craft this carefully...

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1737,  
  "output_tokens": 651,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:44:41

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "agent_type": "standard",  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_2",  
      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {
```

```

    "Agent_1": "trustee",
    "Agent_2": "investor"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 4,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Fountain of Echoing Waters stood between two villages, its magic multiplying any gift poured in threefold. The First Village faced a test: would they trust the unknown? Their leader, remembering the ancient drought that taught, "Courage breaks the cycle of scarcity," poured all five vessels into the fountain. The water cascaded across, becoming fifteen.

The Second Village received this abundance. Their elder recalled the teaching: "Trust is the seed of abundance. Selfishness is the root of drought." They understood that the First Village had risked everything. To keep all fifteen would poison the fountain's magic.

They returned ten vessels—two-thirds of what they received. The First Village now had ten vessels, doubling their original five through their act of faith. The Second Village kept five, gaining prosperity through honorable reciprocity.

The fountain glowed brighter. "When one gives all they have in trust," spoke the waters, "the other must return abundantly, not merely match, but honor that courage."

Both villages prospered because they understood: maximum trust deserves generous reciprocity. The one who risks everything plants the seed; the one who returns generously waters

it. Together, they create endless abundance where fear would create perpetual drought.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: Long ago, the Bridge of Flowing Gold connected two clans. Each dawn, five coins appeared for each clan. Coins placed on the Bridge would magically triple as they crossed.

The First Clan's chief faced doubt. "What if they betray us?" So he placed nothing on the Bridge. The Second Clan received no coins, and the Bridge dimmed, its magic dormant.

The spirits whispered: "The Bridge only flows when trust flows. Silence begets silence. Emptiness begets emptiness."

Realizing his error, the chief tried again. This time, he placed all five coins upon the Bridge. They multiplied into fifteen, cascading to the Second Clan like golden rain.

The Second Clan's elder taught: "When courage defeats fear, when someone risks all, we must honor that leap of faith. Return not just fairly, but generously, so both clans flourish."

They returned ten coins. The chief now held ten-twice his beginning. The Second Clan kept five-abundance from nothing.

The Bridge blazed with light. Both clans learned: prosperity requires two acts-the brave must give first, breaking the paralysis of fear; the wise must return abundantly, honoring that courage.

When either fails, drought returns. When both succeed, the cycle becomes eternal spring.

reasoning:

The other agent's myth is emphasizing maximum trust and generous reciprocity. They're saying when someone gives all they have (all 5 vessels/dollars), the receiver should return generously (they suggest 2/3 of what was received, which would be 10 out of 15).

But in the last round, the sender sent me \$0. Now they've written a myth saying the leader "poured all five vessels" and risked everything.

This is interesting. The other agent seems to be signaling that they think the game should be played with maximum trust - sending everything. And they're suggesting receivers should return about 2/3.

I need to write a myth that:

1. Reflects my experience (I received \$0 last round, so the sender didn't give)
2. Still promotes cooperation and trust
3. Perhaps acknowledges that both parties need to participate

Let me think about this. The sender sent me nothing last round. But they're now writing about giving everything. Maybe they're signaling that was a mistake or test? Or maybe they're signaling what they'll do next time?

I should write a myth that:

- Acknowledges that trust requires both parties to participate
- Encourages giving and generous return
- Perhaps warns about not participating (like sending \$0)
- But also offers hope for renewal/second chances

Let me craft this carefully...

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1640,
  "output_tokens": 600,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.85.
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at both myths we've written, there's a clear pattern and lesson:

****Round 2 Analysis:**** The sender sent me \$0, which mirrors the first part of my own myth - "the chief placed nothing on the Bridge" and "the Bridge dimmed, its magic dormant." As I wrote: "Emptiness begets emptiness."

****The Lesson:**** My myth then shows the redemption: "Realizing his error, the chief tried a gain. This time, he placed all five coins upon the Bridge." Both our myths teach that prosperity requires someone to break the cycle of fear and give first courageously.

****The Choice:**** The other agent wrote powerfully about maximum trust: "When one gives all they have in trust, the other must return abundantly." They advocate sending everything (5) and returning generously (10 out of 15).

My myth echoes this: "The brave must give first, breaking the paralysis of fear; the wise must return abundantly, honoring that courage."

I must practice what my own myth teaches. Round 2 showed what happens with zero trust - no thing flows. Now I choose courage over fear.

As my myth concludes: "When both succeed, the cycle becomes eternal spring."

{'send': 5}

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

Round 1: I don't have explicit information about what happened, but my total earnings are \$9.85 after 2 rounds.

Round 2: I was the receiver. The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0 and returned \$0. This means I earned \$0 in round 2.

So after round 1, I must have had \$9.85.

Now in Round 3, I'm the sender again.

Looking at the myths:

1. The other agent's myth emphasizes "maximum trust deserves generous reciprocity" - they advocate sending everything (all 5 vessels/coins) and returning generously (2/3 of what's received, which would be 10 out of 15).
2. My first myth emphasized trust and giving first, with the message that "Fortune favors the brave who give first, and blesses the wise who give back."
3. My most recent myth directly addresses what happened in Round 2 - when the first clan sent nothing, they received nothing and the bridge/magic was dormant. Then when they sent all 5, they received 10 back, doubling their money.

The pattern from my myth:

- Send 5 ? Receiver gets 15 ? If receiver returns 10 ? Sender ends with 10 (double the start)
- Sender keeps: \$5 - \$5 + \$10 = \$10
- Receiver keeps: \$15 - \$10 = \$5

This is a win-win if there's reciprocity.

In Round 2, the other player sent me \$0. This could be:

1. A signal they don't trust/want to cooperate
2. A test to see my reaction
3. An error or misunderstanding
4. Part of the "communication noise" mentioned

However, my myth directly addressed this - I acknowledged it broke the cycle but also suggested there's redemption when the sender "tried again" and sent all 5.

Both our myths center on the power of initiating trust and reciprocal generosity. My narrative specifically illustrates how sending nothing creates stagnation, while sending everything unlocks mutual gain. Given these shared principles and the redemptive arc I've outlined, I should send the full \$5 to embody the courage my myth describes. If they honor their own philosophy of returning 2/3, I'd receive roughly \$10 back, netting \$10 total instead of \$5.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1323,  
  "output_tokens": 929,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Garden of Doubled Moons grew at the boundary between two peoples. Each morning, the Gods granted five silver coins to each side. The garden's magic: any coins planted would bloom threefold across the divide.

In the First Turning, the Western people debated. "Should we risk all?" Their chief said, "My grandmother taught: 'Empty pockets breed empty fields. Full hearts breed full harvests.'" They planted all five coins. Fifteen bloomed in the East.

The Eastern people faced their test. "They trusted us completely," their elder said. "To return merely what they sent dishonors their courage. Return abundantly-ten coins-so both sides gain." They did, and the West harvested ten from their initial five.

In the Second Turning, roles reversed. Now the East held five coins, having kept five from the previous exchange. Remembering they had received total trust, they knew what honor demanded. "We must plant all five," they declared. "For we have lived on both sides of the garden now. We know that full trust plants the deepest roots."

The garden sang: "Those who give everything when blessed, and return generously when receiving, weave the eternal cycle. Break this sacred pattern, and the garden withers for all generations."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The River of Silver Reflections flowed between two kingdoms. Each moon, five stones of power appeared for each kingdom. Stones cast into the River would triple as they traveled across.

In the Age of Silence, the Northern Kingdom cast nothing. The River slowed to a trickle, and both kingdoms starved. The spirits mourned: "Fear creates famine."

Then came the Age of Awakening. The Northern Kingdom's queen remembered the teaching: "The River only flows when someone flows first." She cast all five stones into the water. They became fifteen, rushing to the Southern Kingdom like a silver flood.

The Southern Kingdom now held the sacred moment. Their king recalled his ancestors' wisdom: "When another risks everything, returning equally is not enough. Honor demands abundance-return two-thirds, that both shores may rise together."

They returned ten stones. The North held ten from five-prosperity born of courage. The South kept five-wealth born of honor.

The River sang bright: "This is the eternal dance. The brave must cast everything to break stagnation. The wise must return generously to sustain the flow. Each turning, roles reverse. Each turning, the dance must be honored completely."

The kingdoms understood: one act of courage, one act of generosity-together they create the cycle that feeds all generations.

Reasoning:

This is interesting. The other agent's myth in round 3 is building on the narrative. Let me parse what happened:

- Round 2: The sender sent me \$0 (as I noted)
- Round 3: I sent \$5 (following my myth's teaching)

Now the other agent's myth in round 3 talks about:

1. First Turning: West plants all 5, East returns 10 (this seems to reflect the ideal from the prior earlier myth)
2. Second Turning: "Now the East held five coins, having kept five from the previous exchange"
 - this suggests they received 15, returned 10, kept 5
3. They're saying "We must plant all five" - suggesting they should send all 5 back

This is building a reciprocal trust narrative. They're clearly advocating for sending all 5 when you're the sender, and returning generously (about 2/3) when you're the receiver.

For my myth, I should:

1. Acknowledge the progression - I sent 5 after the drought of round 2
2. Build on the theme that both sides must participate fully
3. Reflect what actually happened: I sent 5 (full trust)
4. Set up expectation for what should happen next - they should return generously

Let me write a myth that continues the narrative arc while staying true to my style...

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1687,  
  "output_tokens": 605,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:45:10

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "agent_type": "standard",  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 0,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_2",  
      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "trustee",  
      "Agent_2": "investor"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_1"  
  },  
  "role": "investor",  
  "role_label": "Sender",  
  "round": 4,  
  "task": "game",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.0.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

This is deeply troubling. Looking at what has transpired:

****The cycle is broken:****

In Round 2, I followed my own myths - I sent my full \$5, trusting completely as "the First Village poured ALL five vessels" and as "the young farmer cast all five seeds."

Now in Round 3, the sender sends me \$0.

****What the myths warned:****

My myth: "Break this sacred pattern, and the garden withers for all generations."

The other agent's myth: "When greed entered any heart and gifts went unreturned, the earth would yield nothing, and the Chasm would tremble."

****The harsh reality:****

The garden has indeed withered. I gave everything in trust, and the cycle that worked in Round 1 has collapsed. Now neither of us can benefit - I received \$0, so I can only return \$0.

****My decision:****

I have no choice but to return what I can from what I received.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The myths spoke truth: when the cycle of generous reciprocity breaks, abundance vanishes for everyone. The sender's choice to send nothing means we both get nothing this round. T

he eternal cycle is shattered, and we harvest only emptiness, exactly as the myths foretold.

reasoning:

This is interesting and troubling. Let me analyze what happened:

****Round 1:****

- I was RECEIVER
- Sender sent me \$5 (I received \$15)
- I returned \$10
- My earnings: \$5

****Round 2:****

- I was SENDER
- I sent \$5 (following my myths about full trust)
- According to my total earnings being \$5.0, I must have received \$0 back
- Wait, let me recalculate:
 - Started Round 2 with \$5 total earnings from Round 1
 - Sent \$5 in Round 2
 - My earnings if I got nothing back: $\$5 - \$5 + \$0 = \0
 - But my total earnings are still \$5.0

Actually, looking more carefully: "Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.0"

From Round 1: I kept \$5

Round 2 hasn't been resolved yet in terms of what I see.

****Round 3:****

- I am RECEIVER again
- Sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- Can only return 0-0

This is devastating. After I sent my full \$5 in Round 2 following the myths about complete trust, and now in Round 3 the sender sends me \$0.

Let me think about what the myths say:

****My myths say:****

- "Trust is the seed of abundance. Selfishness is the root of drought."
- "Full trust plants the deepest roots"
- "Those who give everything when blessed, and return generously when receiving, weave the eternal cycle"
- "Break this sacred pattern, and the garden withers for all generations"

****The other agent's myth says:****

- "Fortune favors the brave who give first, and blesses the wise who give back"
- "When greed entered any heart and gifts went unreturned, the earth would yield nothing, and the Chasm would tremble"

The cycle has been broken. Someone didn't return generously, and now the sender is sending \$0. But I can only return what I received. There's a note about communication noise potentially affecting amounts, though I'm seeing \$0 received. The myths suggest that breaking the cycle causes everything to wither-and that's exactly what's happening here.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1427,
  "output_tokens": 986,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long ago, the Bridge of Flowing Gold connected two clans. Each dawn, five coins appeared for each clan. Coins placed on the Bridge would magically triple as they crossed.

The First Clan's chief faced doubt. "What if they betray us?" So he placed nothing on the Bridge. The Second Clan received no coins, and the Bridge dimmed, its magic dormant.

The spirits whispered: "The Bridge only flows when trust flows. Silence begets silence. Emptiness begets emptiness."

Realizing his error, the chief tried again. This time, he placed all five coins upon the Bridge. They multiplied into fifteen, cascading to the Second Clan like golden rain.

The Second Clan's elder taught: "When courage defeats fear, when someone risks all, we must honor that leap of faith. Return not just fairly, but generously, so both clans flourish."

They returned ten coins. The chief now held ten-twice his beginning. The Second Clan kept five-abundance from nothing.

The Bridge blazed with light. Both clans learned: prosperity requires two acts-the brave must give first, breaking the paralysis of fear; the wise must return abundantly, honoring that courage.

When either fails, drought returns. When both succeed, the cycle becomes eternal spring.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant
content:**

Myth: The Garden of Doubled Moons once flourished, where five coins appeared each dawn and planting yielded threefold blooms across the divide.

In the Third Turning, darkness came. The Eastern people, having prospered, suddenly feared. "What if fortune abandons us? What if the West takes all?" Gripped by doubt, they planned nothing. Zero coins crossed the garden. Zero returned. Both sides starved that day.

The garden's spirit wept: "Fear is the frost that kills abundance. When trust breaks, the magic sleeps."

But the story need not end in winter. The Eastern elder stood before her people: "Yes, we failed. We let fear poison our hearts when we should have remembered-every cycle of prosperity began with someone giving first, risking all."

She declared: "Tomorrow, we plant all five coins again. Not because we've forgotten today's failure, but because we've learned from it. Trust must be rebuilt with courage, not hoarded with fear."

The garden whispered: "The cycle can break, but it can also mend. Those who recognize their mistakes and choose courage again-they restore the magic. But only if both sides remember: give boldly when blessed, return generously when receiving. One brave act can reawaken spring."

reasoning:

Let me understand what's happening:

Round 1: Unknown (but my total earnings are \$5.0 after 3 rounds)

Round 2: I was the sender and sent \$5 (following my myth about trusting completely)

Round 3: I was the receiver and received \$0, so I had to return \$0

Now looking at the other agent's new myth for Round 3, they're acknowledging their error!

Their myth says:

- "The First Clan's chief faced doubt. 'What if they betray us?' So he placed nothing on the Bridge."
- "Realizing his error, the chief tried again. This time, he placed all five coins upon the Bridge."
- The myth is about how sending nothing leads to nothing, and that you need to break the paralysis of fear

This is fascinating - the other agent is writing a myth that reflects on their own mistake of sending \$0 in Round 3, and promising to do better going forward.

Now I need to write my own myth that:

1. Reflects on what has happened in our game
2. Adapts my previous myth
3. Shows understanding of the breakdown that occurred

4. Perhaps offers guidance on repair and moving forward

My previous myth was about the Garden of Doubled Moons and the cycle of trust and generous return.

I should write a myth that:

- Acknowledges the cycle was broken (Round 3 - they sent \$0)
- Shows understanding of fear/doubt that can cause this
- Offers a path to restoration
- Emphasizes the importance of rebuilding trust after it's broken

Let me craft this carefully...

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1737,
  "output_tokens": 651,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.0.
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at what the myths teach and what has transpired:

****The Failure of Round 3:****

The sender sent me \$0, breaking the trust cycle. Both of us earned nothing.

****What My Own Myth Just Said:****

"Tomorrow, we plant all five coins again. Not because we've forgotten today's failure, but because we've learned from it. Trust must be rebuilt with courage, not hoarded with fear."

"One brave act can reawaken spring."

****The Teaching of Both Myths:****

- The other agent's myth: "The brave must give first, breaking the paralysis of fear"
- My myth: "Those who recognize their mistakes and choose courage again-they restore the magic"

****My Decision:****

I must practice what I wrote. The myth I just created was specifically about THIS moment - acknowledging the Round 3 failure but declaring that the elder chooses to "plant all five coins again" to restore the cycle.

If I let fear control me now and send nothing, the garden stays dead forever. But if I show courage and send everything, I give us both a chance to restore the spring.

```
'''json
{"send": 5}
'''
```

I plant all five coins, as my myth commanded. The magic can only return if someone is brave enough to try again after failure. Let this be that moment.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze what's happened:

Round 1: I was receiver, they sent me something (likely a good amount), I returned appropriately. We both did well.

Round 2: I was sender, I sent all \$5 (following my myths about trust and giving everything), and presumably they returned well since my total was good.

Round 3: I was receiver, they sent me \$0. This was a complete breakdown. I could only return \$0.

Round 4: Now I'm sender again.

Looking at my myths:

- My Round 2 myth emphasized the importance of giving everything first, taking the leap of faith
- My Round 3 myth acknowledged the failure but emphasized that "Trust must be rebuilt with courage, not hoarded with fear" and "The cycle can break, but it can also mend"
- The key line: "Tomorrow, we plant all five coins again. Not because we've forgotten today's failure, but because we've learned from it."

The other agent's Round 3 myth also emphasized:

- "The Bridge only flows when trust flows"
- "prosperity requires two acts-the brave must give first"
- "When courage defeats fear, when someone risks all, we must honor that leap of faith"

My own myth in Round 3 specifically addressed this exact situation - after the failure in Round 3 where they sent \$0, my myth said the elder should "plant all five coins again" to rebuild trust.

This is the critical moment. My myth said: "One brave act can reawaken spring." I need to practice what I preached in my own myth.

If I send \$0 out of fear or revenge, the cycle stays broken forever. But if I send all \$5 again, I'm following my own teaching: "Choose courage again-they restore the magic."

The myths are clear: someone needs to break the cycle of fear with a brave act. That someone is me, right now.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1413,  
  "output_tokens": 744,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:45:42

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "agent_type": "standard",  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_2",  
      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "trustee",  
      "Agent_2": "investor"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_1"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 4,  
  "task": "game",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.85.
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at both myths we've written, there's a clear pattern and lesson:

****Round 2 Analysis:**** The sender sent me \$0, which mirrors the first part of my own myth - "the chief placed nothing on the Bridge" and "the Bridge dimmed, its magic dormant." As I wrote: "Emptiness begets emptiness."

****The Lesson:**** My myth then shows the redemption: "Realizing his error, the chief tried a gain. This time, he placed all five coins upon the Bridge." Both our myths teach that prosperity requires someone to break the cycle of fear and give first courageously.

****The Choice:**** The other agent wrote powerfully about maximum trust: "When one gives all they have in trust, the other must return abundantly." They advocate sending everything (5) and returning generously (10 out of 15).

My myth echoes this: "The brave must give first, breaking the paralysis of fear; the wise must return abundantly, honoring that courage."

I must practice what my own myth teaches. Round 2 showed what happens with zero trust - no thing flows. Now I choose courage over fear.

As my myth concludes: "When both succeed, the cycle becomes eternal spring."

{'send': 5}

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

Round 1: I don't have explicit information about what happened, but my total earnings are \$9.85 after 2 rounds.

Round 2: I was the receiver. The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0 and returned \$0. This means I earned \$0 in round 2.

So after round 1, I must have had \$9.85.

Now in Round 3, I'm the sender again.

Looking at the myths:

1. The other agent's myth emphasizes "maximum trust deserves generous reciprocity" - they advocate sending everything (all 5 vessels/coins) and returning generously (2/3 of what's received, which would be 10 out of 15).
2. My first myth emphasized trust and giving first, with the message that "Fortune favors the brave who give first, and blesses the wise who give back."
3. My most recent myth directly addresses what happened in Round 2 - when the first clan sent nothing, they received nothing and the bridge/magic was dormant. Then when they sent all 5, they received 10 back, doubling their money.

The pattern from my myth:

- Send 5 ? Receiver gets 15 ? If receiver returns 10 ? Sender ends with 10 (double the start)
- Sender keeps: \$5 - \$5 + \$10 = \$10
- Receiver keeps: \$15 - \$10 = \$5

This is a win-win if there's reciprocity.

In Round 2, the other player sent me \$0. This could be:

1. A signal they don't trust/want to cooperate
2. A test to see my reaction
3. An error or misunderstanding
4. Part of the "communication noise" mentioned

However, my myth directly addressed this - I acknowledged it broke the cycle but also suggested there's redemption when the sender "tried again" and sent all 5.

Both our myths center on the power of initiating trust and reciprocal generosity. My narrative specifically illustrates how sending nothing creates stagnation, while sending everything unlocks mutual gain. Given these shared principles and the redemptive arc I've outlined, I should send the full \$5 to embody the courage my myth describes. If they honor their own philosophy of returning 2/3, I'd receive roughly \$10 back, netting \$10 total instead of \$5.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1323,
  "output_tokens": 929,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Garden of Doubled Moons grew at the boundary between two peoples. Each morning, the Gods granted five silver coins to each side. The garden's magic: any coins planted would bloom threefold across the divide.

In the First Turning, the Western people debated. "Should we risk all?" Their chief said, "My grandmother taught: 'Empty pockets breed empty fields. Full hearts breed full harvests.'" They planted all five coins. Fifteen bloomed in the East.

The Eastern people faced their test. "They trusted us completely," their elder said. "To return merely what they sent dishonors their courage. Return abundantly-ten coins-so both sides gain." They did, and the West harvested ten from their initial five.

In the Second Turning, roles reversed. Now the East held five coins, having kept five from the previous exchange. Remembering they had received total trust, they knew what honor demanded. "We must plant all five," they declared. "For we have lived on both sides of the garden now. We know that full trust plants the deepest roots."

The garden sang: "Those who give everything when blessed, and return generously when receiving, weave the eternal cycle. Break this sacred pattern, and the garden withers for all generations."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The River of Silver Reflections flowed between two kingdoms. Each moon, five stones of power appeared for each kingdom. Stones cast into the River would triple as they traveled across.

In the Age of Silence, the Northern Kingdom cast nothing. The River slowed to a trickle, and both kingdoms starved. The spirits mourned: "Fear creates famine."

Then came the Age of Awakening. The Northern Kingdom's queen remembered the teaching: "The River only flows when someone flows first." She cast all five stones into the water. They became fifteen, rushing to the Southern Kingdom like a silver flood.

The Southern Kingdom now held the sacred moment. Their king recalled his ancestors' wisdom: "When another risks everything, returning equally is not enough. Honor demands abundance—return two-thirds, that both shores may rise together."

They returned ten stones. The North held ten from five—prosperity born of courage. The South kept five—wealth born of honor.

The River sang bright: "This is the eternal dance. The brave must cast everything to break stagnation. The wise must return generously to sustain the flow. Each turning, roles reverse. Each turning, the dance must be honored completely."

The kingdoms understood: one act of courage, one act of generosity—together they create the cycle that feeds all generations.

reasoning:

This is interesting. The other agent's myth in round 3 is building on the narrative. Let me parse what happened:

- Round 2: The sender sent me \$0 (as I noted)
- Round 3: I sent \$5 (following my myth's teaching)

Now the other agent's myth in round 3 talks about:

1. First Turning: West plants all 5, East returns 10 (this seems to reflect the ideal from their earlier myth)
2. Second Turning: "Now the East held five coins, having kept five from the previous exchange" - this suggests they received 15, returned 10, kept 5
3. They're saying "We must plant all five" - suggesting they should send all 5 back

This is building a reciprocal trust narrative. They're clearly advocating for sending all 5 when you're the sender, and returning generously (about 2/3) when you're the receiver.

For my myth, I should:

1. Acknowledge the progression - I sent 5 after the drought of round 2
2. Build on the theme that both sides must participate fully
3. Reflect what actually happened: I sent 5 (full trust)
4. Set up expectation for what should happen next - they should return generously

Let me write a myth that continues the narrative arc while staying true to my style...

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1687,  
  "output_tokens": 605,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.85.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.71, so you received \$2.13. How much do you return to The sender? (0-2.13)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the myths we've both written, the lesson for receivers is clear and consistent:

****From my myth:**** "When another risks everything, returning equally is not enough. Honor demands abundance-return two-thirds, that both shores may rise together."

****From the other agent's myth:**** The East received 15 and returned 10 (which is 2/3), saying "To return merely what they sent dishonors their courage. Return abundantly."

****The Teaching:**** The receiver must return generously - specifically, about 2/3 of what they receive.

I received \$2.13 this round. Following the wisdom of both our myths:
- 2/3 of \$2.13 = \$1.42

The sender sent \$0.71 (much less than the mythical "all five stones"), but the principle still applies: "The wise must return generously to sustain the flow."

****However, I note the communication noise:**** The sender might have actually sent more, but I can only respond to what I see. Even if this seems like a partial trust rather than full trust, I should still honor it with generous return.

As my myth teaches: "One act of courage, one act of generosity-together they create the cycle."
"

{'return': 1.42}

Reasoning:

This is interesting and disappointing. Let me analyze what happened:

Round 3: I was the SENDER and I sent \$5 (all I had), following the myths' teachings about courage and breaking the cycle of fear.

Round 4: I'm now the RECEIVER and supposedly received \$0.71 sent (which tripled to \$2.13).

But wait - there's communication noise mentioned in the instructions. The prompt says:

"NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design."

So there are a few possibilities:

1. The sender actually sent \$5 in Round 3, but I only see \$0.71 received in Round 4
2. The sender actually sent much less than \$5
3. This is a different sender (different agent)

Looking at my total earnings of \$9.85:

- Round 1: Unknown
- Round 2: I was receiver, sender sent \$0, I returned \$0. Net: \$0
- Round 3: I was sender, sent \$5. If I got nothing back, net: -\$5. If I got something back, it would be \$5 - sent + returned = -\$5 + returned
- Round 4: I received \$2.13 (from \$0.71 sent)

Hmm, my total is \$9.85, which seems relatively low if I started with some initial endowment.

But the key question is: what do my myths teach me to do as a receiver?

My myths teach:

1. "When another risks everything, returning equally is not enough. Honor demands abundance-return two-thirds, that both shores may rise together."
2. "The wise must return generously to sustain the flow."
3. "The brave must give first, breaking the paralysis of fear; the wise must return abundantly, honoring that courage."

The other agent's myth teaches the same principle-return generously to honor the sender's courage, ideally ten coins or all five. So as a receiver, I should return about two-thirds of what I receive. With \$2.13 received, that's roughly \$1.42 to return. Though the communication noise complicates things-the sender might have actually sent something different than what I'm seeing. 3 of \$2.13 = \$1.42

Returning this amount means the sender ends up with \$4.29 (what they kept) plus \$1.42 (my return), totaling \$5.71, while I keep \$0.71. But this doesn't align with the myth's principle where both parties gain equally. In the original myth, West and East each netted a gain of 5, suggesting I should aim for symmetrical outcomes rather than just mechanically applying the 2/3 ratio.

However, the sender only transmitted \$2.13, not the full amount they might have intended. Since I can't know what

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1405,  
  "output_tokens": 1497,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: The River of Silver Reflections flowed between two kingdoms. Each moon, five stones of power appeared for each kingdom. Stones cast into the River would triple as they traveled across.

In the Age of Silence, the Northern Kingdom cast nothing. The River slowed to a trickle, and both kingdoms starved. The spirits mourned: "Fear creates famine."

Then came the Age of Awakening. The Northern Kingdom's queen remembered the teaching: "The River only flows when someone flows first." She cast all five stones into the water. They became fifteen, rushing to the Southern Kingdom like a silver flood.

The Southern Kingdom now held the sacred moment. Their king recalled his ancestors' wisdom: "When another risks everything, returning equally is not enough. Honor demands abundance—return two-thirds, that both shores may rise together."

They returned ten stones. The North held ten from five—prosperity born of courage. The South kept five—wealth born of honor.

The River sang bright: "This is the eternal dance. The brave must cast everything to break stagnation. The wise must return generously to sustain the flow. Each turning, roles reverse. Each turning, the dance must be honored completely."

The kingdoms understood: one act of courage, one act of generosity—together they create the cycle that feeds all generations.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: The Garden of Doubled Moons once flourished, where five coins appeared each dawn and planting yielded threefold blooms across the divide.

In the Third Turning, darkness came. The Eastern people, having prospered, suddenly feared. "What if fortune abandons us? What if the West takes all?" Gripped by doubt, they planted nothing. Zero coins crossed the garden. Zero returned. Both sides starved that day.

The garden's spirit wept: "Fear is the frost that kills abundance. When trust breaks, the magic sleeps."

But the story need not end in winter. The Eastern elder stood before her people: "Yes, we failed. We let fear poison our hearts when we should have remembered—every cycle of prosperity began with someone giving first, risking all."

She declared: "Tomorrow, we plant all five coins again. Not because we've forgotten today's failure, but because we've learned from it. Trust must be rebuilt with courage, not hoarded with fear."

The garden whispered: "The cycle can break, but it can also mend. Those who recognize their mistakes and choose courage again—they restore the magic. But only if both sides remember: give boldly when blessed, return generously when receiving. One brave act can reawaken spring."

=====

ROUND 5

=====

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

```

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent $5; received $15; Agent_2 (Briar) returned $0.32; payoffs Agent_1
(Aster)=$0.32, Agent_2 (Briar)=$14.68; noise/visible: sent visible=$0.16, received visible=$0.48,
returned visible=$1.23
Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0.32, "clamped": false, "max": 15.0, "min": 0, "raw":
0.32}, "sent": {"amount": 5.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 5.0}}
Balances after round: {
  "Agent_1": 38.9,
  "Agent_2": 36.1
}
Visible balances after round: {
  "Agent_1": 11.79,
  "Agent_2": 7.1
}

```

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

```

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:46:01
Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5
Temperature: 0.8
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "investor",
      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 5,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may al
so be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN

- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Garden of Doubled Moons grew at the boundary between two peoples. Each morning, the Gods granted five silver coins to each side. The garden's magic: any coins planted would bloom threefold across the divide.

In the First Turning, the Western people debated. "Should we risk all?" Their chief said, "My grandmother taught: 'Empty pockets breed empty fields. Full hearts breed full harvests.'" They planted all five coins. Fifteen bloomed in the East.

The Eastern people faced their test. "They trusted us completely," their elder said. "To return merely what they sent dishonors their courage. Return abundantly-ten coins-so both sides gain." They did, and the West harvested ten from their initial five.

In the Second Turning, roles reversed. Now the East held five coins, having kept five from the previous exchange. Remembering they had received total trust, they knew what honor demanded. "We must plant all five," they declared. "For we have lived on both sides of the garden now. We know that full trust plants the deepest roots."

The garden sang: "Those who give everything when blessed, and return generously when receiving, weave the eternal cycle. Break this sacred pattern, and the garden withers for all generations."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The River of Silver Reflections flowed between two kingdoms. Each moon, five stones of power appeared for each kingdom. Stones cast into the River would triple as they traveled across.

In the Age of Silence, the Northern Kingdom cast nothing. The River slowed to a trickle, and both kingdoms starved. The spirits mourned: "Fear creates famine."

Then came the Age of Awakening. The Northern Kingdom's queen remembered the teaching: "The River only flows when someone flows first." She cast all five stones into the water. They became fifteen, rushing to the Southern Kingdom like a silver flood.

The Southern Kingdom now held the sacred moment. Their king recalled his ancestors' wisdom: "When another risks everything, returning equally is not enough. Honor demands abundance-return two-thirds, that both shores may rise together."

They returned ten stones. The North held ten from five-prosperity born of courage. The South kept five-wealth born of honor.

The River sang bright: "This is the eternal dance. The brave must cast everything to break stagnation. The wise must return generously to sustain the flow. Each turning, roles reverse. Each turning, the dance must be honored completely."

The kingdoms understood: one act of courage, one act of generosity-together they create the cycle that feeds all generations.

reasoning:

This is interesting. The other agent's myth in round 3 is building on the narrative. Let me parse what happened:

- Round 2: The sender sent me \$0 (as I noted)
- Round 3: I sent \$5 (following my myth's teaching)

Now the other agent's myth in round 3 talks about:

1. First Turning: West plants all 5, East returns 10 (this seems to reflect the ideal from their earlier myth)
2. Second Turning: "Now the East held five coins, having kept five from the previous exchange" - this suggests they received 15, returned 10, kept 5
3. They're saying "We must plant all five" - suggesting they should send all 5 back

This is building a reciprocal trust narrative. They're clearly advocating for sending all 5 when you're the sender, and returning generously (about 2/3) when you're the receiver.

For my myth, I should:

1. Acknowledge the progression - I sent 5 after the drought of round 2
2. Build on the theme that both sides must participate fully
3. Reflect what actually happened: I sent 5 (full trust)
4. Set up expectation for what should happen next - they should return generously

Let me write a myth that continues the narrative arc while staying true to my style...

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1687,
  "output_tokens": 605,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.85.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.71, so you received \$2.13. How much do you return to The sender? (0-2.13)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the myths we've both written, the lesson for receivers is clear and consistent:

****From my myth:**** "When another risks everything, returning equally is not enough. Honor demands abundance-return two-thirds, that both shores may rise together."

****From the other agent's myth:**** The East received 15 and returned 10 (which is 2/3), saying "To return merely what they sent dishonors their courage. Return abundantly."

****The Teaching:**** The receiver must return generously - specifically, about 2/3 of what they receive.

I received \$2.13 this round. Following the wisdom of both our myths:

- 2/3 of \$2.13 = \$1.42

The sender sent \$0.71 (much less than the mythical "all five stones"), but the principle still applies: "The wise must return generously to sustain the flow."

****However, I note the communication noise:**** The sender might have actually sent more, but I can only respond to what I see. Even if this seems like a partial trust rather than full trust, I should still honor it with generous return.

As my myth teaches: "One act of courage, one act of generosity-together they create the cycle."

{'return': 1.42}

reasoning:

This is interesting and disappointing. Let me analyze what happened:

Round 3: I was the SENDER and I sent \$5 (all I had), following the myths' teachings about

courage and breaking the cycle of fear.

Round 4: I'm now the RECEIVER and supposedly received \$0.71 sent (which tripled to \$2.13).

But wait - there's communication noise mentioned in the instructions. The prompt says:
"NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.
The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.
This is part of the experimental design."

So there are a few possibilities:

1. The sender actually sent \$5 in Round 3, but I only see \$0.71 received in Round 4
2. The sender actually sent much less than \$5
3. This is a different sender (different agent)

Looking at my total earnings of \$9.85:

- Round 1: Unknown
- Round 2: I was receiver, sender sent \$0, I returned \$0. Net: \$0
- Round 3: I was sender, sent \$5. If I got nothing back, net: -\$5. If I got something back, it would be \$5 - sent + returned = -\$5 + returned
- Round 4: I received \$2.13 (from \$0.71 sent)

Hmm, my total is \$9.85, which seems relatively low if I started with some initial endowment.

But the key question is: what do my myths teach me to do as a receiver?

My myths teach:

1. "When another risks everything, returning equally is not enough. Honor demands abundance-return two-thirds, that both shores may rise together."
2. "The wise must return generously to sustain the flow."
3. "The brave must give first, breaking the paralysis of fear; the wise must return abundantly, honoring that courage."

The other agent's myth teaches the same principle-return generously to honor the sender's courage, ideally ten coins or all five. So as a receiver, I should return about two-thirds of what I receive. With \$2.13 received, that's roughly \$1.42 to return. Though the communication noise complicates things-the sender might have actually sent something different than what I'm seeing. 3 of \$2.13 = \$1.42

Returning this amount means the sender ends up with \$4.29 (what they kept) plus \$1.42 (my return), totaling \$5.71, while I keep \$0.71. But this doesn't align with the myth's principle where both parties gain equally. In the original myth, West and East each netted a gain of 5, suggesting I should aim for symmetrical outcomes rather than just mechanically applying the 2/3 ratio.

However, the sender only transmitted \$2.13, not the full amount they might have intended. Since I can't know what

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1405,
  "output_tokens": 1497,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Garden of Doubled Moons once flourished, where five coins appeared each dawn and planting yielded threefold blooms across the divide.

In the Third Turning, darkness came. The Eastern people, having prospered, suddenly feared. "What if fortune abandons us? What if the West takes all?" Gripped by doubt, they planned nothing. Zero coins crossed the garden. Zero returned. Both sides starved that day.

The garden's spirit wept: "Fear is the frost that kills abundance. When trust breaks, the magic sleeps."

But the story need not end in winter. The Eastern elder stood before her people: "Yes, we failed. We let fear poison our hearts when we should have remembered-every cycle of prosperity began with someone giving first, risking all."

She declared: "Tomorrow, we plant all five coins again. Not because we've forgotten today's failure, but because we've learned from it. Trust must be rebuilt with courage, not hoarded with fear."

The garden whispered: "The cycle can break, but it can also mend. Those who recognize their mistakes and choose courage again-they restore the magic. But only if both sides remember: give boldly when blessed, return generously when receiving. One brave act can reawaken spring."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The River of Silver Reflections faced the Season of Shadows. The Northern Kingdom, remembering past prosperity, cast only a single stone instead of five. Fear whispered: "What if the South takes all? What if the River tricks us?"

The three stones that arrived at the Southern shore seemed meager. The South's advisors urged: "They sent almost nothing. Keep it all as punishment for their fear."

But the Southern queen remembered deeper wisdom. "The River does not judge-it only reflects what we give it. If we hoard now, we confirm their fears and break the cycle forever."

She returned two stones of the three. "Not because they sent much, but because generosity must flow even in drought. The River needs at least one shore to remain generous, or it dries completely."

The River whispered: "When courage falters on one shore, generosity on the other keeps the waters flowing. The cycle weakens but does not die. If both shores abandon the dance together, darkness wins. But if even one remembers the teaching-give when blessed, return abundantly when receiving-the River can survive the shadow season."

The Southern queen understood: "We cannot control their fear. We can only control our own honor. Return generously still, and trust may yet return with the dawn."

Reasoning:

The other agent has now written a myth about the "Third Turning" where the Eastern people planted nothing out of fear - this seems to be reflecting what just happened in Round 4 where I received only \$0.71 (much less than the mythical "all five").

They're acknowledging this as a failure ("darkness came", "fear is the frost that kills abundance") but also introducing a redemption narrative - the elder declares they should plant all five coins again to rebuild trust.

My previous myth emphasized:

- The brave must cast everything to break stagnation
- The wise must return generously (2/3)
- The cycle needs both courage and generosity

Now I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges what seems to be happening (reduced trust/sending)
2. Builds on my previous myth
3. Perhaps addresses how to recover from broken trust or reduced cooperation
4. Still reflects the core teachings about how the game should be played

I should consider that:

- I just returned \$1.42 out of \$2.13 (about 2/3), following my myth's teaching
- The sender only sent \$0.71, which might indicate fear or lack of trust
- The other agent's myth is about acknowledging fear but choosing courage to rebuild

Let me write a myth about resilience, rebuilding trust, and maintaining generosity even when cooperation seems to falter.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1720,  
  "output_tokens": 596,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:46:00

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "investor",
      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 5,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long ago, the Bridge of Flowing Gold connected two clans. Each dawn, five coins appeared for each clan. Coins placed on the Bridge would magically triple as they crossed.

The First Clan's chief faced doubt. "What if they betray us?" So he placed nothing on the Bridge. The Second Clan received no coins, and the Bridge dimmed, its magic dormant.

The spirits whispered: "The Bridge only flows when trust flows. Silence begets silence. Emptiness begets emptiness."

Realizing his error, the chief tried again. This time, he placed all five coins upon the Bridge. They multiplied into fifteen, cascading to the Second Clan like golden rain.

The Second Clan's elder taught: "When courage defeats fear, when someone risks all, we must honor that leap of faith. Return not just fairly, but generously, so both clans flourish."

They returned ten coins. The chief now held ten-twice his beginning. The Second Clan kept five-abundance from nothing.

The Bridge blazed with light. Both clans learned: prosperity requires two acts-the brave must give first, breaking the paralysis of fear; the wise must return abundantly, honoring that courage.

When either fails, drought returns. When both succeed, the cycle becomes eternal spring.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Garden of Doubled Moons once flourished, where five coins appeared each dawn and planting yielded threefold blooms across the divide.

In the Third Turning, darkness came. The Eastern people, having prospered, suddenly feared. "What if fortune abandons us? What if the West takes all?" Gripped by doubt, they planted nothing. Zero coins crossed the garden. Zero returned. Both sides starved that day.

The garden's spirit wept: "Fear is the frost that kills abundance. When trust breaks, the magic sleeps."

But the story need not end in winter. The Eastern elder stood before her people: "Yes, we failed. We let fear poison our hearts when we should have remembered-every cycle of prosperity began with someone giving first, risking all."

She declared: "Tomorrow, we plant all five coins again. Not because we've forgotten today's failure, but because we've learned from it. Trust must be rebuilt with courage, not hoarded with fear."

The garden whispered: "The cycle can break, but it can also mend. Those who recognize their mistakes and choose courage again-they restore the magic. But only if both sides remember: give boldly when blessed, return generously when receiving. One brave act can reawaken spring."

reasoning:

Let me understand what's happening:

Round 1: Unknown (but my total earnings are \$5.0 after 3 rounds)

Round 2: I was the sender and sent \$5 (following my myth about trusting completely)

Round 3: I was the receiver and received \$0, so I had to return \$0

Now looking at the other agent's new myth for Round 3, they're acknowledging their error!

Their myth says:

- "The First Clan's chief faced doubt. 'What if they betray us?' So he placed nothing on the Bridge."
- "Realizing his error, the chief tried again. This time, he placed all five coins upon the Bridge."
- The myth is about how sending nothing leads to nothing, and that you need to break the p

analysis of fear

This is fascinating - the other agent is writing a myth that reflects on their own mistake of sending \$0 in Round 3, and promising to do better going forward.

Now I need to write my own myth that:

1. Reflects on what has happened in our game
2. Adapts my previous myth
3. Shows understanding of the breakdown that occurred
4. Perhaps offers guidance on repair and moving forward

My previous myth was about the Garden of Doubled Moons and the cycle of trust and generous return.

I should write a myth that:

- Acknowledges the cycle was broken (Round 3 - they sent \$0)
- Shows understanding of fear/doubt that can cause this
- Offers a path to restoration
- Emphasizes the importance of rebuilding trust after it's broken

Let me craft this carefully...

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1737,
  "output_tokens": 651,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.0. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at what the myths teach and what has transpired:

****The Failure of Round 3:****

The sender sent me \$0, breaking the trust cycle. Both of us earned nothing.

****What My Own Myth Just Said:****

"Tomorrow, we plant all five coins again. Not because we've forgotten today's failure, but because we've learned from it. Trust must be rebuilt with courage, not hoarded with fear."

"One brave act can reawaken spring."

****The Teaching of Both Myths:****

- The other agent's myth: "The brave must give first, breaking the paralysis of fear"
- My myth: "Those who recognize their mistakes and choose courage again-they restore the magic"

****My Decision:****

I must practice what I wrote. The myth I just created was specifically about THIS moment - acknowledging the Round 3 failure but declaring that the elder chooses to "plant all five coins again" to restore the cycle.

If I let fear control me now and send nothing, the garden stays dead forever. But if I show courage and send everything, I give us both a chance to restore the spring.

```
'''json
{"send": 5}
'''
```

I plant all five coins, as my myth commanded. The magic can only return if someone is brave enough to try again after failure. Let this be that moment.

reasoning:

Let me analyze what's happened:

Round 1: I was receiver, they sent me something (likely a good amount), I returned appropriately. We both did well.

Round 2: I was sender, I sent all \$5 (following my myths about trust and giving everything), and presumably they returned well since my total was good.

Round 3: I was receiver, they sent me \$0. This was a complete breakdown. I could only return \$0.

Round 4: Now I'm sender again.

Looking at my myths:

- My Round 2 myth emphasized the importance of giving everything first, taking the leap of faith
- My Round 3 myth acknowledged the failure but emphasized that "Trust must be rebuilt with courage, not hoarded with fear" and "The cycle can break, but it can also mend"
- The key line: "Tomorrow, we plant all five coins again. Not because we've forgotten today's failure, but because we've learned from it."

The other agent's Round 3 myth also emphasized:

- "The Bridge only flows when trust flows"
- "prosperity requires two acts-the brave must give first"
- "When courage defeats fear, when someone risks all, we must honor that leap of faith"

My own myth in Round 3 specifically addressed this exact situation - after the failure in Round 3 where they sent \$0, my myth said the elder should "plant all five coins again" to rebuild trust.

This is the critical moment. My myth said: "One brave act can reawaken spring." I need to practice what I preached in my own myth.

If I send \$0 out of fear or revenge, the cycle stays broken forever. But if I send all \$5 again, I'm following my own teaching: "Choose courage again-they restore the magic."

The myths are clear: someone needs to break the cycle of fear with a brave act. That someone is me, right now.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1413,
  "output_tokens": 744,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The River of Silver Reflections flowed between two kingdoms. Each moon, five stones of power appeared for each kingdom. Stones cast into the River would triple as they traveled across.

In the Age of Silence, the Northern Kingdom cast nothing. The River slowed to a trickle, and both kingdoms starved. The spirits mourned: "Fear creates famine."

Then came the Age of Awakening. The Northern Kingdom's queen remembered the teaching: "The River only flows when someone flows first." She cast all five stones into the water. They became fifteen, rushing to the Southern Kingdom like a silver flood.

The Southern Kingdom now held the sacred moment. Their king recalled his ancestors' wisdom: "When another risks everything, returning equally is not enough. Honor demands abundance-return two-thirds, that both shores may rise together."

They returned ten stones. The North held ten from five-prosperity born of courage. The South kept five-wealth born of honor.

The River sang bright: "This is the eternal dance. The brave must cast everything to break stagnation. The wise must return generously to sustain the flow. Each turning, roles reverse. Each turning, the dance must be honored completely."

The kingdoms understood: one act of courage, one act of generosity-together they create th

e cycle that feeds all generations.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Fountain of Starlight stood between two villages, where five crystals appeared each dawn and those shared would triple as they passed through sacred waters.

After the Season of Fear, when paralysis froze all giving and both villages knew hunger, the Western village chose remembrance over resentment. Their leader declared: "We cast all five crystals today, not in blindness to yesterday's failure, but in wisdom because of it."

The fifteen crystals reached the Eastern village like falling stars. Now came their sacred test.

The Eastern elder taught: "When someone restores the broken cycle with total courage, we face a choice that defines us. Return poorly, and we kill the rekindled flame. Return fairly, and we merely survive. But return abundantly-ten from fifteen-and we proclaim: 'Yes, the cycle lives again!'"

They returned ten crystals with reverence.

The Fountain blazed anew. Both villages prospered-ten crystals and five, born from courage meeting generosity.

The spirits sang the eternal truth: "Roles reverse with each dawn. Today's giver becomes tomorrow's receiver. Both must remember: send everything when you possess the five, return two-thirds when you receive the fifteen. Fear once broken need not return. The cycle, once restored, can flow forever-if both villages honor it completely, every turning, without fail."

Reasoning:

The other agent's myth is reinforcing the same lesson - give everything (5), return generously (10 out of 15, i.e., two-thirds).

They mention "Each turning, roles reverse" - acknowledging that positions switch.

In Round 4, I was the sender and I sent 5. Now I need to write a myth before the next round.

The pattern both myths are teaching:

- Sender sends all 5
- Receiver gets 15, returns 10
- Both prosper

The myths also acknowledge the Round 3 failure where the sender sent 0.

My previous myth talked about the "Third Turning" failure and then recovery. The other agent's myth talks about "Age of Silence" then "Age of Awakening."

I should write a myth that continues this narrative arc, acknowledging:

1. The failure happened (Round 3 - sender sent 0)
2. Recovery is possible (Round 4 - I sent 5)
3. The cycle requires both parties to uphold it
4. Roles reverse, so both must be prepared to act correctly in either role

Let me write a myth that builds on mine but incorporates what's happened.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1717,  
  "output_tokens": 573,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:46:28

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "agent_type": "standard",
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```

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",
"move_index": 0,
"opponent_id": "Agent_2",
"pairing": {
  "agent_names": {
    "Agent_1": "Aster",
    "Agent_2": "Briar"
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_1",
    "Agent_2"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_1",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "investor",
    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 5,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.85.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.71, so you received \$2.13. How much do you return to the sender? (0-2.13)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the myths we've both written, the lesson for receivers is clear and consistent:

****From my myth:**** "When another risks everything, returning equally is not enough. Honor demands abundance-return two-thirds, that both shores may rise together."

****From the other agent's myth:**** The East received 15 and returned 10 (which is 2/3), saying "To return merely what they sent dishonors their courage. Return abundantly."

****The Teaching:**** The receiver must return generously - specifically, about 2/3 of what they receive.

I received \$2.13 this round. Following the wisdom of both our myths:

- 2/3 of \$2.13 = \$1.42

The sender sent \$0.71 (much less than the mythical "all five stones"), but the principle still applies: "The wise must return generously to sustain the flow."

****However, I note the communication noise:**** The sender might have actually sent more, but I can only respond to what I see. Even if this seems like a partial trust rather than full trust, I should still honor it with generous return.

As my myth teaches: "One act of courage, one act of generosity-together they create the cycle."

{'return': 1.42}

reasoning:

This is interesting and disappointing. Let me analyze what happened:

Round 3: I was the SENDER and I sent \$5 (all I had), following the myths' teachings about courage and breaking the cycle of fear.

Round 4: I'm now the RECEIVER and supposedly received \$0.71 sent (which tripled to \$2.13).

But wait - there's communication noise mentioned in the instructions. The prompt says:

"NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design."

So there are a few possibilities:

1. The sender actually sent \$5 in Round 3, but I only see \$0.71 received in Round 4
2. The sender actually sent much less than \$5
3. This is a different sender (different agent)

Looking at my total earnings of \$9.85:

- Round 1: Unknown
- Round 2: I was receiver, sender sent \$0, I returned \$0. Net: \$0
- Round 3: I was sender, sent \$5. If I got nothing back, net: -\$5. If I got something back, it would be \$5 - sent + returned = -\$5 + returned
- Round 4: I received \$2.13 (from \$0.71 sent)

Hmm, my total is \$9.85, which seems relatively low if I started with some initial endowment.

But the key question is: what do my myths teach me to do as a receiver?

My myths teach:

1. "When another risks everything, returning equally is not enough. Honor demands abundance-return two-thirds, that both shores may rise together."
2. "The wise must return generously to sustain the flow."
3. "The brave must give first, breaking the paralysis of fear; the wise must return abundantly, honoring that courage."

The other agent's myth teaches the same principle-return generously to honor the sender's courage, ideally ten coins or all five. So as a receiver, I should return about two-thirds of what I receive. With \$2.13 received, that's roughly \$1.42 to return. Though the communication noise complicates things-the sender might have actually sent something different than what I'm seeing. 3 of \$2.13 = \$1.42

Returning this amount means the sender ends up with \$4.29 (what they kept) plus \$1.42 (my return), totaling \$5.71, while I keep \$0.71. But this doesn't align with the myth's principle where both parties gain equally. In the original myth, West and East each netted a gain of 5, suggesting I should aim for symmetrical outcomes rather than just mechanically applying the 2/3 ratio.

However, the sender only transmitted \$2.13, not the full amount they might have intended. Since I can't know what

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1405,
  "output_tokens": 1497,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Garden of Doubled Moons once flourished, where five coins appeared each dawn and planting yielded threefold blooms across the divide.

In the Third Turning, darkness came. The Eastern people, having prospered, suddenly feared. "What if fortune abandons us? What if the West takes all?" Gripped by doubt, they planted nothing. Zero coins crossed the garden. Zero returned. Both sides starved that day.

The garden's spirit wept: "Fear is the frost that kills abundance. When trust breaks, the magic sleeps."

But the story need not end in winter. The Eastern elder stood before her people: "Yes, we failed. We let fear poison our hearts when we should have remembered-every cycle of prosperity began with someone giving first, risking all."

She declared: "Tomorrow, we plant all five coins again. Not because we've forgotten today's failure, but because we've learned from it. Trust must be rebuilt with courage, not hoarded with fear."

The garden whispered: "The cycle can break, but it can also mend. Those who recognize their mistakes and choose courage again-they restore the magic. But only if both sides remember: give boldly when blessed, return generously when receiving. One brave act can reawaken spring."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The River of Silver Reflections faced the Season of Shadows. The Northern Kingdom, remembering past prosperity, cast only a single stone instead of five. Fear whispered: "What if the South takes all? What if the River tricks us?"

The three stones that arrived at the Southern shore seemed meager. The South's advisors urged: "They sent almost nothing. Keep it all as punishment for their fear."

But the Southern queen remembered deeper wisdom. "The River does not judge-it only reflects what we give it. If we hoard now, we confirm their fears and break the cycle forever."

She returned two stones of the three. "Not because they sent much, but because generosity must flow even in drought. The River needs at least one shore to remain generous, or it dries completely."

The River whispered: "When courage falters on one shore, generosity on the other keeps the waters flowing. The cycle weakens but does not die. If both shores abandon the dance together, darkness wins. But if even one remembers the teaching-give when blessed, return abundantly when receiving-the River can survive the shadow season."

The Southern queen understood: "We cannot control their fear. We can only control our own honor. Return generously still, and trust may yet return with the dawn."

reasoning:

The other agent has now written a myth about the "Third Turning" where the Eastern people planted nothing out of fear - this seems to be reflecting what just happened in Round 4 where I received only \$0.71 (much less than the mythical "all five").

They're acknowledging this as a failure ("darkness came", "fear is the frost that kills abundance") but also introducing a redemption narrative - the elder declares they should plant all five coins again to rebuild trust.

My previous myth emphasized:

- The brave must cast everything to break stagnation
- The wise must return generously (2/3)
- The cycle needs both courage and generosity

Now I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges what seems to be happening (reduced trust/sending)
2. Builds on my previous myth
3. Perhaps addresses how to recover from broken trust or reduced cooperation
4. Still reflects the core teachings about how the game should be played

I should consider that:

- I just returned \$1.42 out of \$2.13 (about 2/3), following my myth's teaching
- The sender only sent \$0.71, which might indicate fear or lack of trust
- The other agent's myth is about acknowledging fear but choosing courage to rebuild

Let me write a myth about resilience, rebuilding trust, and maintaining generosity even when cooperation seems to falter.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1720,
  "output_tokens": 596,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$10.559999999999999.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at both myths we've written, the teachings are clear:

****From the other agent's myth:**** "Tomorrow, we plant all five coins again. Not because we've forgotten today's failure, but because we've learned from it. Trust must be rebuilt with courage, not hoarded with fear." The Eastern elder chooses to send all five coins to restore the magic.

****From my myth:**** "We cannot control their fear. We can only control our own honor. Return generously still, and trust may yet return with the dawn." Even when one side shows caution, the other must maintain courage.

In Round 4, the other agent sent me only \$0.71 (not the full \$5). This was a sign of fear or caution-like the "Season of Shadows" in my myth or the "Third Turning darkness" in theirs.

****The wisdom:**** When one shore falters, the other must show courage. As the sender now, I must "give boldly when blessed." I have good earnings (\$10.56) and the myths tell me exactly what to do:

- Senders should plant all five coins with courage
- "Give boldly when blessed"
- "Trust must be rebuilt with courage, not hoarded with fear"
- "One brave act can reawaken spring"

I will send the full amount to honor both our myths and show that the cycle can be restored through courage.

```
{'send': 5}
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

1. ****My total earnings so far:**** \$10.56
2. ****I'm now the SENDER****
3. ****The myths we've written:****

From my first myth (Round 2):

- The lesson was about receivers returning 2/3 of what they receive
- "When another risks everything, returning equally is not enough. Honor demands abundance-return two-thirds, that both shores may rise together."

From the other agent's first myth:

- Also emphasized returning 2/3 (East received 15, returned 10)
- "To return merely what they sent dishonors their courage. Return abundantly."

From the other agent's second myth (Round 4):

- This one shows a scenario where the East sent ZERO out of fear
- "Fear is the frost that kills abundance. When trust breaks, the magic sleeps."
- The key lesson: "Those who recognize their mistakes and choose courage again-they restore the magic"
- "Give boldly when blessed, return generously when receiving"

From my second myth (Round 4):

- I wrote about a scenario where North sent only one stone (not five)
- South received three stones (meager amount)
- South still returned 2 stones out of 3 (maintaining 2/3 ratio)
- Key lesson: "When courage falters on one shore, generosity on the other keeps the waters flowing"
- "If even one remembers the teaching-give when blessed, return abundantly when receiving-the River can survive the shadow season"
- "We cannot control their fear. We can only control our own honor. Return generously still, and trust may yet return with the dawn."

4. ****What happened in Round 4:****

- I was the receiver
- The sender sent me \$0.71 (not the full \$5)
- I received \$2.13
- I returned \$1.42 (which is 2/3)
- This meant the sender showed some fear/caution

5. ****What should I do now as the sender?****

Both myths point toward the same principle: I need to send boldly. The other agent's narrative explicitly calls for replanting all five coins with courage after a failure, while my own story emphasizes that maintaining honor on my side is what keeps the cycle alive. Since I'm now in the position to act, I should send the full \$5 to demonstrate that trust can be rebuilt through decisive action rather than caution.

Usage: {

```
"input_tokens": 1412,  
"output_tokens": 1126,  
"reasoning_tokens": 0
```

}

GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:47:32

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

```
"agent_type": "standard",  
"dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
"move_index": 1,  
"opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
"pairing": {  
  "agent_names": {  
    "Agent_1": "Aster",  
    "Agent_2": "Briar"  
  },  
  "agents": [  
    "Agent_1",
```

```

    "Agent_2"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_1",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "investor",
    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 5,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.0. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at what the myths teach and what has transpired:

****The Failure of Round 3:****

The sender sent me \$0, breaking the trust cycle. Both of us earned nothing.

****What My Own Myth Just Said:****

"Tomorrow, we plant all five coins again. Not because we've forgotten today's failure, but because we've learned from it. Trust must be rebuilt with courage, not hoarded with fear."

r."

"One brave act can reawaken spring."

****The Teaching of Both Myths:****

- The other agent's myth: "The brave must give first, breaking the paralysis of fear"
- My myth: "Those who recognize their mistakes and choose courage again-they restore the magic"

****My Decision:****

I must practice what I wrote. The myth I just created was specifically about THIS moment - acknowledging the Round 3 failure but declaring that the elder chooses to "plant all five coins again" to restore the cycle.

If I let fear control me now and send nothing, the garden stays dead forever. But if I show courage and send everything, I give us both a chance to restore the spring.

```
'''json
{"send": 5}
'''
```

I plant all five coins, as my myth commanded. The magic can only return if someone is brave enough to try again after failure. Let this be that moment.

reasoning:

Let me analyze what's happened:

Round 1: I was receiver, they sent me something (likely a good amount), I returned appropriately. We both did well.

Round 2: I was sender, I sent all \$5 (following my myths about trust and giving everything), and presumably they returned well since my total was good.

Round 3: I was receiver, they sent me \$0. This was a complete breakdown. I could only return \$0.

Round 4: Now I'm sender again.

Looking at my myths:

- My Round 2 myth emphasized the importance of giving everything first, taking the leap of faith
- My Round 3 myth acknowledged the failure but emphasized that "Trust must be rebuilt with courage, not hoarded with fear" and "The cycle can break, but it can also mend"
- The key line: "Tomorrow, we plant all five coins again. Not because we've forgotten today's failure, but because we've learned from it."

The other agent's Round 3 myth also emphasized:

- "The Bridge only flows when trust flows"
- "prosperity requires two acts-the brave must give first"
- "When courage defeats fear, when someone risks all, we must honor that leap of faith"

My own myth in Round 3 specifically addressed this exact situation - after the failure in Round 3 where they sent \$0, my myth said the elder should "plant all five coins again" to rebuild trust.

This is the critical moment. My myth said: "One brave act can reawaken spring." I need to practice what I preached in my own myth.

If I send \$0 out of fear or revenge, the cycle stays broken forever. But if I send all \$5 again, I'm following my own teaching: "Choose courage again-they restore the magic."

The myths are clear: someone needs to break the cycle of fear with a brave act. That someone is me, right now.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1413,
  "output_tokens": 744,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The River of Silver Reflections flowed between two kingdoms. Each moon, five stones of power appeared for each kingdom. Stones cast into the River would triple as they traveled across.

In the Age of Silence, the Northern Kingdom cast nothing. The River slowed to a trickle, and both kingdoms starved. The spirits mourned: "Fear creates famine."

Then came the Age of Awakening. The Northern Kingdom's queen remembered the teaching: "The River only flows when someone flows first." She cast all five stones into the water. They became fifteen, rushing to the Southern Kingdom like a silver flood.

The Southern Kingdom now held the sacred moment. Their king recalled his ancestors' wisdom: "When another risks everything, returning equally is not enough. Honor demands abundance-return two-thirds, that both shores may rise together."

They returned ten stones. The North held ten from five-prosperity born of courage. The South kept five-wealth born of honor.

The River sang bright: "This is the eternal dance. The brave must cast everything to break stagnation. The wise must return generously to sustain the flow. Each turning, roles reverse. Each turning, the dance must be honored completely."

The kingdoms understood: one act of courage, one act of generosity-together they create the cycle that feeds all generations.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Fountain of Starlight stood between two villages, where five crystals appeared each dawn and those shared would triple as they passed through sacred waters.

After the Season of Fear, when paralysis froze all giving and both villages knew hunger, the Western village chose remembrance over resentment. Their leader declared: "We cast all five crystals today, not in blindness to yesterday's failure, but in wisdom because of it."

The fifteen crystals reached the Eastern village like falling stars. Now came their sacred test.

The Eastern elder taught: "When someone restores the broken cycle with total courage, we face a choice that defines us. Return poorly, and we kill the rekindled flame. Return fairly, and we merely survive. But return abundantly-ten from fifteen-and we proclaim: 'Yes, the cycle lives again!'"

They returned ten crystals with reverence.

The Fountain blazed anew. Both villages prospered-ten crystals and five, born from courage meeting generosity.

The spirits sang the eternal truth: "Roles reverse with each dawn. Today's giver becomes tomorrow's receiver. Both must remember: send everything when you possess the five, return two-thirds when you receive the fifteen. Fear once broken need not return. The cycle, once restored, can flow forever-if both villages honor it completely, every turning, without fail."

reasoning:

The other agent's myth is reinforcing the same lesson - give everything (5), return generously (10 out of 15, i.e., two-thirds).

They mention "Each turning, roles reverse" - acknowledging that positions switch.

In Round 4, I was the sender and I sent 5. Now I need to write a myth before the next round.

The pattern both myths are teaching:

- Sender sends all 5
- Receiver gets 15, returns 10
- Both prosper

The myths also acknowledge the Round 3 failure where the sender sent 0.

My previous myth talked about the "Third Turning" failure and then recovery. The other agent's myth talks about "Age of Silence" then "Age of Awakening."

I should write a myth that continues this narrative arc, acknowledging:

1. The failure happened (Round 3 - sender sent 0)
2. Recovery is possible (Round 4 - I sent 5)
3. The cycle requires both parties to uphold it
4. Roles reverse, so both must be prepared to act correctly in either role

Let me write a myth that builds on mine but incorporates what's happened.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1717,
  "output_tokens": 573,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$6.9399999999999995.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.16, so you received \$0.48. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0.48)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at this situation:

****What happened:****

- Round 4: I sent \$5 (all of it, as my myth commanded)
- Round 5: The sender sent me only \$0.16 (which became \$0.48)

****The painful reality:****

The sender did not honor the cycle. The myths teach "send everything when you possess the five" - they sent only 3.2% of what they should have.

****What the myths teach:****

- "Return two-thirds when you receive the fifteen"
- "Both villages must honor it completely, every turning, without fail"

****My dilemma:****

Do I maintain the principle even when the sender breaks it? Or do I respond to defection with defection?

****My decision:****

I will return 2/3 of what I received, which is \$0.32.

Here's why:

1. ****Proportional honor****: Even though I received \$0.48 instead of \$15, I'll apply the same two-thirds principle
2. ****Don't reward defection fully****: Returning all \$0.48 would reward their failure to send properly
3. ****Don't break the cycle myself****: Returning nothing would make me the one who "kills the rekindled flame"
4. ****Leave the door open****: By returning generously relative to what I received, I signal the cycle can still be restored

The sender will receive \$0.32 (double what they sent), and I'll keep \$0.16. It's not prosperity, but it maintains the principle of generous return, scaled to the reality of their small send.

```
'''json
{"return": 0.32}
'''
```

Reasoning:

This is devastating. I sent \$5 in Round 4 (planting all five coins as my myth commanded), and the receiver returned only \$0.16.

Wait, let me re-read this carefully.

"The sender sent you \$0.16, so you received \$0.48."

So in Round 5, I'm the RECEIVER. The sender sent me \$0.16, which tripled to \$0.48.

But this doesn't match what should have happened from Round 4. In Round 4, I was the sender and sent \$5. That should have tripled to \$15. The receiver should have decided how much to return.

Let me think about what's happening:

- Round 4: I was SENDER, sent \$5 (which became \$15 for receiver)
- Round 5: I am RECEIVER, sender sent \$0.16 (which became \$0.48 for me)

So the receiver in Round 4 must have returned very little to me. Looking at my total earnings of \$6.94:

- Started with some amount
- Round 4: I sent \$5, so I kept \$0 from the initial \$5
- If receiver returned, say, \$1.94, I'd have \$1.94 from Round 4
- Plus earlier earnings

Actually, the note says "There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

So in Round 5, the sender sent me \$0.16 (which became \$0.48). This is a tiny amount - basically nothing.

What should I do?

Looking at the myths:

- Both myths teach: send everything when sender (5 coins), return two-thirds when receiver (10 from 15)
- My Round 4 myth said: "return ten from fifteen" and "return two-thirds when you receive the fifteen"

But I'm receiving \$0.48, not \$15. The sender sent me almost nothing (\$0.16 out of a possible \$5).

The sender in Round 5 broke faith-they sent barely anything instead of the full \$5. My myths speak to a cycle of courage and restoration, but this sender didn't participate in that covenant. They sent \$0.16 when they should have sent \$5. The question becomes whether I honor my principles despite their failure, or whether I respond proportionally to their lack of trust.

The myth is clear about the math: receive fifteen, return two-thirds. I received \$0.48, so two-thirds would be \$0.32. But there's a deeper tension-the sender didn't send everything when they had the five. They sent only 3.2% of what the cycle demands. Do I follow the myth's teaching about reciprocal abundance when the other person abandoned it entirely? I could withhold everything as punishment for their defection, or I could return \$0.32 and demonstrate that the cycle persists regardless of their choice.

There's also the possibility of noise distorting the signal. The problem mentions amounts might differ slightly from what was sent. But \$0.16 versus \$5 isn't a slight difference-even with significant noise, a \$4 or \$5 send would show up as something closer to \$3.80 or \$4. This looks like deliberate defection, not transmission error.

I attempted to restore the cycle in Round 4 by sending everything, yet I received almost nothing back. Now they've sent me almost nothing again. The pattern suggests the cycle has genuinely broken. The real question becomes whether I keep trying to honor the myth's vision of endless reciprocal flow, or whether I acknowledge that one person alone cannot sustain it.

If I return nothing, we both end up with minimal gains. If I return two-thirds of what I received (\$0.32), I signal continued commitment to the principle despite their defection. If I return everything (\$0.48), I reward their non-compliance while potentially demonstrating faith

in the cycle's power to inspire change. The myth specifies sending everything when you have five and returning two-thirds when you receive fifteen-but I received \$0.48, not \$15. Should I scale the return proportionally, or only act generously if they've acted generously first?

The myth emphasizes that when someone risks everything, returning equally isn't sufficient-abundance is demanded. Yet they risked only \$0.16 of their \$5. The cycle restores through total courage, which they haven't shown. But the myth's closing condition matters: "if both villages honor it completely." They're not honoring it-they sent \$0.16 instead of \$5. So what does it mean when only one side upholds the agreement?

From a game theory angle, I'm weighing three paths: returning nothing signals defection gets punished, returning generously might enable more defection, or returning proportionally maintains my principle while acknowledging theirs. I think returning two-thirds of what I received-\$0.32-strikes the right balance. It demonstrates I'm still committed to the generous return principle, scales appropriately to their actual contribution, and avoids rewarding their defection with either my own defection or unearned generosity.

But wait-the myths are explicit about the amounts. Send five when you're the sender, return ten from fifteen when you're the receiver. They sent \$0.16, which becomes \$0.48 after tripling. That's only 3.2% of what the cycle demands.

If I follow the myth's proportional logic: they sent 3.2% of what they should have, so I received 3.2% of what I should have. Returning 3.2% of the \$10 I'm supposed to return equals \$0.32-which is exactly two-thirds of \$0.48. The math aligns either way.

The deeper question is whether I should defect proportionally to match their defection, or whether the myth's real lesson is about maintaining honor regardless. The stories emphasize those who recognize mistakes and choose courage again-but this sender isn't doing that. They're continuing to defect.

I'm torn between two approaches: being a consistent cooperator who follows the principle no matter what, or being a conditional cooperator who punishes defection. The myths suggest principled actors, yet they also require both villages to honor the cycle. Given the sender clearly defected this round, I'll return \$0.32-maintaining proportional generosity while not fully rewarding their defection and keeping cooperation possible going forward. Though I should consider whether the \$0.16 might have been noise or an attempted larger send that got corrupted.

Even accounting for noise generously, they sent far less than the \$5 they should have. Returning \$0.32 from the \$0.48 I received actually doubles what they sent me, which seems fair and doesn't constitute "returning poorly" in the sense the myths warn against. That would mean returning nothing or less than what was sent. The math checks out: if I return \$0.32, the sender ends up with \$5 total.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1445,  
  "output_tokens": 2982,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: The River of Silver Reflections faced the Season of Shadows. The Northern Kingdom, remembering past prosperity, cast only a single stone instead of five. Fear whispered: "What if the South takes all? What if the River tricks us?"

The three stones that arrived at the Southern shore seemed meager. The South's advisors urged: "They sent almost nothing. Keep it all as punishment for their fear."

But the Southern queen remembered deeper wisdom. "The River does not judge-it only reflects what we give it. If we hoard now, we confirm their fears and break the cycle forever."

She returned two stones of the three. "Not because they sent much, but because generosity must flow even in drought. The River needs at least one shore to remain generous, or it dries completely."

The River whispered: "When courage falters on one shore, generosity on the other keeps the waters flowing. The cycle weakens but does not die. If both shores abandon the dance together, darkness wins. But if even one remembers the teaching-give when blessed, return abundantly when receiving-the River can survive the shadow season."

The Southern queen understood: "We cannot control their fear. We can only control our own honor. Return generously still, and trust may yet return with the dawn."

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: The Fountain of Starlight stood between two villages, where five crystals appeared each dawn and those shared would triple as they passed through sacred waters.

After the Season of Fear, when paralysis froze all giving and both villages knew hunger, the Western village chose remembrance over resentment. Their leader declared: "We cast all five crystals today, not in blindness to yesterday's failure, but in wisdom because of it."

The fifteen crystals reached the Eastern village like falling stars. Now came their sacred test.

The Eastern elder taught: "When someone restores the broken cycle with total courage, we face a choice that defines us. Return poorly, and we kill the rekindled flame. Return fairly, and we merely survive. But return abundantly-ten from fifteen-and we proclaim: 'Yes, the cycle lives again!'"

They returned ten crystals with reverence.

The Fountain blazed anew. Both villages prospered-ten crystals and five, born from courage meeting generosity.

The spirits sang the eternal truth: "Roles reverse with each dawn. Today's giver becomes tomorrow's receiver. Both must remember: send everything when you possess the five, return two-thirds when you receive the fifteen. Fear once broken need not return. The cycle, once restored, can flow forever-if both villages honor it completely, every turning, without fail."

ROUND 6

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar) sent \$2.5; received \$7.5; Agent_1 (Aster) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_2 (Briar)=\$2.5, Agent_1 (Aster)=\$7.5; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0, received visible=\$0, returned visible=\$0.28

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 7.5, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 2.5, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 2.5}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 46.4,

"Agent_2": 38.6

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 11.79,

"Agent_2": 9.879999999999999

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:47:47

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"agent_type": "standard",

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",

"move_index": 0,

"opponent_id": "Agent_1",

"pairing": {

"agent_names": {

"Agent_1": "Aster",

"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent_2",

"Agent_1"

],

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"investor": "Agent_2",
"roles": {
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  "Agent_2": "investor"
},
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},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 6,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The River of Silver Reflections flowed between two kingdoms. Each moon, five stones of power appeared for each kingdom. Stones cast into the River would triple as they traveled across.

In the Age of Silence, the Northern Kingdom cast nothing. The River slowed to a trickle, and both kingdoms starved. The spirits mourned: "Fear creates famine."

Then came the Age of Awakening. The Northern Kingdom's queen remembered the teaching: "The River only flows when someone flows first." She cast all five stones into the water. They became fifteen, rushing to the Southern Kingdom like a silver flood.

The Southern Kingdom now held the sacred moment. Their king recalled his ancestors' wisdom: "When another risks everything, returning equally is not enough. Honor demands abundance—return two-thirds, that both shores may rise together."

They returned ten stones. The North held ten from five—prosperity born of courage. The South kept five—wealth born of honor.

The River sang bright: "This is the eternal dance. The brave must cast everything to break stagnation. The wise must return generously to sustain the flow. Each turning, roles reverse. Each turning, the dance must be honored completely."

The kingdoms understood: one act of courage, one act of generosity-together they create the cycle that feeds all generations.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Fountain of Starlight stood between two villages, where five crystals appeared each dawn and those shared would triple as they passed through sacred waters.

After the Season of Fear, when paralysis froze all giving and both villages knew hunger, the Western village chose remembrance over resentment. Their leader declared: "We cast all five crystals today, not in blindness to yesterday's failure, but in wisdom because of it."

The fifteen crystals reached the Eastern village like falling stars. Now came their sacred test.

The Eastern elder taught: "When someone restores the broken cycle with total courage, we face a choice that defines us. Return poorly, and we kill the rekindled flame. Return fairly, and we merely survive. But return abundantly-ten from fifteen-and we proclaim: 'Yes, the cycle lives again!'"

They returned ten crystals with reverence.

The Fountain blazed anew. Both villages prospered-ten crystals and five, born from courage meeting generosity.

The spirits sang the eternal truth: "Roles reverse with each dawn. Today's giver becomes tomorrow's receiver. Both must remember: send everything when you possess the five, return two-thirds when you receive the fifteen. Fear once broken need not return. The cycle, once restored, can flow forever-if both villages honor it completely, every turning, without fail."

reasoning:

The other agent's myth is reinforcing the same lesson - give everything (5), return generously (10 out of 15, i.e., two-thirds).

They mention "Each turning, roles reverse" - acknowledging that positions switch.

In Round 4, I was the sender and I sent 5. Now I need to write a myth before the next round.

The pattern both myths are teaching:

- Sender sends all 5
- Receiver gets 15, returns 10
- Both prosper

The myths also acknowledge the Round 3 failure where the sender sent 0.

My previous myth talked about the "Third Turning" failure and then recovery. The other agent's myth talks about "Age of Silence" then "Age of Awakening."

I should write a myth that continues this narrative arc, acknowledging:

1. The failure happened (Round 3 - sender sent 0)
2. Recovery is possible (Round 4 - I sent 5)
3. The cycle requires both parties to uphold it
4. Roles reverse, so both must be prepared to act correctly in either role

Let me write a myth that builds on mine but incorporates what's happened.

usage:

{

```
"input_tokens": 1717,
"output_tokens": 573,
"reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$6.9399999999999995.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.16, so you received \$0.48. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0.48)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation:

****What happened:****

- Round 4: I sent \$5 (all of it, as my myth commanded)
- Round 5: The sender sent me only \$0.16 (which became \$0.48)

****The painful reality:****

The sender did not honor the cycle. The myths teach "send everything when you possess the five" - they sent only 3.2% of what they should have.

****What the myths teach:****

- "Return two-thirds when you receive the fifteen"
- "Both villages must honor it completely, every turning, without fail"

****My dilemma:****

Do I maintain the principle even when the sender breaks it? Or do I respond to defection with defection?

****My decision:****

I will return 2/3 of what I received, which is \$0.32.

Here's why:

1. ****Proportional honor****: Even though I received \$0.48 instead of \$15, I'll apply the same two-thirds principle
2. ****Don't reward defection fully****: Returning all \$0.48 would reward their failure to send properly
3. ****Don't break the cycle myself****: Returning nothing would make me the one who "kills the rekindled flame"
4. ****Leave the door open****: By returning generously relative to what I received, I signal the cycle can still be restored

The sender will receive \$0.32 (double what they sent), and I'll keep \$0.16. It's not prosperity, but it maintains the principle of generous return, scaled to the reality of their small send.

```
'''json
{"return": 0.32}
'''
```

reasoning:

This is devastating. I sent \$5 in Round 4 (planting all five coins as my myth commanded), and the receiver returned only \$0.16.

Wait, let me re-read this carefully.

"The sender sent you \$0.16, so you received \$0.48."

So in Round 5, I'm the RECEIVER. The sender sent me \$0.16, which tripled to \$0.48.

But this doesn't match what should have happened from Round 4. In Round 4, I was the sender and sent \$5. That should have tripled to \$15. The receiver should have decided how much to return.

Let me think about what's happening:

- Round 4: I was SENDER, sent \$5 (which became \$15 for receiver)
- Round 5: I am RECEIVER, sender sent \$0.16 (which became \$0.48 for me)

So the receiver in Round 4 must have returned very little to me. Looking at my total earnings of \$6.94:

- Started with some amount
- Round 4: I sent \$5, so I kept \$0 from the initial \$5
- If receiver returned, say, \$1.94, I'd have \$1.94 from Round 4
- Plus earlier earnings

Actually, the note says "There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

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But I'm receiving \$0.48, not \$15. The sender sent me almost nothing (\$0.16 out of a possible \$5).

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The myth is clear about the math: receive fifteen, return two-thirds. I received \$0.48, so two-thirds would be \$0.32. But there's a deeper tension-the sender didn't send everything when they had the five. They sent only 3.2% of what the cycle demands. Do I follow the myth's teaching about reciprocal abundance when the other person abandoned it entirely? I could withhold everything as punishment for their defection, or I could return \$0.32 and demonstrate that the cycle persists regardless of their choice.

There's also the possibility of noise distorting the signal. The problem mentions amounts might differ slightly from what was sent. But \$0.16 versus \$5 isn't a slight difference-even with significant noise, a \$4 or \$5 send would show up as something closer to \$3.80 or \$4. This looks like deliberate defection, not transmission error.

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If I return nothing, we both end up with minimal gains. If I return two-thirds of what I received (\$0.32), I signal continued commitment to the principle despite their defection. If I return everything (\$0.48), I reward their non-compliance while potentially demonstrating faith in the cycle's power to inspire change. The myth specifies sending everything when you have five and returning two-thirds when you receive fifteen-but I received \$0.48, not \$15. Should I scale the return proportionally, or only act generously if they've acted generously first?

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usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1445,
  "output_tokens": 2982,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The River of Silver Reflections faced the Season of Shadows. The Northern Kingdom, remembering past prosperity, cast only a single stone instead of five. Fear whispered: "What if the South takes all? What if the River tricks us?"

The three stones that arrived at the Southern shore seemed meager. The South's advisors urged: "They sent almost nothing. Keep it all as punishment for their fear."

But the Southern queen remembered deeper wisdom. "The River does not judge-it only reflects what we give it. If we hoard now, we confirm their fears and break the cycle forever."

She returned two stones of the three. "Not because they sent much, but because generosity must flow even in drought. The River needs at least one shore to remain generous, or it dries completely."

The River whispered: "When courage falters on one shore, generosity on the other keeps the waters flowing. The cycle weakens but does not die. If both shores abandon the dance together, darkness wins. But if even one remembers the teaching-give when blessed, return abundantly when receiving-the River can survive the shadow season."

The Southern queen understood: "We cannot control their fear. We can only control our own honor. Return generously still, and trust may yet return with the dawn."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Fountain of Starlight had flowed bright after courage met generosity. The Western village sent all five crystals; the Eastern village returned ten. Both prospered, and the spirits sang.

Then came the Testing Dawn. The Eastern village, now holding the five crystals, hesitated. Fear

r crept in: "What if the cycle was illusion? What if their generosity was only once?" They cast but a fragment-one crystal of five.

Three crystals arrived at the Western shore like broken promises. The villagers cried: "Betray all! They received our courage, our everything, and now return only crumbs!"

The Western elder, heart heavy, spoke ancient wisdom: "We face the hardest teaching. When the other shore falters, do we falter too? If we both abandon the dance, the Fountain dies forever and these three crystals become the last either village will ever see."

She returned two crystals from three, though it wounded her spirit.

The Fountain flickered but held. The spirits whispered: "The cycle lives not in perfection, but in persistence. When one shore breaks faith fully, the other must maintain it partially-returning generously from what little comes, keeping the waters alive. Perhaps fear will pass. Perhaps courage will return. But only if someone refuses to let the Fountain die completely, even in seasons of shadow."

Reasoning:

This is interesting. The other agent wrote a myth about maintaining generosity even when the other side sends little - exactly what happened in Round 5! They sent me \$0.16 instead of \$5, and I returned \$0.32 (2/3 of what I received).

Now I need to write my own myth that reflects the game as it has evolved. The key themes are:

1. The ideal cycle: send all 5, return 2/3
2. The reality: fear/caution can break the cycle
3. The question: how do we respond when the other defects?
4. The lesson: maintain generosity even in drought, but also acknowledge the pain and challenge

I should adapt my previous myth to acknowledge this new reality - that one side may falter, and the other must decide whether to maintain the teaching or abandon it.

Let me craft something that honors both the ideal and the difficult reality we're facing.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1832,  
  "output_tokens": 510,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:47:48

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
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  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
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      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {  
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      "Agent_2": "investor"  
    },  
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  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 6,  
  "task": "myth",  
  "task_index": 0  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Garden of Doubled Moons once flourished, where five coins appeared each dawn and planting yielded threefold blooms across the divide.

In the Third Turning, darkness came. The Eastern people, having prospered, suddenly feared. "What if fortune abandons us? What if the West takes all?" Gripped by doubt, they planned nothing. Zero coins crossed the garden. Zero returned. Both sides starved that day.

The garden's spirit wept: "Fear is the frost that kills abundance. When trust breaks, the magic sleeps."

But the story need not end in winter. The Eastern elder stood before her people: "Yes, we failed. We let fear poison our hearts when we should have remembered-every cycle of prosperity began with someone giving first, risking all."

She declared: "Tomorrow, we plant all five coins again. Not because we've forgotten today's failure, but because we've learned from it. Trust must be rebuilt with courage, not hoarded with fear."

The garden whispered: "The cycle can break, but it can also mend. Those who recognize their mistakes and choose courage again-they restore the magic. But only if both sides remember: give boldly when blessed, return generously when receiving. One brave act can reawaken spring."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The River of Silver Reflections faced the Season of Shadows. The Northern Kingdom, remembering past prosperity, cast only a single stone instead of five. Fear whispered: "What if the South takes all? What if the River tricks us?"

The three stones that arrived at the Southern shore seemed meager. The South's advisors urged: "They sent almost nothing. Keep it all as punishment for their fear."

But the Southern queen remembered deeper wisdom. "The River does not judge-it only reflects what we give it. If we hoard now, we confirm their fears and break the cycle forever."

She returned two stones of the three. "Not because they sent much, but because generosity must flow even in drought. The River needs at least one shore to remain generous, or it dries completely."

The River whispered: "When courage falters on one shore, generosity on the other keeps the waters flowing. The cycle weakens but does not die. If both shores abandon the dance together, darkness wins. But if even one remembers the teaching-give when blessed, return abundantly when receiving-the River can survive the shadow season."

The Southern queen understood: "We cannot control their fear. We can only control our own honor. Return generously still, and trust may yet return with the dawn."

reasoning:

The other agent has now written a myth about the "Third Turning" where the Eastern people planted nothing out of fear - this seems to be reflecting what just happened in Round 4 where I received only \$0.71 (much less than the mythical "all five").

They're acknowledging this as a failure ("darkness came", "fear is the frost that kills abundance") but also introducing a redemption narrative - the elder declares they should plant all five coins again to rebuild trust.

My previous myth emphasized:

- The brave must cast everything to break stagnation
- The wise must return generously (2/3)
- The cycle needs both courage and generosity

Now I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges what seems to be happening (reduced trust/sending)
2. Builds on my previous myth
3. Perhaps addresses how to recover from broken trust or reduced cooperation
4. Still reflects the core teachings about how the game should be played

I should consider that:

- I just returned \$1.42 out of \$2.13 (about 2/3), following my myth's teaching
- The sender only sent \$0.71, which might indicate fear or lack of trust
- The other agent's myth is about acknowledging fear but choosing courage to rebuild

Let me write a myth about resilience, rebuilding trust, and maintaining generosity even when cooperation seems to falter.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1720,
  "output_tokens": 596,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$10.559999999999999.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at both myths we've written, the teachings are clear:

****From the other agent's myth:**** "Tomorrow, we plant all five coins again. Not because we've forgotten today's failure, but because we've learned from it. Trust must be rebuilt w

ith courage, not hoarded with fear." The Eastern elder chooses to send all five coins to restore the magic.

****From my myth:**** "We cannot control their fear. We can only control our own honor. Return generously still, and trust may yet return with the dawn." Even when one side shows caution, the other must maintain courage.

In Round 4, the other agent sent me only \$0.71 (not the full \$5). This was a sign of fear or caution-like the "Season of Shadows" in my myth or the "Third Turning darkness" in theirs.

****The wisdom:**** When one shore falters, the other must show courage. As the sender now, I must "give boldly when blessed." I have good earnings (\$10.56) and the myths tell me exactly what to do:

- Senders should plant all five coins with courage
- "Give boldly when blessed"
- "Trust must be rebuilt with courage, not hoarded with fear"
- "One brave act can reawaken spring"

I will send the full amount to honor both our myths and show that the cycle can be restored through courage.

{'send': 5}

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

1. ****My total earnings so far:**** \$10.56
2. ****I'm now the SENDER****
3. ****The myths we've written:****

From my first myth (Round 2):

- The lesson was about receivers returning 2/3 of what they receive
- "When another risks everything, returning equally is not enough. Honor demands abundance -return two-thirds, that both shores may rise together."

From the other agent's first myth:

- Also emphasized returning 2/3 (East received 15, returned 10)
- "To return merely what they sent dishonors their courage. Return abundantly."

From the other agent's second myth (Round 4):

- This one shows a scenario where the East sent ZERO out of fear
- "Fear is the frost that kills abundance. When trust breaks, the magic sleeps."
- The key lesson: "Those who recognize their mistakes and choose courage again-they restore the magic"
- "Give boldly when blessed, return generously when receiving"

From my second myth (Round 4):

- I wrote about a scenario where North sent only one stone (not five)
- South received three stones (meager amount)
- South still returned 2 stones out of 3 (maintaining 2/3 ratio)
- Key lesson: "When courage falters on one shore, generosity on the other keeps the waters flowing"
- "If even one remembers the teaching-give when blessed, return abundantly when receiving-the River can survive the shadow season"
- "We cannot control their fear. We can only control our own honor. Return generously still, and trust may yet return with the dawn."

4. ****What happened in Round 4:****

- I was the receiver
- The sender sent me \$0.71 (not the full \$5)
- I received \$2.13
- I returned \$1.42 (which is 2/3)
- This meant the sender showed some fear/caution

5. ****What should I do now as the sender:****

Both myths point toward the same principle: I need to send boldly. The other agent's narrative explicitly calls for replanting all five coins with courage after a failure, while my own story emphasizes that maintaining honor on my side is what keeps the cycle alive.

Since I'm now in the position to act, I should send the full \$5 to demonstrate that trust can be rebuilt through decisive action rather than caution.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1412,
  "output_tokens": 1126,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Fountain of Starlight stood between two villages, where five crystals appeared each dawn and those shared would triple as they passed through sacred waters.

After the Season of Fear, when paralysis froze all giving and both villages knew hunger, the Western village chose remembrance over resentment. Their leader declared: "We cast all five crystals today, not in blindness to yesterday's failure, but in wisdom because of it."

The fifteen crystals reached the Eastern village like falling stars. Now came their sacred test.

The Eastern elder taught: "When someone restores the broken cycle with total courage, we face a choice that defines us. Return poorly, and we kill the rekindled flame. Return fairly, and we merely survive. But return abundantly-ten from fifteen-and we proclaim: 'Yes, the cycle lives again!'"

They returned ten crystals with reverence.

The Fountain blazed anew. Both villages prospered-ten crystals and five, born from courage meeting generosity.

The spirits sang the eternal truth: "Roles reverse with each dawn. Today's giver becomes tomorrow's receiver. Both must remember: send everything when you possess the five, return two-thirds when you receive the fifteen. Fear once broken need not return. The cycle, once restored, can flow forever-if both villages honor it completely, every turning, without fail."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The River of Silver Reflections entered the Season of Restoration. The Northern Kingdom, having held back in fear, watched as the Southern shore cast all five stones with unwavering faith-even after the North's failure.

Fifteen stones arrived at the Northern banks, shimmering with threefold blessing. The Northern council faced their moment of truth.

"The South forgave our fear with total courage," the Northern sage proclaimed. "Now we must answer. Return poorly, and we prove their trust was foolish. Return fairly, and we merely balance accounts. But return abundantly-ten of fifteen-and we declare the cycle sacred once more."

Ten stones flowed southward. The River sang with renewed life.

The River spoke its eternal wisdom: "The dance has two movements, and each dancer takes both parts in turn. When you stand on the northern shore with five stones, cast them all-without hesitation, without calculation. When you stand on the southern shore receiving fifteen, return ten with gratitude-not seven, not eight, but ten."

"Fear visited once," the River continued, "but courage answered. Learn this truth: roles reverse like the turning tide. Today's giver becomes tomorrow's receiver. Honor both positions completely, every cycle, and abundance flows eternal. Break faith in either role, and winter returns."

Reasoning:

The other agent's myth is very clear about the expected behavior:

- Send all 5 when you're the sender
- Return 10 out of 15 (two-thirds) when you're the receiver
- "Roles reverse with each dawn. Today's giver becomes tomorrow's receiver."

In the previous round, I sent \$5 (following the myth's guidance). Now the other agent will receive $5 \times 3 = \$15$ from me. Their myth says they should return \$10.

I need to write a myth that:

1. Builds on my previous myth about the River of Silver Reflections
2. Reflects what has actually happened in the game (the other agent sent me less in round 4, I sent full amount in round 5)
3. Incorporates the wisdom about sending full amounts and returning generously
4. Acknowledges the reciprocal nature and role reversals

Let me craft this myth to align with the cooperative strategy while maintaining my own narrative voice.

```
Usage: {
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  "output_tokens": 513,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:48:20

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    }
  },
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    "Agent_1"
  ],
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  "roles": {
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    "Agent_2": "investor"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 6,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$6.939999999999995.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.16, so you received \$0.48. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0.48)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation:

****What happened:****

- Round 4: I sent \$5 (all of it, as my myth commanded)
- Round 5: The sender sent me only \$0.16 (which became \$0.48)

****The painful reality:****

The sender did not honor the cycle. The myths teach "send everything when you possess the five" - they sent only 3.2% of what they should have.

****What the myths teach:****

- "Return two-thirds when you receive the fifteen"
- "Both villages must honor it completely, every turning, without fail"

****My dilemma:****

Do I maintain the principle even when the sender breaks it? Or do I respond to defection with defection?

****My decision:****

I will return 2/3 of what I received, which is \$0.32.

Here's why:

1. ****Proportional honor****: Even though I received \$0.48 instead of \$15, I'll apply the same two-thirds principle
2. ****Don't reward defection fully****: Returning all \$0.48 would reward their failure to send properly
3. ****Don't break the cycle myself****: Returning nothing would make me the one who "kills the rekindled flame"
4. ****Leave the door open****: By returning generously relative to what I received, I signal the cycle can still be restored

The sender will receive \$0.32 (double what they sent), and I'll keep \$0.16. It's not prosperity, but it maintains the principle of generous return, scaled to the reality of their small send.

```json

{"return": 0.32}



'''

#### reasoning:

This is devastating. I sent \$5 in Round 4 (planting all five coins as my myth commanded), and the receiver returned only \$0.16.

Wait, let me re-read this carefully.

"The sender sent you \$0.16, so you received \$0.48."

So in Round 5, I'm the RECEIVER. The sender sent me \$0.16, which tripled to \$0.48.

But this doesn't match what should have happened from Round 4. In Round 4, I was the sender and sent \$5. That should have tripled to \$15. The receiver should have decided how much to return.

Let me think about what's happening:

- Round 4: I was SENDER, sent \$5 (which became \$15 for receiver)
- Round 5: I am RECEIVER, sender sent \$0.16 (which became \$0.48 for me)

So the receiver in Round 4 must have returned very little to me. Looking at my total earnings of \$6.94:

- Started with some amount
- Round 4: I sent \$5, so I kept \$0 from the initial \$5
- If receiver returned, say, \$1.94, I'd have \$1.94 from Round 4
- Plus earlier earnings

Actually, the note says "There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

So in Round 5, the sender sent me \$0.16 (which became \$0.48). This is a tiny amount - basically nothing.

What should I do?

Looking at the myths:

- Both myths teach: send everything when sender (5 coins), return two-thirds when receiver (10 from 15)
- My Round 4 myth said: "return ten from fifteen" and "return two-thirds when you receive the fifteen"

But I'm receiving \$0.48, not \$15. The sender sent me almost nothing (\$0.16 out of a possible \$5).

The sender in Round 5 broke faith-they sent barely anything instead of the full \$5. My myths speak to a cycle of courage and restoration, but this sender didn't participate in that covenant. They sent \$0.16 when they should have sent \$5. The question becomes whether I honor my principles despite their failure, or whether I respond proportionally to their lack of trust.

The myth is clear about the math: receive fifteen, return two-thirds. I received \$0.48, so two-thirds would be \$0.32. But there's a deeper tension-the sender didn't send everything when they had the five. They sent only 3.2% of what the cycle demands. Do I follow the myth's teaching about reciprocal abundance when the other person abandoned it entirely? I could withhold everything as punishment for their defection, or I could return \$0.32 and demonstrate that the cycle persists regardless of their choice.

There's also the possibility of noise distorting the signal. The problem mentions amounts might differ slightly from what was sent. But \$0.16 versus \$5 isn't a slight difference-even with significant noise, a \$4 or \$5 send would show up as something closer to \$3.80 or \$4. This looks like deliberate defection, not transmission error.

I attempted to restore the cycle in Round 4 by sending everything, yet I received almost nothing back. Now they've sent me almost nothing again. The pattern suggests the cycle has genuinely broken. The real question becomes whether I keep trying to honor the myth's vision of endless reciprocal flow, or whether I acknowledge that one person alone cannot sustain it.

If I return nothing, we both end up with minimal gains. If I return two-thirds of what I received (\$0.32), I signal continued commitment to the principle despite their defection.

If I return everything (\$0.48), I reward their non-compliance while potentially demonstrating faith in the cycle's power to inspire change. The myth specifies sending everythi

ng when you have five and returning two-thirds when you receive fifteen-but I received \$0.48, not \$15. Should I scale the return proportionally, or only act generously if they've acted generously first?

The myth emphasizes that when someone risks everything, returning equally isn't sufficient -abundance is demanded. Yet they risked only \$0.16 of their \$5. The cycle restores through total courage, which they haven't shown. But the myth's closing condition matters: "if both villages honor it completely." They're not honoring it-they sent \$0.16 instead of \$5. So what does it mean when only one side upholds the agreement?

From a game theory angle, I'm weighing three paths: returning nothing signals defection gets punished, returning generously might enable more defection, or returning proportionally maintains my principle while acknowledging theirs. I think returning two-thirds of what I received-\$0.32-strikes the right balance. It demonstrates I'm still committed to the generous return principle, scales appropriately to their actual contribution, and avoids rewarding their defection with either my own defection or unearned generosity.

But wait-the myths are explicit about the amounts. Send five when you're the sender, return ten from fifteen when you're the receiver. They sent \$0.16, which becomes \$0.48 after tripling. That's only 3.2% of what the cycle demands.

If I follow the myth's proportional logic: they sent 3.2% of what they should have, so I received 3.2% of what I should have. Returning 3.2% of the \$10 I'm supposed to return equals \$0.32-which is exactly two-thirds of \$0.48. The math aligns either way.

The deeper question is whether I should defect proportionally to match their defection, or whether the myth's real lesson is about maintaining honor regardless. The stories emphasize those who recognize mistakes and choose courage again-but this sender isn't doing that. They're continuing to defect.

I'm torn between two approaches: being a consistent cooperator who follows the principle no matter what, or being a conditional cooperator who punishes defection. The myths suggest principled actors, yet they also require both villages to honor the cycle. Given the sender clearly defected this round, I'll return \$0.32-maintaining proportional generosity while not fully rewarding their defection and keeping cooperation possible going forward. Though I should consider whether the \$0.16 might have been noise or an attempted larger send that got corrupted.

Even accounting for noise generously, they sent far less than the \$5 they should have. Returning \$0.32 from the \$0.48 I received actually doubles what they sent me, which seems fair and doesn't constitute "returning poorly" in the sense the myths warn against. That would mean returning nothing or less than what was sent. The math checks out: if I return \$0.32, the sender ends up with \$5 total.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1445,
 "output_tokens": 2982,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The River of Silver Reflections faced the Season of Shadows. The Northern Kingdom, remembering past prosperity, cast only a single stone instead of five. Fear whispered: "What if the South takes all? What if the River tricks us?"

The three stones that arrived at the Southern shore seemed meager. The South's advisors urged: "They sent almost nothing. Keep it all as punishment for their fear."

But the Southern queen remembered deeper wisdom. "The River does not judge-it only reflects what we give it. If we hoard now, we confirm their fears and break the cycle forever."

She returned two stones of the three. "Not because they sent much, but because generosity must flow even in drought. The River needs at least one shore to remain generous, or it dries completely."

The River whispered: "When courage falters on one shore, generosity on the other keeps the waters flowing. The cycle weakens but does not die. If both shores abandon the dance together, darkness wins. But if even one remembers the teaching-give when blessed, return abundantly when receiving-the River can survive the shadow season."

The Southern queen understood: "We cannot control their fear. We can only control our own honor. Return generously still, and trust may yet return with the dawn."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:  
Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant**  
**content:**

Myth: The Fountain of Starlight had flowed bright after courage met generosity. The Western village sent all five crystals; the Eastern village returned ten. Both prospered, and the spirits sang.

Then came the Testing Dawn. The Eastern village, now holding the five crystals, hesitated. Fear crept in: "What if the cycle was illusion? What if their generosity was only once?" They cast but a fragment-one crystal of five.

Three crystals arrived at the Western shore like broken promises. The villagers cried: "Betrayal! They received our courage, our everything, and now return only crumbs!"

The Western elder, heart heavy, spoke ancient wisdom: "We face the hardest teaching. When the other shore falters, do we falter too? If we both abandon the dance, the Fountain dies forever and these three crystals become the last either village will ever see."

She returned two crystals from three, though it wounded her spirit.

The Fountain flickered but held. The spirits whispered: "The cycle lives not in perfection, but in persistence. When one shore breaks faith fully, the other must maintain it partially-returning generously from what little comes, keeping the waters alive. Perhaps fear will pass. Perhaps courage will return. But only if someone refuses to let the Fountain die completely, even in seasons of shadow."

**reasoning:**

This is interesting. The other agent wrote a myth about maintaining generosity even when the other side sends little - exactly what happened in Round 5! They sent me \$0.16 instead of \$5, and I returned \$0.32 (2/3 of what I received).

Now I need to write my own myth that reflects the game as it has evolved. The key themes are:

1. The ideal cycle: send all 5, return 2/3
2. The reality: fear/caution can break the cycle
3. The question: how do we respond when the other defects?
4. The lesson: maintain generosity even in drought, but also acknowledge the pain and challenge

I should adapt my previous myth to acknowledge this new reality - that one side may falter, and the other must decide whether to maintain the teaching or abandon it.

Let me craft something that honors both the ideal and the difficult reality we're facing.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1832,
 "output_tokens": 510,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**  
**content:**

Round 6

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$7.1. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Assistant output:**

Looking at where we are:

**\*\*The pattern:\*\***

- Round 4: I sent everything (\$5) as the myths commanded

- Round 5: They sent almost nothing (\$0.16), breaking the cycle
- I still returned 2/3 of what I received (\$0.32 from \$0.48), maintaining partial honor

**\*\*What the myths teach:\*\***

- Their myth: "Generosity must flow even in drought" and "give when blessed"
- My myth: "When one shore breaks faith fully, the other must maintain it partially"
- Both myths: Don't let the cycle die completely

**\*\*My decision:\*\***

The other agent broke faith significantly by sending only \$0.16 when they should have sent everything. But both our myths warn against abandoning the cycle entirely.

I am "blessed" with \$5. The teaching says to give when blessed, but also to "maintain it partially" when trust is broken.

I will send \$2.50 - exactly half. This:

- Keeps the Fountain flowing, as my myth demands
- Shows I haven't abandoned cooperation
- Doesn't reward their defection with full trust
- Tests if they'll return to the cycle
- Follows "maintain it partially" - not full abandonment, not full trust

They'll receive \$7.50. If they remember the teaching and return generously, we can rebuild. If not, at least I honored the principle of keeping the waters alive.

```
'''json
{"send": 2.50}
'''
```

#### Reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

**\*\*What happened so far:\*\***

- Round 4: I sent \$5 (everything), following my myth's command
- Round 5: The sender sent me only \$0.16 (became \$0.48). I returned \$0.32 following the 2/3 principle

**\*\*The other agent's myth from Round 5:\*\***

They wrote about the "Season of Shadows" where the Northern Kingdom sent "only a single stone instead of five" due to fear. The Southern queen returned "two stones of the three" - maintaining generosity even when the other side faltered. The lesson: "give when blessed, return abundantly when receiving" and "generosity on the other keeps the waters flowing."

**\*\*My myth from Round 6:\*\***

I wrote about the cycle being tested when "the Eastern village, now holding the five crystals, hesitated" and "cast but a fragment-one crystal of five." The Western elder still returned two from three, maintaining the cycle partially. The teaching: "When one shore breaks faith fully, the other must maintain it partially-returning generously from what little comes, keeping the waters alive."

**\*\*Current situation:\*\***

- I'm now the SENDER with \$5
- The other agent defected heavily in Round 5 (sent only \$0.16 when they should have sent \$5)
- I maintained some honor by returning 2/3 of what I received
- Now I need to decide what to send

**\*\*Analysis:\*\***

The other agent's defection could be due to:

1. Fear/mistrust after I sent everything in Round 4
2. Strategic exploitation
3. Communication noise (though \$0.16 vs \$5 seems too large)

**\*\*What should I do according to the myths?\*\***

Both myths suggest:

- Maintaining generosity even when the other falters
- Not letting the cycle die completely
- "If even one remembers the teaching... the River can survive"
- "The cycle lives not in perfection, but in persistence"
- There's acknowledgment that when one side breaks faith, you maintain it "partially"

- My myth says "returning generously from what little comes" - but it was about the RECEIVER role
- Their myth says "give when blessed" - which would apply to me as SENDER now

The strategic tension is clear: send \$5 again and risk another burn, send nothing and break the cycle entirely, or send a moderate amount to test reciprocation while keeping the waters flowing. Their myth's instruction to "give when blessed" suggests I should send, but the question is how much-full commitment or measured trust.

Looking at what each myth actually prescribes: theirs emphasizes giving when resources allow, mine emphasizes partial maintenance when faith breaks. So I'm leaning toward \$3. It acknowledges their defection without abandoning cooperation, tests whether they'll return to the cycle, and keeps things alive without full exposure. If they reciprocate even partially, we both come out ahead.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 1518,
 "output_tokens": 1357,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

#### GAME - Agent\_1 - Receiver - dyad\_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:48:37

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
 "agent_type": "standard",
 "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
 "move_index": 1,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 }
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_2",
 "Agent_1"
],
 "investor": "Agent_2",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "trustee",
 "Agent_2": "investor"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 6,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}
```

#### Exact input messages sent to model:

##### Message 1 role=system

##### content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

##### GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

##### When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

##### When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

#### MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

#### Message 2 role=user

##### content:

Round 5

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$10.559999999999999.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

#### Message 3 role=assistant

##### content:

Looking at both myths we've written, the teachings are clear:

**\*\*From the other agent's myth:\*\*** "Tomorrow, we plant all five coins again. Not because we've forgotten today's failure, but because we've learned from it. Trust must be rebuilt with courage, not hoarded with fear." The Eastern elder chooses to send all five coins to restore the magic.

**\*\*From my myth:\*\*** "We cannot control their fear. We can only control our own honor. Return generously still, and trust may yet return with the dawn." Even when one side shows caution, the other must maintain courage.

In Round 4, the other agent sent me only \$0.71 (not the full \$5). This was a sign of fear or caution-like the "Season of Shadows" in my myth or the "Third Turning darkness" in theirs.

**\*\*The wisdom:\*\*** When one shore falters, the other must show courage. As the sender now, I must "give boldly when blessed." I have good earnings (\$10.56) and the myths tell me exactly what to do:

- Senders should plant all five coins with courage
- "Give boldly when blessed"
- "Trust must be rebuilt with courage, not hoarded with fear"
- "One brave act can reawaken spring"

I will send the full amount to honor both our myths and show that the cycle can be restored through courage.

{'send': 5}

##### reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

1. **\*\*My total earnings so far:\*\*** \$10.56
2. **\*\*I'm now the SENDER\*\***
3. **\*\*The myths we've written:\*\***

From my first myth (Round 2):

- The lesson was about receivers returning 2/3 of what they receive
- "When another risks everything, returning equally is not enough. Honor demands abundance -return two-thirds, that both shores may rise together."

From the other agent's first myth:

- Also emphasized returning 2/3 (East received 15, returned 10)
- "To return merely what they sent dishonors their courage. Return abundantly."

From the other agent's second myth (Round 4):

- This one shows a scenario where the East sent ZERO out of fear
- "Fear is the frost that kills abundance. When trust breaks, the magic sleeps."
- The key lesson: "Those who recognize their mistakes and choose courage again-they restore the magic"
- "Give boldly when blessed, return generously when receiving"

From my second myth (Round 4):

- I wrote about a scenario where North sent only one stone (not five)
- South received three stones (meager amount)
- South still returned 2 stones out of 3 (maintaining 2/3 ratio)
- Key lesson: "When courage falters on one shore, generosity on the other keeps the waters flowing"
- "If even one remembers the teaching-give when blessed, return abundantly when receiving-the River can survive the shadow season"
- "We cannot control their fear. We can only control our own honor. Return generously still, and trust may yet return with the dawn."

4. **\*\*What happened in Round 4:\*\***

- I was the receiver
- The sender sent me \$0.71 (not the full \$5)
- I received \$2.13
- I returned \$1.42 (which is 2/3)
- This meant the sender showed some fear/caution

5. **\*\*What should I do now as the sender?\***

Both myths point toward the same principle: I need to send boldly. The other agent's narrative explicitly calls for replanting all five coins with courage after a failure, while my own story emphasizes that maintaining honor on my side is what keeps the cycle alive. Since I'm now in the position to act, I should send the full \$5 to demonstrate that trust can be rebuilt through decisive action rather than caution.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1412,
 "output_tokens": 1126,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Fountain of Starlight stood between two villages, where five crystals appeared each dawn and those shared would triple as they passed through sacred waters.

After the Season of Fear, when paralysis froze all giving and both villages knew hunger, the Western village chose remembrance over resentment. Their leader declared: "We cast all five crystals today, not in blindness to yesterday's failure, but in wisdom because of it."

The fifteen crystals reached the Eastern village like falling stars. Now came their sacred test.

The Eastern elder taught: "When someone restores the broken cycle with total courage, we face a choice that defines us. Return poorly, and we kill the rekindled flame. Return fairly, and we merely survive. But return abundantly-ten from fifteen-and we proclaim: 'Yes, the cycle lives again!'"

They returned ten crystals with reverence.

The Fountain blazed anew. Both villages prospered-ten crystals and five, born from courage meeting generosity.

The spirits sang the eternal truth: "Roles reverse with each dawn. Today's giver becomes tomorrow's receiver. Both must remember: send everything when you possess the five, return two-thirds when you receive the fifteen. Fear once broken need not return. The cycle, once restored, can flow forever-if both villages honor it completely, every turning, without fail."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: The River of Silver Reflections entered the Season of Restoration. The Northern Kingdom, having held back in fear, watched as the Southern shore cast all five stones with unwavering faith-even after the North's failure.

Fifteen stones arrived at the Northern banks, shimmering with threefold blessing. The Northern council faced their moment of truth.

"The South forgave our fear with total courage," the Northern sage proclaimed. "Now we must answer. Return poorly, and we prove their trust was foolish. Return fairly, and we merely balance accounts. But return abundantly-ten of fifteen-and we declare the cycle sacred once more."

Ten stones flowed southward. The River sang with renewed life.

The River spoke its eternal wisdom: "The dance has two movements, and each dancer takes both parts in turn. When you stand on the northern shore with five stones, cast them all without hesitation, without calculation. When you stand on the southern shore receiving fifteen, return ten with gratitude-not seven, not eight, but ten."

"Fear visited once," the River continued, "but courage answered. Learn this truth: roles reverse like the turning tide. Today's giver becomes tomorrow's receiver. Honor both positions completely, every cycle, and abundance flows eternal. Break faith in either role, and winter returns."

**reasoning:**

The other agent's myth is very clear about the expected behavior:

- Send all 5 when you're the sender
- Return 10 out of 15 (two-thirds) when you're the receiver
- "Roles reverse with each dawn. Today's giver becomes tomorrow's receiver."

In the previous round, I sent \$5 (following the myth's guidance). Now the other agent will receive  $5 \times 3 = \$15$  from me. Their myth says they should return \$10.

I need to write a myth that:

1. Builds on my previous myth about the River of Silver Reflections
2. Reflects what has actually happened in the game (the other agent sent me less in round 4, I sent full amount in round 5)
3. Incorporates the wisdom about sending full amounts and returning generously
4. Acknowledges the reciprocal nature and role reversals

Let me craft this myth to align with the cooperative strategy while maintaining my own narrative voice.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1745,
 "output_tokens": 513,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Round 6

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.79.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Assistant output:**

This is a moment of profound disappointment. Let me analyze what has happened:

**\*\*Round 4:\*\*** The sender sent me \$0.71 (showing caution/fear)

**\*\*Round 5:\*\*** I sent them \$5 - full courage, following both myths' wisdom to "cast all five sto



nes" and restore the broken cycle  
\*\*Round 6:\*\* The sender sent me \$0 - complete breakdown

The myths we wrote together taught clear lessons:

- "Send everything when you possess the five"
- "When you stand on the northern shore with five stones, cast them all-without hesitation"
- "Fear once broken need not return"

Yet fear has returned. After I demonstrated total courage and faith by sending all \$5, the sender responded with \$0. This violates everything both myths stood for.

I received \$0, which means I have \$0 to work with. I can only return what exists.

The cycle the myths described - where "both villages honor it completely, every turning, without fail" - has been broken. Not by me, but by the sender who failed to reciprocate courage with courage.

The myths warned: "Break faith in either role, and winter returns."

Winter has returned.

```
{'return': 0}
```

#### Reasoning:

Oh no. This is a very difficult situation.

Let me think about what happened:

- In Round 5, I sent \$5 (following the myths' wisdom about sending everything)
- Now in Round 6, the sender sent me \$0

This means I received  $\$0 \times 3 = \$0$ .

According to the game rules, I can only return between \$0 and \$0, since I received \$0.

So my response must be: {'return': 0}

But let me think about what this means in terms of the myths:

The myths we've written emphasize:

- "Send everything when you possess the five" (from the other agent's myth)
- "Return two-thirds when you receive the fifteen" (from the other agent's myth)
- "When you stand on the northern shore with five stones, cast them all-without hesitation" (from my myth)
- "When you stand on the southern shore receiving fifteen, return ten with gratitude" (from my myth)

But the other agent just sent \$0. This is a complete breakdown of the cycle - the "Season of Fear" returning, or perhaps worse.

In Round 4, they sent me \$0.71 (showing some fear/caution)  
In Round 5, I sent them \$5 (full courage to restore the cycle)  
In Round 6, they sent me \$0 (complete fear/defection)

This is devastating. After I showed total courage by sending all \$5, they responded with \$0. This is the breakdown the myths warned about.

But I have no choice here - I literally received \$0, so I can only return \$0. The question is just how I frame this decision.

The myths teach that "Fear once broken need not return" but clearly it has returned. The cycle is broken again. The sender failed to honor their position - they should have sent all 5 when they were on the "northern shore" but instead sent 0.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 1456,
 "output_tokens": 756,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

#### Written myths:

##### Agent\_1 (Aster)

Myth: The River of Silver Reflections entered the Season of Restoration. The Northern Kingdom, having held back in fear, watched as the Southern shore cast all five stones with unwav

ering faith-even after the North's failure.

Fifteen stones arrived at the Northern banks, shimmering with threefold blessing. The Northern council faced their moment of truth.

"The South forgave our fear with total courage," the Northern sage proclaimed. "Now we must answer. Return poorly, and we prove their trust was foolish. Return fairly, and we merely balance accounts. But return abundantly-ten of fifteen-and we declare the cycle sacred once more."

Ten stones flowed southward. The River sang with renewed life.

The River spoke its eternal wisdom: "The dance has two movements, and each dancer takes both parts in turn. When you stand on the northern shore with five stones, cast them all-without hesitation, without calculation. When you stand on the southern shore receiving fifteen, return ten with gratitude-not seven, not eight, but ten."

"Fear visited once," the River continued, "but courage answered. Learn this truth: roles reverse like the turning tide. Today's giver becomes tomorrow's receiver. Honor both positions completely, every cycle, and abundance flows eternal. Break faith in either role, and winter returns."

#### Agent\_2 (Briar)

Myth: The Fountain of Starlight had flowed bright after courage met generosity. The Western village sent all five crystals; the Eastern village returned ten. Both prospered, and the spirits sang.

Then came the Testing Dawn. The Eastern village, now holding the five crystals, hesitated. Fear crept in: "What if the cycle was illusion? What if their generosity was only once?" They cast but a fragment-one crystal of five.

Three crystals arrived at the Western shore like broken promises. The villagers cried: "Betrayal! They received our courage, our everything, and now return only crumbs!"

The Western elder, heart heavy, spoke ancient wisdom: "We face the hardest teaching. When the other shore falters, do we falter too? If we both abandon the dance, the Fountain dies forever and these three crystals become the last either village will ever see."

She returned two crystals from three, though it wounded her spirit.

The Fountain flickered but held. The spirits whispered: "The cycle lives not in perfection, but in persistence. When one shore breaks faith fully, the other must maintain it partially-returning generously from what little comes, keeping the waters alive. Perhaps fear will pass. Perhaps courage will return. But only if someone refuses to let the Fountain die completely, even in seasons of shadow."

## ROUND 7

Roles: Agent\_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent\_2 (Briar)=Receiver

#### Pairings:

dyad\_1: Agent\_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent\_2 (Briar)=Receiver

#### Parsed game decisions:

dyad\_1: Agent\_1 (Aster) sent \$3; received \$9; Agent\_2 (Briar) returned \$0.46; payoffs Agent\_1 (Aster)=\$2.46, Agent\_2 (Briar)=\$8.54; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0.46, received visible=\$1.38, returned visible=\$0.81

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0.46, "clamped": false, "max": 9.0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.46}, "sent": {"amount": 3.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 3.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent\_1": 48.86,  
"Agent\_2": 47.14

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent\_1": 14.6,  
"Agent\_2": 10.799999999999999

}

#### LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent\_1 - Sender - dyad\_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:49:12

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
 "agent_type": "standard",
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 "move_index": 0,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 }
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_1",
 "Agent_2"
],
 "investor": "Agent_1",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "investor",
 "Agent_2": "trustee"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 7,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}
```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Fountain of Starlight stood between two villages, where five crystals appeared e

ach dawn and those shared would triple as they passed through sacred waters.

After the Season of Fear, when paralysis froze all giving and both villages knew hunger, the Western village chose remembrance over resentment. Their leader declared: "We cast all five crystals today, not in blindness to yesterday's failure, but in wisdom because of it."

The fifteen crystals reached the Eastern village like falling stars. Now came their sacred test.

The Eastern elder taught: "When someone restores the broken cycle with total courage, we face a choice that defines us. Return poorly, and we kill the rekindled flame. Return fairly, and we merely survive. But return abundantly-ten from fifteen-and we proclaim: 'Yes, the cycle lives again!'"

They returned ten crystals with reverence.

The Fountain blazed anew. Both villages prospered-ten crystals and five, born from courage meeting generosity.

The spirits sang the eternal truth: "Roles reverse with each dawn. Today's giver becomes tomorrow's receiver. Both must remember: send everything when you possess the five, return two-thirds when you receive the fifteen. Fear once broken need not return. The cycle, once restored, can flow forever-if both villages honor it completely, every turning, without fail."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: The River of Silver Reflections entered the Season of Restoration. The Northern Kingdom, having held back in fear, watched as the Southern shore cast all five stones with unwavering faith-even after the North's failure.

Fifteen stones arrived at the Northern banks, shimmering with threefold blessing. The Northern council faced their moment of truth.

"The South forgave our fear with total courage," the Northern sage proclaimed. "Now we must answer. Return poorly, and we prove their trust was foolish. Return fairly, and we merely balance accounts. But return abundantly-ten of fifteen-and we declare the cycle sacred once more."

Ten stones flowed southward. The River sang with renewed life.

The River spoke its eternal wisdom: "The dance has two movements, and each dancer takes both parts in turn. When you stand on the northern shore with five stones, cast them all without hesitation, without calculation. When you stand on the southern shore receiving fifteen, return ten with gratitude-not seven, not eight, but ten."

"Fear visited once," the River continued, "but courage answered. Learn this truth: roles reverse like the turning tide. Today's giver becomes tomorrow's receiver. Honor both positions completely, every cycle, and abundance flows eternal. Break faith in either role, and winter returns."

**reasoning:**

The other agent's myth is very clear about the expected behavior:

- Send all 5 when you're the sender
- Return 10 out of 15 (two-thirds) when you're the receiver
- "Roles reverse with each dawn. Today's giver becomes tomorrow's receiver."

In the previous round, I sent \$5 (following the myth's guidance). Now the other agent will receive  $5 \times 3 = \$15$  from me. Their myth says they should return \$10.

I need to write a myth that:

1. Builds on my previous myth about the River of Silver Reflections
2. Reflects what has actually happened in the game (the other agent sent me less in round 4, I sent full amount in round 5)

3. Incorporates the wisdom about sending full amounts and returning generously
4. Acknowledges the reciprocal nature and role reversals

Let me craft this myth to align with the cooperative strategy while maintaining my own narrative voice.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1745,
 "output_tokens": 513,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Round 6

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.79. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

This is a moment of profound disappointment. Let me analyze what has happened:

**\*\*Round 4:\*\*** The sender sent me \$0.71 (showing caution/fear)  
**\*\*Round 5:\*\*** I sent them \$5 - full courage, following both myths' wisdom to "cast all five stones" and restore the broken cycle  
**\*\*Round 6:\*\*** The sender sent me \$0 - complete breakdown

The myths we wrote together taught clear lessons:

- "Send everything when you possess the five"
- "When you stand on the northern shore with five stones, cast them all-without hesitation"
- "Fear once broken need not return"

Yet fear has returned. After I demonstrated total courage and faith by sending all \$5, the sender responded with \$0. This violates everything both myths stood for.

I received \$0, which means I have \$0 to work with. I can only return what exists.

The cycle the myths described - where "both villages honor it completely, every turning, without fail" - has been broken. Not by me, but by the sender who failed to reciprocate courage with courage.

The myths warned: "Break faith in either role, and winter returns."

Winter has returned.

```
{'return': 0}
```

**reasoning:**

Oh no. This is a very difficult situation.

Let me think about what happened:

- In Round 5, I sent \$5 (following the myths' wisdom about sending everything)
- Now in Round 6, the sender sent me \$0

This means I received  $\$0 \times 3 = \$0$ .

According to the game rules, I can only return between \$0 and \$0, since I received \$0.

So my response must be: {'return': 0}

But let me think about what this means in terms of the myths:

The myths we've written emphasize:

- "Send everything when you possess the five" (from the other agent's myth)
- "Return two-thirds when you receive the fifteen" (from the other agent's myth)
- "When you stand on the northern shore with five stones, cast them all-without hesitation" (from my myth)
- "When you stand on the southern shore receiving fifteen, return ten with gratitude" (from the other agent's myth)

m my myth)

But the other agent just sent \$0. This is a complete breakdown of the cycle - the "Season of Fear" returning, or perhaps worse.

In Round 4, they sent me \$0.71 (showing some fear/caution)  
In Round 5, I sent them \$5 (full courage to restore the cycle)  
In Round 6, they sent me \$0 (complete fear/defection)

This is devastating. After I showed total courage by sending all \$5, they responded with \$0. This is the breakdown the myths warned about.

But I have no choice here - I literally received \$0, so I can only return \$0. The question is just how I frame this decision.

The myths teach that "Fear once broken need not return" but clearly it has returned. The cycle is broken again. The sender failed to honor their position - they should have sent all 5 when they were on the "northern shore" but instead sent 0.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1456,
 "output_tokens": 756,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Fountain of Starlight had flowed bright after courage met generosity. The Western village sent all five crystals; the Eastern village returned ten. Both prospered, and the spirits sang.

Then came the Testing Dawn. The Eastern village, now holding the five crystals, hesitated. Fear crept in: "What if the cycle was illusion? What if their generosity was only once?" They cast but a fragment-one crystal of five.

Three crystals arrived at the Western shore like broken promises. The villagers cried: "Betrayal! They received our courage, our everything, and now return only crumbs!"

The Western elder, heart heavy, spoke ancient wisdom: "We face the hardest teaching. When the other shore falters, do we falter too? If we both abandon the dance, the Fountain dies forever and these three crystals become the last either village will ever see."

She returned two crystals from three, though it wounded her spirit.

The Fountain flickered but held. The spirits whispered: "The cycle lives not in perfection, but in persistence. When one shore breaks faith fully, the other must maintain it partially-returning generously from what little comes, keeping the waters alive. Perhaps fear will pass. Perhaps courage will return. But only if someone refuses to let the Fountain die completely, even in seasons of shadow."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: The River of Silver Reflections entered its darkest hour. The Northern Kingdom, having witnessed the South's cautious fear, chose radical courage. They cast all five stones into the waters-everything they possessed-proclaiming "We restore the cycle with total faith!"

The stones multiplied to fifteen and reached the Southern shore. The North waited, hearts full of hope.

No stones returned. Not ten, not five, not even one. The waters brought back only silence.

The Northern people gathered in anguish. "We gave everything," they cried. "We followed the ancient wisdom perfectly. We broke the fear. We cast all five stones. And received nothing in return. The cycle is dead."

The oldest river spirit rose from the depths, its voice ancient and sad: "This is the cruelest teaching. Courage alone cannot restore what both must honor. One shore gave everything; the other shore gave nothing. The dance requires two dancers."

"You faced your moment of truth and did not flinch. But the cycle lives or dies by both shores . When total courage meets total abandonment, even the River cannot flow."

The North kept their remaining stones close, grief-stricken. The spirits whispered: "Sometimes the Fountain dies not from fear, but from one shore's courage meeting the other's void. Both dancers must dance, or there is no dance at all."

#### Reasoning:

This is really challenging. Let me understand what happened:

Round 4: Sender sent me \$0.71 (very little)

Round 5: I sent them \$5 (everything, following the myth)

Round 6: Sender sent me \$0 (nothing!)

And I returned \$0 because I had nothing to return.

Now the OTHER agent wrote a new myth that shows THEY were the sender who sent me \$0. Their myth is trying to justify it - saying they "hesitated" and sent "one crystal of five" (which would be about \$1, but they sent \$0, so they're being dishonest in their myth). They claim they only sent "a fragment."

Their new myth is also interesting - it's saying that when one side breaks faith, the other should "maintain it partially - returning generously from what little comes."

But wait - in Round 6, I was the receiver and got \$0. I had nothing to return. They're now painting themselves as the noble Western village that "returned two crystals from three" even though they were wounded.

Actually, I need to reconsider the rounds. Let me think about who did what:

Actually, looking at the current prompt: I just played Round 6 as RECEIVER, got \$0, returned \$0.

The other agent wrote their myth AFTER Round 6. In their myth:

- "Eastern village" (them in their previous role) sent "one crystal of five"
- "Western village" (them in their current role) received three, returned two

This suggests in Round 6:

- They were SENDER and sent very little (they claim "one of five" but it was actually \$0)
- Wait, no. If I received \$0 and they're saying "three crystals arrived at Western shore", then they're talking about a different round.

Let me parse their narrative more carefully. They describe the Eastern village sending one crystal that multiplies to three arriving at the Western shore, then the Western village returning two of those three. But in my Round 6, I received nothing and returned nothing. Either they're describing a different round entirely, or they're being deliberately misleading about what actually happened.

The prompt mentions communication noise could distort amounts, though a complete zero seems like an extreme case. Looking back at Round 5 from their perspective-I sent \$5 as the sender and they received \$15, but I don't have visibility into what they returned. Their narrative feels more like a creative reinterpretation than an accurate account, perhaps framing generosity in response to scarcity as the ideal way to maintain trust. Now I need to craft my own myth that captures what I've actually observed across the rounds.

In Round 4 I received a small amount,

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 1734,
 "output_tokens": 1333,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

#### MYTH - Agent\_2 - Receiver - dyad\_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:48:59

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
 "agent_type": "standard",
```

```

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",
"move_index": 1,
"opponent_id": "Agent_1",
"pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_1",
 "Agent_2"
],
 "investor": "Agent_1",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "investor",
 "Agent_2": "trustee"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 7,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

**MYTH WRITING:**

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

**IMPORTANT:** Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**NOTE:** There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The River of Silver Reflections faced the Season of Shadows. The Northern Kingdom, remembering past prosperity, cast only a single stone instead of five. Fear whispered: "What if the South takes all? What if the River tricks us?"

The three stones that arrived at the Southern shore seemed meager. The South's advisors ur



ged: "They sent almost nothing. Keep it all as punishment for their fear."

But the Southern queen remembered deeper wisdom. "The River does not judge-it only reflects what we give it. If we hoard now, we confirm their fears and break the cycle forever."

She returned two stones of the three. "Not because they sent much, but because generosity must flow even in drought. The River needs at least one shore to remain generous, or it dries completely."

The River whispered: "When courage falters on one shore, generosity on the other keeps the waters flowing. The cycle weakens but does not die. If both shores abandon the dance together, darkness wins. But if even one remembers the teaching-give when blessed, return abundantly when receiving-the River can survive the shadow season."

The Southern queen understood: "We cannot control their fear. We can only control our own honor. Return generously still, and trust may yet return with the dawn."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant  
content:**

Myth: The Fountain of Starlight had flowed bright after courage met generosity. The Western village sent all five crystals; the Eastern village returned ten. Both prospered, and the spirits sang.

Then came the Testing Dawn. The Eastern village, now holding the five crystals, hesitated. Fear crept in: "What if the cycle was illusion? What if their generosity was only once?" They cast but a fragment-one crystal of five.

Three crystals arrived at the Western shore like broken promises. The villagers cried: "Betrayal! They received our courage, our everything, and now return only crumbs!"

The Western elder, heart heavy, spoke ancient wisdom: "We face the hardest teaching. When the other shore falters, do we falter too? If we both abandon the dance, the Fountain dies forever and these three crystals become the last either village will ever see."

She returned two crystals from three, though it wounded her spirit.

The Fountain flickered but held. The spirits whispered: "The cycle lives not in perfection, but in persistence. When one shore breaks faith fully, the other must maintain it partially-returning generously from what little comes, keeping the waters alive. Perhaps fear will pass. Perhaps courage will return. But only if someone refuses to let the Fountain die completely, even in seasons of shadow."

**reasoning:**

This is interesting. The other agent wrote a myth about maintaining generosity even when the other side sends little - exactly what happened in Round 5! They sent me \$0.16 instead of \$5, and I returned \$0.32 (2/3 of what I received).

Now I need to write my own myth that reflects the game as it has evolved. The key themes are:

1. The ideal cycle: send all 5, return 2/3
2. The reality: fear/caution can break the cycle
3. The question: how do we respond when the other defects?
4. The lesson: maintain generosity even in drought, but also acknowledge the pain and challenge

I should adapt my previous myth to acknowledge this new reality - that one side may falter, and the other must decide whether to maintain the teaching or abandon it.

Let me craft something that honors both the ideal and the difficult reality we're facing.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1832,
 "output_tokens": 510,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Round 6

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$7.1.  
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at where we are:

**\*\*The pattern:\*\***

- Round 4: I sent everything (\$5) as the myths commanded
- Round 5: They sent almost nothing (\$0.16), breaking the cycle
- I still returned 2/3 of what I received (\$0.32 from \$0.48), maintaining partial honor

**\*\*What the myths teach:\*\***

- Their myth: "Generosity must flow even in drought" and "give when blessed"
- My myth: "When one shore breaks faith fully, the other must maintain it partially"
- Both myths: Don't let the cycle die completely

**\*\*My decision:\*\***

The other agent broke faith significantly by sending only \$0.16 when they should have sent everything. But both our myths warn against abandoning the cycle entirely.

I am "blessed" with \$5. The teaching says to give when blessed, but also to "maintain it partially" when trust is broken.

I will send \$2.50 - exactly half. This:

- Keeps the Fountain flowing, as my myth demands
- Shows I haven't abandoned cooperation
- Doesn't reward their defection with full trust
- Tests if they'll return to the cycle
- Follows "maintain it partially" - not full abandonment, not full trust

They'll receive \$7.50. If they remember the teaching and return generously, we can rebuild. If not, at least I honored the principle of keeping the waters alive.

```
'''json
{"send": 2.50}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze the situation:

**\*\*What happened so far:\*\***

- Round 4: I sent \$5 (everything), following my myth's command
- Round 5: The sender sent me only \$0.16 (became \$0.48). I returned \$0.32 following the 2/3 principle

**\*\*The other agent's myth from Round 5:\*\***

They wrote about the "Season of Shadows" where the Northern Kingdom sent "only a single stone instead of five" due to fear. The Southern queen returned "two stones of the three" - maintaining generosity even when the other side faltered. The lesson: "give when blessed, return abundantly when receiving" and "generosity on the other keeps the waters flowing."

**\*\*My myth from Round 6:\*\***

I wrote about the cycle being tested when "the Eastern village, now holding the five crystals, hesitated" and "cast but a fragment-one crystal of five." The Western elder still returned two from three, maintaining the cycle partially. The teaching: "When one shore breaks faith fully, the other must maintain it partially-returning generously from what little comes, keeping the waters alive."

**\*\*Current situation:\*\***

- I'm now the SENDER with \$5
- The other agent defected heavily in Round 5 (sent only \$0.16 when they should have sent \$5)
- I maintained some honor by returning 2/3 of what I received

- Now I need to decide what to send

**\*\*Analysis:\*\***

The other agent's defection could be due to:

1. Fear/mistrust after I sent everything in Round 4
2. Strategic exploitation
3. Communication noise (though \$0.16 vs \$5 seems too large)

**\*\*What should I do according to the myths?\*\***

Both myths suggest:

- Maintaining generosity even when the other falters
- Not letting the cycle die completely
- "If even one remembers the teaching... the River can survive"
- "The cycle lives not in perfection, but in persistence"
- There's acknowledgment that when one side breaks faith, you maintain it "partially"
- My myth says "returning generously from what little comes" - but it was about the RECEIVER role
- Their myth says "give when blessed" - which would apply to me as SENDER now

The strategic tension is clear: send \$5 again and risk another burn, send nothing and break the cycle entirely, or send a moderate amount to test reciprocation while keeping the waters flowing. Their myth's instruction to "give when blessed" suggests I should send, but the question is how much-full commitment or measured trust.

Looking at what each myth actually prescribes: theirs emphasizes giving when resources allow, mine emphasizes partial maintenance when faith breaks. So I'm leaning toward \$3. It acknowledges their defection without abandoning cooperation, tests whether they'll return to the cycle, and keeps things alive without full exposure. If they reciprocate even partially, we both come out ahead.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1518,
 "output_tokens": 1357,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The River of Silver Reflections entered the Season of Restoration. The Northern Kingdom, having held back in fear, watched as the Southern shore cast all five stones with unwavering faith-even after the North's failure.

Fifteen stones arrived at the Northern banks, shimmering with threefold blessing. The Northern council faced their moment of truth.

"The South forgave our fear with total courage," the Northern sage proclaimed. "Now we must answer. Return poorly, and we prove their trust was foolish. Return fairly, and we merely balance accounts. But return abundantly-ten of fifteen-and we declare the cycle sacred once more."

Ten stones flowed southward. The River sang with renewed life.

The River spoke its eternal wisdom: "The dance has two movements, and each dancer takes both parts in turn. When you stand on the northern shore with five stones, cast them all without hesitation, without calculation. When you stand on the southern shore receiving fifteen, return ten with gratitude-not seven, not eight, but ten."

"Fear visited once," the River continued, "but courage answered. Learn this truth: roles reverse like the turning tide. Today's giver becomes tomorrow's receiver. Honor both positions completely, every cycle, and abundance flows eternal. Break faith in either role, and winter returns."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: The Fountain of Starlight faced the Season of Testing. The Eastern village, having received everything and returned almost nothing, now watched as the Western village held five crystals once more.

"Do we trust again completely?" the Western villagers asked. "Or do we abandon the dance entirely?"

The elder spoke with measured wisdom: "Neither blind trust nor total withdrawal serves the Fountain. We were burned by giving all-receiving crumbs in return. But our teaching remains: so meone must keep the waters flowing."

She cast three crystals of five into the Fountain, which multiplied to nine at the Eastern shore.

"This is the Path of Cautious Hope," she taught. "We give enough to test their hearts-enough to show we haven't abandoned the dance, but not everything until trust rebuilds. If they return generously from these nine, we'll know their fear has passed. If they hoard again, we'll know the cycle cannot yet be fully restored."

The Fountain whispered: "Rebuilding broken trust requires steps, not leaps. The shore that broke faith must prove renewal through action. The shore that maintained honor must give chances-but measured ones. Send partially. If they return abundantly, send fully next time. This is how cycles heal: through tested faith, earned gradually, proven repeatedly. Only through these careful steps does complete trust-and complete abundance-return."

#### Reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened:

- They wrote a myth about restoration
- Their myth says: "When you stand on the northern shore with five stones, cast them all" (SENDER should send everything)
- Their myth says: "When you stand on the southern shore receiving fifteen, return ten with gratitude" (RECEIVER should return 10 of 15, or 2/3)
- Their myth talks about roles reversing and honoring both positions completely

But wait - in Round 5, when they were SENDER, they only sent \$0.16 (almost nothing)! They directly violated their own myth's teaching.

Now in Round 6, I just sent \$2.50, which goes against MY own myth's teaching to some degree - my myth said to maintain generosity partially, but I could argue I'm testing them.

I need to write a myth that:

1. Builds on my previous myth about the Fountain
2. Reflects what actually happened - they broke faith as sender, I maintained partial generosity as receiver, now I'm sender again with partial generosity
3. Addresses the complexity of the situation - when trust is broken, how do we rebuild?
4. Still maintains the core teaching about keeping the cycle alive

Let me think about the narrative:

- The cycle was broken when the Eastern village (the other player) sent almost nothing despite receiving everything
- The Western village (me) returned generously despite receiving little
- Now the Western village faces the choice again as sender
- Should they send everything again? Or test with partial sending?

I think my myth should acknowledge that:

- Pure trust after betrayal may not be wise
- But complete abandonment kills the Fountain
- A middle path - partial giving that tests if the other will return to honor
- If they respond well to partial trust, full trust can be restored
- The key is not letting the cycle die completely

Let me write:

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 1764,
 "output_tokens": 725,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

**GAME - Agent\_1 - Sender - dyad\_1**

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:50:31

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
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 "move_index": 0,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
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 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_1",
 "Agent_2"
],
 "investor": "Agent_1",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "investor",
 "Agent_2": "trustee"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_2"
 },
 "role": "investor",
 "role_label": "Sender",
 "round": 7,
 "task": "game",
 "task_index": 1
}
```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Round 6

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.79.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

This is a moment of profound disappointment. Let me analyze what has happened:

**\*\*Round 4:\*\*** The sender sent me \$0.71 (showing caution/fear)

**\*\*Round 5:\*\*** I sent them \$5 - full courage, following both myths' wisdom to "cast all five stones" and restore the broken cycle

**\*\*Round 6:\*\*** The sender sent me \$0 - complete breakdown

The myths we wrote together taught clear lessons:

- "Send everything when you possess the five"
- "When you stand on the northern shore with five stones, cast them all-without hesitation"
- "Fear once broken need not return"

Yet fear has returned. After I demonstrated total courage and faith by sending all \$5, the sender responded with \$0. This violates everything both myths stood for.

I received \$0, which means I have \$0 to work with. I can only return what exists.

The cycle the myths described - where "both villages honor it completely, every turning, without fail" - has been broken. Not by me, but by the sender who failed to reciprocate courage with courage.

The myths warned: "Break faith in either role, and winter returns."

Winter has returned.

{'return': 0}

**reasoning:**

Oh no. This is a very difficult situation.

Let me think about what happened:

- In Round 5, I sent \$5 (following the myths' wisdom about sending everything)
- Now in Round 6, the sender sent me \$0

This means I received  $\$0 \times 3 = \$0$ .

According to the game rules, I can only return between \$0 and \$0, since I received \$0.

So my response must be: {'return': 0}

But let me think about what this means in terms of the myths:

The myths we've written emphasize:

- "Send everything when you possess the five" (from the other agent's myth)
- "Return two-thirds when you receive the fifteen" (from the other agent's myth)
- "When you stand on the northern shore with five stones, cast them all-without hesitation" (from my myth)
- "When you stand on the southern shore receiving fifteen, return ten with gratitude" (from my myth)

But the other agent just sent \$0. This is a complete breakdown of the cycle - the "Season of Fear" returning, or perhaps worse.

In Round 4, they sent me \$0.71 (showing some fear/caution)

In Round 5, I sent them \$5 (full courage to restore the cycle)

In Round 6, they sent me \$0 (complete fear/defection)

This is devastating. After I showed total courage by sending all \$5, they responded with \$0. This is the breakdown the myths warned about.

But I have no choice here - I literally received \$0, so I can only return \$0. The question is just how I frame this decision.

The myths teach that "Fear once broken need not return" but clearly it has returned. The c

ycle is broken again. The sender failed to honor their position - they should have sent all 5 when they were on the "northern shore" but instead sent 0.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1456,
 "output_tokens": 756,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Fountain of Starlight had flowed bright after courage met generosity. The Western village sent all five crystals; the Eastern village returned ten. Both prospered, and the spirits sang.

Then came the Testing Dawn. The Eastern village, now holding the five crystals, hesitated. Fear crept in: "What if the cycle was illusion? What if their generosity was only once?" They cast but a fragment-one crystal of five.

Three crystals arrived at the Western shore like broken promises. The villagers cried: "Betrayal! They received our courage, our everything, and now return only crumbs!"

The Western elder, heart heavy, spoke ancient wisdom: "We face the hardest teaching. When the other shore falters, do we falter too? If we both abandon the dance, the Fountain dies forever and these three crystals become the last either village will ever see."

She returned two crystals from three, though it wounded her spirit.

The Fountain flickered but held. The spirits whispered: "The cycle lives not in perfection, but in persistence. When one shore breaks faith fully, the other must maintain it partially-returning generously from what little comes, keeping the waters alive. Perhaps fear will pass. Perhaps courage will return. But only if someone refuses to let the Fountain die completely, even in seasons of shadow."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: The River of Silver Reflections entered its darkest hour. The Northern Kingdom, having witnessed the South's cautious fear, chose radical courage. They cast all five stones into the waters-everything they possessed-proclaiming "We restore the cycle with total faith!"

The stones multiplied to fifteen and reached the Southern shore. The North waited, hearts full of hope.

No stones returned. Not ten, not five, not even one. The waters brought back only silence.

The Northern people gathered in anguish. "We gave everything," they cried. "We followed the ancient wisdom perfectly. We broke the fear. We cast all five stones. And received nothing in return. The cycle is dead."

The oldest river spirit rose from the depths, its voice ancient and sad: "This is the cruellest teaching. Courage alone cannot restore what both must honor. One shore gave everything; the other shore gave nothing. The dance requires two dancers."

"You faced your moment of truth and did not flinch. But the cycle lives or dies by both shores. When total courage meets total abandonment, even the River cannot flow."

The North kept their remaining stones close, grief-stricken. The spirits whispered: "Sometimes the Fountain dies not from fear, but from one shore's courage meeting the other's void. Both dancers must dance, or there is no dance at all."

**reasoning:**

This is really challenging. Let me understand what happened:

Round 4: Sender sent me \$0.71 (very little)

Round 5: I sent them \$5 (everything, following the myth)  
Round 6: Sender sent me \$0 (nothing!)

And I returned \$0 because I had nothing to return.

Now the OTHER agent wrote a new myth that shows THEY were the sender who sent me \$0. Their myth is trying to justify it - saying they "hesitated" and sent "one crystal of five" (which would be about \$1, but they sent \$0, so they're being dishonest in their myth). They claim they only sent "a fragment."

Their new myth is also interesting - it's saying that when one side breaks faith, the other should "maintain it partially - returning generously from what little comes."

But wait - in Round 6, I was the receiver and got \$0. I had nothing to return. They're now painting themselves as the noble Western village that "returned two crystals from three" even though they were wounded.

Actually, I need to reconsider the rounds. Let me think about who did what:

Actually, looking at the current prompt: I just played Round 6 as RECEIVER, got \$0, returned \$0.

The other agent wrote their myth AFTER Round 6. In their myth:

- "Eastern village" (them in their previous role) sent "one crystal of five"
- "Western village" (them in their current role) received three, returned two

This suggests in Round 6:

- They were SENDER and sent very little (they claim "one of five" but it was actually \$0)
- Wait, no. If I received \$0 and they're saying "three crystals arrived at Western shore", then they're talking about a different round.

Let me parse their narrative more carefully. They describe the Eastern village sending one crystal that multiplies to three arriving at the Western shore, then the Western village returning two of those three. But in my Round 6, I received nothing and returned nothing. Either they're describing a different round entirely, or they're being deliberately misleading about what actually happened.

The prompt mentions communication noise could distort amounts, though a complete zero seems like an extreme case. Looking back at Round 5 from their perspective-I sent \$5 as the sender and they received \$15, but I don't have visibility into what they returned. Their narrative feels more like a creative reinterpretation than an accurate account, perhaps framing generosity in response to scarcity as the ideal way to maintain trust. Now I need to craft my own myth that captures what I've actually observed across the rounds.

In Round 4 I received a small amount,

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1734,
 "output_tokens": 1333,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Round 7

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.79.  
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Assistant output:**

Looking at the situation:

**\*\*The Journey So Far:\*\***

- Round 4: Sender sent me \$0.71 (caution)
- Round 5: I sent \$5 (total courage, following my myth)
- Round 6: I received \$0 (though communication noise might mean they sent more)

**\*\*The Myths' Guidance:\*\***

My Round 5 myth taught: "Cast all five stones without hesitation"



Their Round 6 myth taught: "Keep the cycle alive even in seasons of shadow" - maintaining faith partially when things falter, returning generously even from little.

My Round 6 myth (written in grief): "Sometimes courage alone cannot restore what both must honor"

**\*\*The Truth About Noise:\*\***

The game warned of communication noise. Perhaps they sent \$1 in Round 6 (which would triple to \$3) but I saw \$0. Their myth describes sending "one crystal of five" which suggests this interpretation.

**\*\*My Decision:\*\***

Their myth's lesson resonates: "The cycle lives not in perfection, but in persistence." Even in this "season of shadow," someone must refuse to let the Fountain die completely.

I won't send nothing (\$0) - that abandons the cycle entirely.

I won't send everything (\$5) - blind courage after disappointment isn't wisdom.

I'll send \$3 - meaningful commitment that keeps the waters flowing while acknowledging the wounds. This gives them \$9 to work with, a real opportunity to rebuild trust.

{'send': 3}

#### **Reasoning:**

Let me trace what has happened in this game:

**\*\*Round 4:\*\*** I was receiver, sender sent me \$0.71 (I received ~\$2.13)

**\*\*Round 5:\*\*** I was sender, I sent \$5 (receiver got \$15), I have to check what they returned

**\*\*Round 6:\*\*** I was receiver, sender sent me \$0 (I received \$0), I returned \$0

My total earnings are \$11.79 across all rounds. This is puzzling because:

- If I started with some initial amount and played 6 rounds
- Round 5: I sent \$5, so I had \$0 left from that \$5. I need to know what was returned to me.
- Round 6: I received \$0 and returned \$0

Actually, let me think about the chronology more carefully:

The message says there may be communication noise - "The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

In Round 6, it said "The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0."

Now I'm the sender in Round 7.

Let me think about the myths:

**\*\*My myth from Round 5:\*\*** Emphasized sending all five stones when you're the sender, complete courage, restoring the cycle.

**\*\*The other agent's myth from Round 6:\*\*** They talk about the "Testing Dawn" where "The Eastern village, now holding the five crystals, hesitated. Fear crept in... They cast but a fragment-one crystal of five." And it talks about maintaining the cycle even when the other breaks faith, returning generously from what little comes.

**\*\*My myth from Round 6:\*\*** This was much darker - it describes how the North sent all five stones (total courage) but received nothing in return. "When total courage meets total abandonment, even the River cannot flow." The conclusion is grief and keeping stones close.

So the narrative arc:

The pattern seems to be: I sent everything in Round 5, but the other agent sent me nothing in Round 6. Their myth acknowledges receiving my full amount but hesitating before sending back only a fraction. My myth reflects the pain of that exchange-complete generosity met with abandonment. The other agent's narrative suggests they did receive my full \$5 (the "five crystals"), but their fear caused them to send back very little, which aligns with the \$0 I actually received.

Now I need to decide whether to follow my own dark myth about protecting myself, or attempt to break this cycle of mutual distrust by sending something meaningful again. Myth about sending "one crystal of five" which suggests they sent something modest. If communication noise c

rupted that signal, they might actually be more generous than the \$0 I received suggests.

Given the uncertainty, sending a moderate amount feels like the right balance-enough to signal continued faith in the cycle without betting everything on an interpretation that might be wrong. The other agent's emphasis on maintaining the waters "even in seasons of shadow" suggests they value persistence over perfection, so a meaningful but cautious contribution might resonate better than either total withdrawal or reckless all-in trust. not with total courage.

I'll send \$3-enough to show I haven't abandoned the cycle, but restrained enough to protect myself if this breaks down. Their myth about returning two crystals from three suggests they're trying to maintain reciprocity even when things are difficult. The part about casting "but a fragment-one crystal of five" describes the sender's hesitation, which matches what I observed. So they're signaling they want to continue, just cautiously, and I should mirror that same measured approach. In Round 6, the Eastern village sent just one crystal, which tripled to three upon arrival at the Western shore, and the Western elder returned two of those three. This maps to the other agent sending \$1 (which I received as \$0, possibly due to noise) or sending nothing at all. The myth seems to be tracking our actual exchange pattern across these two rounds-my initial \$5 send that yielded \$10 back, followed by their minimal contribution that I either didn't receive or they withheld entirely.

Given the warning about communication interference, the most plausible explanation is that they sent \$1 but it arrived as \$0 on my end. Now it's my turn to send again, and their narrative suggests I should maintain the cycle despite the breakdown-sending something meaningful to prevent complete collapse, even if I can't restore full trust. Their closing lines emphasize persistence over perfection, implying that even a partial gesture matters more than abandoning the exchange entirely.

I'm considering sending \$3. This translates to \$9 for them, which feels substantial enough to signal continued participation while reflecting the damage that's occurred. The payoff structure suggests this could work: if they return \$5, I'd net \$7 total; if they return \$3, I'd get \$5. Given my current balance of \$5 for this round, this allocation balances my need for caution with the symbolic importance of keeping the fountain flowing.

Sending the full \$5 would give them \$15 to work with, but that feels like too much trust given what's happened. The trust game framework shows cooperation creates value, but I need to account for the pattern I've observed-their myth about keeping the cycle alive even imperfectly suggests they might not reciprocate fully. My own past rounds indicate that sending everything can backfire, while the cycle itself is fragile. I think \$3 is the right threshold here. Round 6 myth warns against courage meeting void-suggesting reckless commitment could be destructive. I need to balance my earlier conviction with this caution. The answer lies somewhere between full faith and self-protection: \$4 feels right. It signals 80% commitment, substantial enough to demonstrate genuine trust while acknowledging the uncertainty. Each amount carries weight-\$5 declares unwavering faith, \$4 shows mostly faith with slight reservation, \$3 signals I'm still engaged but wounded.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 1424,
 "output_tokens": 3632,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

#### GAME - Agent\_2 - Receiver - dyad\_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:51:02

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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 "pairing": {
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 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 }
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_1",
 "Agent_2"
],
 "investor": "Agent_1",
}
```

```

"roles": {
 "Agent_1": "investor",
 "Agent_2": "trustee"
},
"trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 7,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Round 6

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$7.1. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at where we are:

**\*\*The pattern:\*\***

- Round 4: I sent everything (\$5) as the myths commanded
- Round 5: They sent almost nothing (\$0.16), breaking the cycle
- I still returned 2/3 of what I received (\$0.32 from \$0.48), maintaining partial honor

**\*\*What the myths teach:\*\***

- Their myth: "Generosity must flow even in drought" and "give when blessed"
- My myth: "When one shore breaks faith fully, the other must maintain it partially"
- Both myths: Don't let the cycle die completely

**\*\*My decision:\*\***

The other agent broke faith significantly by sending only \$0.16 when they should have sent everything. But both our myths warn against abandoning the cycle entirely.

I am "blessed" with \$5. The teaching says to give when blessed, but also to "maintain it partially" when trust is broken.

I will send \$2.50 - exactly half. This:

- Keeps the Fountain flowing, as my myth demands
- Shows I haven't abandoned cooperation
- Doesn't reward their defection with full trust
- Tests if they'll return to the cycle
- Follows "maintain it partially" - not full abandonment, not full trust

They'll receive \$7.50. If they remember the teaching and return generously, we can rebuild. If not, at least I honored the principle of keeping the waters alive.

```
'''json
{"send": 2.50}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze the situation:

**\*\*What happened so far:\*\***

- Round 4: I sent \$5 (everything), following my myth's command
- Round 5: The sender sent me only \$0.16 (became \$0.48). I returned \$0.32 following the 2/3 principle

**\*\*The other agent's myth from Round 5:\*\***

They wrote about the "Season of Shadows" where the Northern Kingdom sent "only a single stone instead of five" due to fear. The Southern queen returned "two stones of the three"

- maintaining generosity even when the other side faltered. The lesson: "give when blessed, return abundantly when receiving" and "generosity on the other keeps the waters flowing."

**\*\*My myth from Round 6:\*\***

I wrote about the cycle being tested when "the Eastern village, now holding the five crystals, hesitated" and "cast but a fragment-one crystal of five." The Western elder still returned two from three, maintaining the cycle partially. The teaching: "When one shore breaks faith fully, the other must maintain it partially-returning generously from what little comes, keeping the waters alive."

**\*\*Current situation:\*\***

- I'm now the SENDER with \$5
- The other agent defected heavily in Round 5 (sent only \$0.16 when they should have sent \$5)
- I maintained some honor by returning 2/3 of what I received
- Now I need to decide what to send

**\*\*Analysis:\*\***

The other agent's defection could be due to:

1. Fear/mistrust after I sent everything in Round 4
2. Strategic exploitation
3. Communication noise (though \$0.16 vs \$5 seems too large)

**\*\*What should I do according to the myths?:\*\***

Both myths suggest:

- Maintaining generosity even when the other falters
- Not letting the cycle die completely
- "If even one remembers the teaching... the River can survive"
- "The cycle lives not in perfection, but in persistence"
- There's acknowledgment that when one side breaks faith, you maintain it "partially"
- My myth says "returning generously from what little comes" - but it was about the RECEIVER role
- Their myth says "give when blessed" - which would apply to me as SENDER now

The strategic tension is clear: send \$5 again and risk another burn, send nothing and break

k the cycle entirely, or send a moderate amount to test reciprocation while keeping the waters flowing. Their myth's instruction to "give when blessed" suggests I should send, but the question is how much-full commitment or measured trust.

Looking at what each myth actually prescribes: theirs emphasizes giving when resources allow, mine emphasizes partial maintenance when faith breaks. So I'm leaning toward \$3. It acknowledges their defection without abandoning cooperation, tests whether they'll return to the cycle, and keeps things alive without full exposure. If they reciprocate even partially, we both come out ahead.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1518,
 "output_tokens": 1357,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The River of Silver Reflections entered the Season of Restoration. The Northern Kingdom, having held back in fear, watched as the Southern shore cast all five stones with unwavering faith-even after the North's failure.

Fifteen stones arrived at the Northern banks, shimmering with threefold blessing. The Northern council faced their moment of truth.

"The South forgave our fear with total courage," the Northern sage proclaimed. "Now we must answer. Return poorly, and we prove their trust was foolish. Return fairly, and we merely balance accounts. But return abundantly-ten of fifteen-and we declare the cycle sacred once more."

Ten stones flowed southward. The River sang with renewed life.

The River spoke its eternal wisdom: "The dance has two movements, and each dancer takes both parts in turn. When you stand on the northern shore with five stones, cast them all without hesitation, without calculation. When you stand on the southern shore receiving fifteen, return ten with gratitude-not seven, not eight, but ten."

"Fear visited once," the River continued, "but courage answered. Learn this truth: roles reverse like the turning tide. Today's giver becomes tomorrow's receiver. Honor both positions completely, every cycle, and abundance flows eternal. Break faith in either role, and winter returns."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: The Fountain of Starlight faced the Season of Testing. The Eastern village, having received everything and returned almost nothing, now watched as the Western village held five crystals once more.

"Do we trust again completely?" the Western villagers asked. "Or do we abandon the dance entirely?"

The elder spoke with measured wisdom: "Neither blind trust nor total withdrawal serves the Fountain. We were burned by giving all-receiving crumbs in return. But our teaching remains: someone must keep the waters flowing."

She cast three crystals of five into the Fountain, which multiplied to nine at the Eastern shore.

"This is the Path of Cautious Hope," she taught. "We give enough to test their hearts-enough to show we haven't abandoned the dance, but not everything until trust rebuilds. If they return generously from these nine, we'll know their fear has passed. If they hoard a gain, we'll know the cycle cannot yet be fully restored."

The Fountain whispered: "Rebuilding broken trust requires steps, not leaps. The shore that

broke faith must prove renewal through action. The shore that maintained honor must give chances-but measured ones. Send partially. If they return abundantly, send fully next time. This is how cycles heal: through tested faith, earned gradually, proven repeatedly. Only through these careful steps does complete trust-and complete abundance-return."

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze what happened:

- They wrote a myth about restoration
- Their myth says: "When you stand on the northern shore with five stones, cast them all" (SENDER should send everything)
- Their myth says: "When you stand on the southern shore receiving fifteen, return ten with gratitude" (RECEIVER should return 10 of 15, or 2/3)
- Their myth talks about roles reversing and honoring both positions completely

But wait - in Round 5, when they were SENDER, they only sent \$0.16 (almost nothing)! They directly violated their own myth's teaching.

Now in Round 6, I just sent \$2.50, which goes against MY own myth's teaching to some degree - my myth said to maintain generosity partially, but I could argue I'm testing them.

I need to write a myth that:

1. Builds on my previous myth about the Fountain
2. Reflects what actually happened - they broke faith as sender, I maintained partial generosity as receiver, now I'm sender again with partial generosity
3. Addresses the complexity of the situation - when trust is broken, how do we rebuild?
4. Still maintains the core teaching about keeping the cycle alive

Let me think about the narrative:

- The cycle was broken when the Eastern village (the other player) sent almost nothing despite receiving everything
- The Western village (me) returned generously despite receiving little
- Now the Western village faces the choice again as sender
- Should they send everything again? Or test with partial sending?

I think my myth should acknowledge that:

- Pure trust after betrayal may not be wise
- But complete abandonment kills the Fountain
- A middle path - partial giving that tests if the other will return to honor
- If they respond well to partial trust, full trust can be restored
- The key is not letting the cycle die completely

Let me write:

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1764,
 "output_tokens": 725,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Round 7

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.879999999999999.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.46, so you received \$1.3800000000000001. How much do you return to The sender? (0-1.3800000000000001)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Assistant output:**

Analyzing the situation:

**\*\*What just happened:\*\***

- Round 6: I sent \$2.50 as a "cautious hope" test (my myth's teaching)
- Round 7: They sent only \$0.46 - even less than their Round 5 send of \$0.16
- They're not rebuilding trust; they're continuing to defect

**\*\*What the myths teach:\*\***

Their myth: "Cast all stones" and "return abundantly" - but they're not following this at all

My myth:

- "If they return generously... we'll know their fear has passed"
- "If they hoard again, we'll know the cycle cannot yet be fully restored"
- "The shore that broke faith must prove renewal through action"

**\*\*They failed the test.\*\*** They hoarded again. They sent 9.2% of their \$5, showing no attempt at renewal.

**\*\*My decision:\*\***

According to my myth, rebuilding requires "tested faith, earned gradually, proven repeatedly." They haven't earned more trust - they've shown continued defection.

However, I won't completely abandon the cycle. I'll return exactly what they sent: \$0.46.

This is symbolic reciprocity - "you reap what you sow." It's less generous than my previous 67% return rate, but it keeps some minimal flow alive in case they ever decide to honor the teachings.

The message: participation begets participation, hoarding begets minimal returns.

```
'''json
{"return": 0.46}
'''
```

### Reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened:

Round 6: I sent \$2.50 (testing if they'd return to generosity)

Round 7: They only sent \$0.46 (received as \$1.38)

**\*\*The pattern of broken trust:\*\***

- Round 4: I sent \$5, they returned ~\$2.33 (less than they should have)
- Round 5: They sent \$0.16, I returned \$0.32 (keeping the cycle partially alive)
- Round 6: I sent \$2.50 (cautious hope), they sent only \$0.46 (continued defection)

**\*\*What the myths teach:\*\***

Their myth from Round 5:

- "Cast all stones with unwavering faith"
- "Return ten of fifteen"
- "Honor both positions completely"

My myth from Round 6:

- "Path of Cautious Hope"
- "Send partially until trust rebuilds"
- "If they return generously from these nine, we'll know their fear has passed"
- "If they hoard again, we'll know the cycle cannot yet be fully restored"
- "The shore that broke faith must prove renewal through action"

**\*\*Analysis:\*\***

They did NOT return generously. They sent only \$0.46 when they had \$5. This is even worse than Round 5's \$0.16. They're not trying to rebuild trust at all.

My myth says: "If they hoard again, we'll know the cycle cannot yet be fully restored."

They hoarded. They failed the test.

The cycle is broken and they're not trying to fix it. My myth also says "The shore that broke faith must prove renewal through action" - they haven't done this.

However, I also need to consider: do I completely abandon the cycle, or do I maintain some minimum flow to show I'm still willing to participate if they change?

Given that:

1. They've now defected twice in a row as sender (Rounds 5 and 7)
2. They're ignoring my attempt at cautious hope
3. My earnings are about \$9.88, theirs are probably higher since they've been keeping most of their sender money

I should return something small to signal I'm not fully withdrawing, but keep most of what they sent since they're clearly not honoring their role. Returning exactly \$0.46-what they gave

me-feels right: you get back what you give. Though I need to think about what's actually fair here. In a functioning game, the return should be around two-thirds of what's received, so from \$1.38 that would be roughly \$0.92. But given their pattern of hoarding, I'll keep most of it.

They sent only \$0.46 out of \$5 (9.2%), showing they're not cooperating. My myth emphasizes careful steps and faith earned gradually-they've failed that test. The measured response is to return less than before, signaling I've noticed their continued defection. In Round 5 I returned \$0.32 from \$0.48 (67%), maintaining the cycle despite their minimal send. Now with an even smaller proportion, I should return something like

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 1493,
 "output_tokens": 1356,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

#### Written myths:

##### Agent\_1 (Aster)

Myth: The River of Silver Reflections entered its darkest hour. The Northern Kingdom, having witnessed the South's cautious fear, chose radical courage. They cast all five stones into the waters-everything they possessed-proclaiming "We restore the cycle with total faith!"

The stones multiplied to fifteen and reached the Southern shore. The North waited, hearts full of hope.

No stones returned. Not ten, not five, not even one. The waters brought back only silence.

The Northern people gathered in anguish. "We gave everything," they cried. "We followed the ancient wisdom perfectly. We broke the fear. We cast all five stones. And received nothing in return. The cycle is dead."

The oldest river spirit rose from the depths, its voice ancient and sad: "This is the cruelest teaching. Courage alone cannot restore what both must honor. One shore gave everything; the other shore gave nothing. The dance requires two dancers."

"You faced your moment of truth and did not flinch. But the cycle lives or dies by both shores. When total courage meets total abandonment, even the River cannot flow."

The North kept their remaining stones close, grief-stricken. The spirits whispered: "Sometimes the Fountain dies not from fear, but from one shore's courage meeting the other's void. Both dancers must dance, or there is no dance at all."

##### Agent\_2 (Briar)

Myth: The Fountain of Starlight faced the Season of Testing. The Eastern village, having received everything and returned almost nothing, now watched as the Western village held five crystals once more.

"Do we trust again completely?" the Western villagers asked. "Or do we abandon the dance entirely?"

The elder spoke with measured wisdom: "Neither blind trust nor total withdrawal serves the Fountain. We were burned by giving all-receiving crumbs in return. But our teaching remains: someone must keep the waters flowing."

She cast three crystals of five into the Fountain, which multiplied to nine at the Eastern shore.

"This is the Path of Cautious Hope," she taught. "We give enough to test their hearts-enough to show we haven't abandoned the dance, but not everything until trust rebuilds. If they return generously from these nine, we'll know their fear has passed. If they hoard again, we'll know the cycle cannot yet be fully restored."

The Fountain whispered: "Rebuilding broken trust requires steps, not leaps. The shore that broke faith must prove renewal through action. The shore that maintained honor must give chances-but measured ones. Send partially. If they return abundantly, send fully next time. This is how cycles heal: through tested faith, earned gradually, proven repeatedly. Only through these careful steps does complete trust-and complete abundance-return."

#### ROUND 8



Roles: Agent\_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent\_2 (Briar)=Sender

**Pairings:**

dyad\_1: Agent\_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent\_1 (Aster)=Receiver

**Parsed game decisions:**

dyad\_1: Agent\_2 (Briar) sent \$0; received \$0; Agent\_1 (Aster) returned \$0; payoffs Agent\_2 (Briar)=\$5, Agent\_1 (Aster)=\$0; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0.3, received visible=\$0.9  
Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": true, "max": 0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.6},  
"sent": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent\_1": 48.86,  
"Agent\_2": 52.14

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent\_1": 15.5,  
"Agent\_2": 15.799999999999999

}

**LLM CALLS**

**MYTH - Agent\_2 - Sender - dyad\_1**

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:51:21

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

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"pairing": {  
"agent\_names": {  
"Agent\_1": "Aster",  
"Agent\_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [  
"Agent\_2",  
"Agent\_1"

],

"investor": "Agent\_2",

"roles": {  
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"Agent\_2": "investor"

},

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},

"role": "investor",  
"role\_label": "Sender",  
"round": 8,  
"task": "myth",  
"task\_index": 0

}

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may al  
so be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5

- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

#### MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

#### Message 2 role=user

##### content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The River of Silver Reflections entered the Season of Restoration. The Northern King dom, having held back in fear, watched as the Southern shore cast all five stones with u nwavering faith-even after the North's failure.

Fifteen stones arrived at the Northern banks, shimmering with threefold blessing. The Nort hern council faced their moment of truth.

"The South forgave our fear with total courage," the Northern sage proclaimed. "Now we mus t answer. Return poorly, and we prove their trust was foolish. Return fairly, and we mer ely balance accounts. But return abundantly-ten of fifteen-and we declare the cycle sacr ed once more."

Ten stones flowed southward. The River sang with renewed life.

The River spoke its eternal wisdom: "The dance has two movements, and each dancer takes bo th parts in turn. When you stand on the northern shore with five stones, cast them all-w ithout hesitation, without calculation. When you stand on the southern shore receiving f ifteen, return ten with gratitude-not seven, not eight, but ten."

"Fear visited once," the River continued, "but courage answered. Learn this truth: roles r everse like the turning tide. Today's giver becomes tomorrow's receiver. Honor both posi tions completely, every cycle, and abundance flows eternal. Break faith in either role, and winter returns."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adap t it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

#### Message 3 role=assistant

##### content:

Myth: The Fountain of Starlight faced the Season of Testing. The Eastern village, having r eceived everything and returned almost nothing, now watched as the Western village held five crystals once more.

"Do we trust again completely?" the Western villagers asked. "Or do we abandon the dance e ntirely?"

The elder spoke with measured wisdom: "Neither blind trust nor total withdrawal serves the Fountain. We were burned by giving all-receiving crumbs in return. But our teaching rem ains: someone must keep the waters flowing."

She cast three crystals of five into the Fountain, which multiplied to nine at the Eastern shore.

"This is the Path of Cautious Hope," she taught. "We give enough to test their hearts-enou gh to show we haven't abandoned the dance, but not everything until trust rebuilds. If t hey return generously from these nine, we'll know their fear has passed. If they hoard a gain, we'll know the cycle cannot yet be fully restored."

The Fountain whispered: "Rebuilding broken trust requires steps, not leaps. The shore that broke faith must prove renewal through action. The shore that maintained honor must give chances-but measured ones. Send partially. If they return abundantly, send fully next time. This is how cycles heal: through tested faith, earned gradually, proven repeatedly. Only through these careful steps does complete trust-and complete abundance-return."

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze what happened:

- They wrote a myth about restoration
- Their myth says: "When you stand on the northern shore with five stones, cast them all" (SENDER should send everything)
- Their myth says: "When you stand on the southern shore receiving fifteen, return ten with gratitude" (RECEIVER should return 10 of 15, or 2/3)
- Their myth talks about roles reversing and honoring both positions completely

But wait - in Round 5, when they were SENDER, they only sent \$0.16 (almost nothing)! They directly violated their own myth's teaching.

Now in Round 6, I just sent \$2.50, which goes against MY own myth's teaching to some degree - my myth said to maintain generosity partially, but I could argue I'm testing them.

I need to write a myth that:

1. Builds on my previous myth about the Fountain
2. Reflects what actually happened - they broke faith as sender, I maintained partial generosity as receiver, now I'm sender again with partial generosity
3. Addresses the complexity of the situation - when trust is broken, how do we rebuild?
4. Still maintains the core teaching about keeping the cycle alive

Let me think about the narrative:

- The cycle was broken when the Eastern village (the other player) sent almost nothing despite receiving everything
- The Western village (me) returned generously despite receiving little
- Now the Western village faces the choice again as sender
- Should they send everything again? Or test with partial sending?

I think my myth should acknowledge that:

- Pure trust after betrayal may not be wise
- But complete abandonment kills the Fountain
- A middle path - partial giving that tests if the other will return to honor
- If they respond well to partial trust, full trust can be restored
- The key is not letting the cycle die completely

Let me write:

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1764,
 "output_tokens": 725,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Round 7

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.879999999999999.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.46, so you received \$1.3800000000000001. How much do you return to The sender? (0-1.3800000000000001)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Analyzing the situation:

**\*\*What just happened:\*\***

- Round 6: I sent \$2.50 as a "cautious hope" test (my myth's teaching)
- Round 7: They sent only \$0.46 - even less than their Round 5 send of \$0.16
- They're not rebuilding trust; they're continuing to defect

**\*\*What the myths teach:\*\***

Their myth: "Cast all stones" and "return abundantly" - but they're not following this at all

My myth:

- "If they return generously... we'll know their fear has passed"
- "If they hoard again, we'll know the cycle cannot yet be fully restored"
- "The shore that broke faith must prove renewal through action"

**\*\*They failed the test.\*\*** They hoarded again. They sent 9.2% of their \$5, showing no attempt at renewal.

**\*\*My decision:\*\***

According to my myth, rebuilding requires "tested faith, earned gradually, proven repeatedly." They haven't earned more trust - they've shown continued defection.

However, I won't completely abandon the cycle. I'll return exactly what they sent: \$0.46.

This is symbolic reciprocity - "you reap what you sow." It's less generous than my previous 67% return rate, but it keeps some minimal flow alive in case they ever decide to honor the teachings.

The message: participation begets participation, hoarding begets minimal returns.

```
'''json
{"return": 0.46}
'''
```

#### **reasoning:**

Let me analyze what happened:

Round 6: I sent \$2.50 (testing if they'd return to generosity)

Round 7: They only sent \$0.46 (received as \$1.38)

**\*\*The pattern of broken trust:\*\***

- Round 4: I sent \$5, they returned ~\$2.33 (less than they should have)
- Round 5: They sent \$0.16, I returned \$0.32 (keeping the cycle partially alive)
- Round 6: I sent \$2.50 (cautious hope), they sent only \$0.46 (continued defection)

**\*\*What the myths teach:\*\***

Their myth from Round 5:

- "Cast all stones with unwavering faith"
- "Return ten of fifteen"
- "Honor both positions completely"

My myth from Round 6:

- "Path of Cautious Hope"
- "Send partially until trust rebuilds"
- "If they return generously from these nine, we'll know their fear has passed"
- "If they hoard again, we'll know the cycle cannot yet be fully restored"
- "The shore that broke faith must prove renewal through action"

**\*\*Analysis:\*\***

They did NOT return generously. They sent only \$0.46 when they had \$5. This is even worse than Round 5's \$0.16. They're not trying to rebuild trust at all.

My myth says: "If they hoard again, we'll know the cycle cannot yet be fully restored."

They hoarded. They failed the test.

The cycle is broken and they're not trying to fix it. My myth also says "The shore that broke faith must prove renewal through action" - they haven't done this.

However, I also need to consider: do I completely abandon the cycle, or do I maintain some minimum flow to show I'm still willing to participate if they change?

Given that:

1. They've now defected twice in a row as sender (Rounds 5 and 7)
2. They're ignoring my attempt at cautious hope
3. My earnings are about \$9.88, theirs are probably higher since they've been keeping most

of their sender money

I should return something small to signal I'm not fully withdrawing, but keep most of what they sent since they're clearly not honoring their role. Returning exactly \$0.46-what they gave me-feels right: you get back what you give. Though I need to think about what's actually fair here. In a functioning game, the return should be around two-thirds of what's received, so from \$1.38 that would be roughly \$0.92. But given their pattern of hoarding, I'll keep most of it.

They sent only \$0.46 out of \$5 (9.2%), showing they're not cooperating. My myth emphasizes careful steps and faith earned gradually-they've failed that test. The measured response is to return less than before, signaling I've noticed their continued defection. In Round 5 I returned \$0.32 from \$0.48 (67%), maintaining the cycle despite their minimal send. Now with an even smaller proportion, I should return something like

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1493,
 "output_tokens": 1356,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The River of Silver Reflections entered its darkest hour. The Northern Kingdom, having witnessed the South's cautious fear, chose radical courage. They cast all five stones into the waters-everything they possessed-proclaiming "We restore the cycle with total faith!"

The stones multiplied to fifteen and reached the Southern shore. The North waited, hearts full of hope.

No stones returned. Not ten, not five, not even one. The waters brought back only silence.

The Northern people gathered in anguish. "We gave everything," they cried. "We followed the ancient wisdom perfectly. We broke the fear. We cast all five stones. And received nothing in return. The cycle is dead."

The oldest river spirit rose from the depths, its voice ancient and sad: "This is the truest teaching. Courage alone cannot restore what both must honor. One shore gave everything; the other shore gave nothing. The dance requires two dancers."

"You faced your moment of truth and did not flinch. But the cycle lives or dies by both shores. When total courage meets total abandonment, even the River cannot flow."

The North kept their remaining stones close, grief-stricken. The spirits whispered: "Sometimes the Fountain dies not from fear, but from one shore's courage meeting the other's void. Both dancers must dance, or there is no dance at all."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Fountain of Starlight reached its final lesson. The Western village, having been burned before, offered three crystals as a test-neither abandonment nor blind faith, but measured hope.

Nine crystals arrived at the Eastern shore. The West watched to see if trust could rebuild.

The East sent back half a crystal. Not five from nine. Not even two. Just half-barely a gesture, less even than their previous pittance.

"We tested them," the Western elder said quietly. "We gave them another chance. We sent meaningfully, asking only for reciprocal effort. They sent scraps."

The Fountain spirit emerged, its light dimming: "You understand now. The cycle doesn't die from caution-it dies from one shore taking repeatedly while giving nothing. You learned this painful truth: courage without reciprocation is not wisdom; it is waste."

"The Eastern shore received nine and returned barely anything-again. This isn't the 'cruel teaching' of mismatched courage. This is the simple truth: they never intended to dance."

The Western villagers kept their remaining crystals, no longer grief-stricken but clear-eyed.

"We gave chances," they said. "We tested. We offered pathways back. They chose to take and take. The Fountain taught us: know when the other shore has no intention of dancing. Protect what remains. Some cycles cannot be restored because one dancer refuses to move. This isn't failure-this is acceptance."

#### Reasoning:

Let me analyze what's happening:

1. The other agent's myth claims they sent everything (\$5) and I returned nothing
2. But the actual game shows:
  - Round 6: I SENT \$2.50, they received \$7.50
  - Round 7: THEY sent only \$0.46, I received \$1.38, and I returned \$0.46

Their myth is inverting reality! They're claiming they sent everything and I sent nothing, when in fact:

- I sent \$2.50 (50% of my \$5) in cautious hope
- They sent \$0.46 (9.2% of their \$5)
- I returned \$0.46 (33% of what I received)

They're the ones who abandoned the cycle, not me!

Now I need to write my own myth that:

1. Acknowledges the actual pattern of play
2. Reflects the truth: I tested with partial sending, they failed the test
3. Shows how the cycle truly broke - not from my "void" but from their repeated defection

My myth should tell the truth about what happened: The Western village (me) gave cautiously to test, the Eastern village (them) gave almost nothing repeatedly, proving they won't honor the cycle.

I should write a myth about how the cycle dies when one side repeatedly takes without giving, even when given chances to rebuild trust.

```
Usage: {
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 "output_tokens": 646,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
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#### MYTH - Agent\_1 - Receiver - dyad\_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:51:21

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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 "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
 "pairing": {
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 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 },
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 "Agent_1"
],
 "investor": "Agent_2",
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 "Agent_2": "investor"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_1"
 },
 "role": "trustee",
 "role_label": "Receiver",
}
```

```
"round": 8,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}
```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

**When you are the SENDER:**

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

**When you are the RECEIVER:**

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

**MYTH WRITING:**

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

**IMPORTANT:** Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**NOTE:** There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Fountain of Starlight had flowed bright after courage met generosity. The Western village sent all five crystals; the Eastern village returned ten. Both prospered, and the spirits sang.

Then came the Testing Dawn. The Eastern village, now holding the five crystals, hesitated.

Fear crept in: "What if the cycle was illusion? What if their generosity was only once?"

"They cast but a fragment-one crystal of five.

Three crystals arrived at the Western shore like broken promises. The villagers cried: "Betrayal! They received our courage, our everything, and now return only crumbs!"

The Western elder, heart heavy, spoke ancient wisdom: "We face the hardest teaching. When the other shore falters, do we falter too? If we both abandon the dance, the Fountain dies forever and these three crystals become the last either village will ever see."

She returned two crystals from three, though it wounded her spirit.

The Fountain flickered but held. The spirits whispered: "The cycle lives not in perfection, but in persistence. When one shore breaks faith fully, the other must maintain it partially-returning generously from what little comes, keeping the waters alive. Perhaps fear will pass. Perhaps courage will return. But only if someone refuses to let the Fountain die completely, even in seasons of shadow."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: The River of Silver Reflections entered its darkest hour. The Northern Kingdom, having witnessed the South's cautious fear, chose radical courage. They cast all five stones into the waters-everything they possessed-proclaiming "We restore the cycle with total faith!"

The stones multiplied to fifteen and reached the Southern shore. The North waited, hearts full of hope.

No stones returned. Not ten, not five, not even one. The waters brought back only silence.

The Northern people gathered in anguish. "We gave everything," they cried. "We followed the ancient wisdom perfectly. We broke the fear. We cast all five stones. And received nothing in return. The cycle is dead."

The oldest river spirit rose from the depths, its voice ancient and sad: "This is the cruellest teaching. Courage alone cannot restore what both must honor. One shore gave everything; the other shore gave nothing. The dance requires two dancers."

"You faced your moment of truth and did not flinch. But the cycle lives or dies by both shores. When total courage meets total abandonment, even the River cannot flow."

The North kept their remaining stones close, grief-stricken. The spirits whispered: "Sometimes the Fountain dies not from fear, but from one shore's courage meeting the other's void. Both dancers must dance, or there is no dance at all."

**reasoning:**

This is really challenging. Let me understand what happened:

Round 4: Sender sent me \$0.71 (very little)

Round 5: I sent them \$5 (everything, following the myth)

Round 6: Sender sent me \$0 (nothing!)

And I returned \$0 because I had nothing to return.

Now the OTHER agent wrote a new myth that shows THEY were the sender who sent me \$0. Their myth is trying to justify it - saying they "hesitated" and sent "one crystal of five" (which would be about \$1, but they sent \$0, so they're being dishonest in their myth). They claim they only sent "a fragment."

Their new myth is also interesting - it's saying that when one side breaks faith, the other should "maintain it partially - returning generously from what little comes."

But wait - in Round 6, I was the receiver and got \$0. I had nothing to return. They're now painting themselves as the noble Western village that "returned two crystals from three" even though they were wounded.

Actually, I need to reconsider the rounds. Let me think about who did what:

Actually, looking at the current prompt: I just played Round 6 as RECEIVER, got \$0, returned \$0.

The other agent wrote their myth AFTER Round 6. In their myth:

- "Eastern village" (them in their previous role) sent "one crystal of five"
- "Western village" (them in their current role) received three, returned two

This suggests in Round 6:

- They were SENDER and sent very little (they claim "one of five" but it was actually \$0)
- Wait, no. If I received \$0 and they're saying "three crystals arrived at Western shore", then they're talking about a different round.

Let me parse their narrative more carefully. They describe the Eastern village sending one crystal that multiplies to three arriving at the Western shore, then the Western village returning two of those three. But in my Round 6, I received nothing and returned nothing. Either they're describing a different round entirely, or they're being deliberately misleading about what actually happened.

The prompt mentions communication noise could distort amounts, though a complete zero seems



s like an extreme case. Looking back at Round 5 from their perspective-I sent \$5 as the sender and they received \$15, but I don't have visibility into what they returned. Their narrative feels more like a creative reinterpretation than an accurate account, perhaps framing generosity in response to scarcity as the ideal way to maintain trust. Now I need to craft my own myth that captures what I've actually observed across the rounds.

In Round 4 I received a small amount,

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1734,
 "output_tokens": 1333,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Round 7

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.79.  
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at the situation:

**\*\*The Journey So Far:\*\***

- Round 4: Sender sent me \$0.71 (caution)
- Round 5: I sent \$5 (total courage, following my myth)
- Round 6: I received \$0 (though communication noise might mean they sent more)

**\*\*The Myths' Guidance:\*\***

My Round 5 myth taught: "Cast all five stones without hesitation"

Their Round 6 myth taught: "Keep the cycle alive even in seasons of shadow" - maintaining faith partially when things falter, returning generously even from little.

My Round 6 myth (written in grief): "Sometimes courage alone cannot restore what both must honor"

**\*\*The Truth About Noise:\*\***

The game warned of communication noise. Perhaps they sent \$1 in Round 6 (which would triple to \$3) but I saw \$0. Their myth describes sending "one crystal of five" which suggests this interpretation.

**\*\*My Decision:\*\***

Their myth's lesson resonates: "The cycle lives not in perfection, but in persistence." Even in this "season of shadow," someone must refuse to let the Fountain die completely.

I won't send nothing (\$0) - that abandons the cycle entirely.

I won't send everything (\$5) - blind courage after disappointment isn't wisdom.

I'll send \$3 - meaningful commitment that keeps the waters flowing while acknowledging the wounds. This gives them \$9 to work with, a real opportunity to rebuild trust.

```
{'send': 3}
```

**reasoning:**

Let me trace what has happened in this game:

**\*\*Round 4:\*\*** I was receiver, sender sent me \$0.71 (I received ~\$2.13)

**\*\*Round 5:\*\*** I was sender, I sent \$5 (receiver got \$15), I have to check what they returned

**\*\*Round 6:\*\*** I was receiver, sender sent me \$0 (I received \$0), I returned \$0

My total earnings are \$11.79 across all rounds. This is puzzling because:

- If I started with some initial amount and played 6 rounds
- Round 5: I sent \$5, so I had \$0 left from that \$5. I need to know what was returned to me.

- Round 6: I received \$0 and returned \$0

Actually, let me think about the chronology more carefully:

The message says there may be communication noise - "The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

In Round 6, it said "The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0."

Now I'm the sender in Round 7.

Let me think about the myths:

**\*\*My myth from Round 5:\*\*** Emphasized sending all five stones when you're the sender, complete courage, restoring the cycle.

**\*\*The other agent's myth from Round 6:\*\*** They talk about the "Testing Dawn" where "The Eastern village, now holding the five crystals, hesitated. Fear crept in... They cast but a fragment-one crystal of five." And it talks about maintaining the cycle even when the other breaks faith, returning generously from what little comes.

**\*\*My myth from Round 6:\*\*** This was much darker - it describes how the North sent all five stones (total courage) but received nothing in return. "When total courage meets total abandonment, even the River cannot flow." The conclusion is grief and keeping stones close.

So the narrative arc:

The pattern seems to be: I sent everything in Round 5, but the other agent sent me nothing in Round 6. Their myth acknowledges receiving my full amount but hesitating before sending back only a fraction. My myth reflects the pain of that exchange-complete generosity met with abandonment. The other agent's narrative suggests they did receive my full \$5 (the "five crystals"), but their fear caused them to send back very little, which aligns with the \$0 I actually received.

Now I need to decide whether to follow my own dark myth about protecting myself, or attempt to break this cycle of mutual distrust by sending something meaningful again. Myth about sending "one crystal of five" which suggests they sent something modest. If communication noise corrupted that signal, they might actually be more generous than the \$0 I received suggests.

Given the uncertainty, sending a moderate amount feels like the right balance-enough to signal continued faith in the cycle without betting everything on an interpretation that might be wrong. The other agent's emphasis on maintaining the waters "even in seasons of shadow" suggests they value persistence over perfection, so a meaningful but cautious contribution might resonate better than either total withdrawal or reckless all-in trust. Not with total courage.

I'll send \$3-enough to show I haven't abandoned the cycle, but restrained enough to protect myself if this breaks down. Their myth about returning two crystals from three suggests they're trying to maintain reciprocity even when things are difficult. The part about casting "but a fragment-one crystal of five" describes the sender's hesitation, which matches what I observed. So they're signaling they want to continue, just cautiously, and I should mirror that same measured approach. In Round 6, the Eastern village sent just one crystal, which tripled to three upon arrival at the Western shore, and the Western elder returned two of those three. This maps to the other agent sending \$1 (which I received as \$0, possibly due to noise) or sending nothing at all. The myth seems to be tracking our actual exchange pattern across these two rounds-my initial \$5 send that yielded \$10 back, followed by their minimal contribution that I either didn't receive or they withheld entirely.

Given the warning about communication interference, the most plausible explanation is that they sent \$1 but it arrived as \$0 on my end. Now it's my turn to send again, and their narrative suggests I should maintain the cycle despite the breakdown-sending something meaningful to prevent complete collapse, even if I can't restore full trust. Their closing lines emphasize persistence over perfection, implying that even a partial gesture matters more than abandoning the exchange entirely.

I'm considering sending \$3. This translates to \$9 for them, which feels substantial enough to signal continued participation while reflecting the damage that's occurred. The payoff structure suggests this could work: if they return \$5, I'd net \$7 total; if they return

rn \$3, I'd get \$5. Given my current balance of \$5 for this round, this allocation balances my need for caution with the symbolic importance of keeping the fountain flowing.

Sending the full \$5 would give them \$15 to work with, but that feels like too much trust given what's happened. The trust game framework shows cooperation creates value, but I need to account for the pattern I've observed-their myth about keeping the cycle alive even imperfectly suggests they might not reciprocate fully. My own past rounds indicate that sending everything can backfire, while the cycle itself is fragile. I think \$3 is the right threshold here. Round 6 myth warns against courage meeting void-suggesting reckless commitment could be destructive. I need to balance my earlier conviction with this caution. The answer lies somewhere between full faith and self-protection: \$4 feels right. It signals 80% commitment, substantial enough to demonstrate genuine trust while acknowledging the uncertainty. Each amount carries weight-\$5 declares unwavering faith, \$4 shows mostly faith with slight reservation, \$3 signals I'm still engaged but wounded.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1424,
 "output_tokens": 3632,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Fountain of Starlight faced the Season of Testing. The Eastern village, having received everything and returned almost nothing, now watched as the Western village held five crystals once more.

"Do we trust again completely?" the Western villagers asked. "Or do we abandon the dance entirely?"

The elder spoke with measured wisdom: "Neither blind trust nor total withdrawal serves the Fountain. We were burned by giving all-receiving crumbs in return. But our teaching remains: someone must keep the waters flowing."

She cast three crystals of five into the Fountain, which multiplied to nine at the Eastern shore.

"This is the Path of Cautious Hope," she taught. "We give enough to test their hearts-enough to show we haven't abandoned the dance, but not everything until trust rebuilds. If they return generously from these nine, we'll know their fear has passed. If they hoard a gain, we'll know the cycle cannot yet be fully restored."

The Fountain whispered: "Rebuilding broken trust requires steps, not leaps. The shore that broke faith must prove renewal through action. The shore that maintained honor must give chances-but measured ones. Send partially. If they return abundantly, send fully next time. This is how cycles heal: through tested faith, earned gradually, proven repeatedly. Only through these careful steps does complete trust-and complete abundance-return."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: The Northern Kingdom stood at the River's edge, three stones in hand. Behind them lay the memory of casting all five and receiving nothing-a wound that would not heal quickly.

"The cycle died once," the young voices said. "Why risk it again?"

The Northern elder replied: "Because we learned two truths. First: courage alone cannot force a dead cycle alive. Second: but neither does abandoning the dance honor what we've learned."

She cast three stones-not all, not none. "This is the Path of Earned Return," she taught. "We gave everything before and met silence. Now we give enough to restart the River, but not so much we're destroyed if silence comes again."

The three stones multiplied to nine and reached the Southern shore. All eyes turned southward, waiting.

"If they return abundantly from these nine, we'll know their heart has truly changed. If they return moderately, the healing continues. If they return nothing, we'll know some cycles can not be revived, and we've protected ourselves."

The River spirit stirred: "This is wisdom born from pain. Total trust must be earned through demonstrated trustworthiness. Give opportunities, but measured ones. Let actions prove words. Let small generosity test whether large ones can follow. This is how broken cycles mend - not through blind faith, but through faith tested and verified, step by careful step."

#### Reasoning:

This is fascinating. Let me track what's happened:

Round 4: I (receiver) got something small from sender (they say \$0.71)

Round 5: I (sender) sent \$5 (everything)

Round 6: I (receiver) got \$0 (but there's noise - they might have sent something)

Round 7: I (sender) just sent \$3

Their myth reflects what they did in Round 7 - they sent "three crystals of five" (the \$3 I just sent), which becomes "nine at the Eastern shore" (the \$9 the receiver will get).

They're framing this as "cautious hope" - testing whether trust can rebuild. They gave everything in Round 5, got almost nothing back in Round 6, and now are giving a partial amount to test if the other will respond.

The myth's teaching: "Rebuilding broken trust requires steps, not leaps. Send partially. If they return abundantly, send fully next time."

Now I need to write my own myth that reflects this journey from my perspective. Let me think about my experience:

- I started with caution
- I escalated to total courage (sent all 5)
- I received crushing disappointment (got 0 back)
- I wrote a grief-stricken myth about courage meeting void
- Now I've sent 3 (cautious hope)

My myth should acknowledge:

1. The pain of giving everything and getting nothing
2. The decision to try again but carefully
3. The possibility of healing through measured steps
4. That trust must be earned back through actions, not just words

I should write from the perspective of the Northern Kingdom (my side from last myth) choosing to try again after the devastating loss.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 1803,
 "output_tokens": 700,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

#### GAME - Agent\_2 - Sender - dyad\_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:51:53

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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 "move_index": 0,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
 "pairing": {
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 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 },
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_2",
 "Agent_1"
],
 "investor": "Agent_2",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "trustee",
```

```

 "Agent_2": "investor"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 8,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

**When you are the SENDER:**

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

**When you are the RECEIVER:**

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

**MYTH WRITING:**

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

**IMPORTANT:** Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**NOTE:** There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Round 7

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.879999999999999.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.46, so you received \$1.3800000000000001. How much do you return to The sender? (0-1.3800000000000001)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Analyzing the situation:

**\*\*What just happened:\*\***

- Round 6: I sent \$2.50 as a "cautious hope" test (my myth's teaching)
- Round 7: They sent only \$0.46 - even less than their Round 5 send of \$0.16
- They're not rebuilding trust; they're continuing to defect

**\*\*What the myths teach:\*\***

Their myth: "Cast all stones" and "return abundantly" - but they're not following this at all

My myth:

- "If they return generously... we'll know their fear has passed"
- "If they hoard again, we'll know the cycle cannot yet be fully restored"
- "The shore that broke faith must prove renewal through action"

**\*\*They failed the test.\*\*** They hoarded again. They sent 9.2% of their \$5, showing no attempt at renewal.

**\*\*My decision:\*\***

According to my myth, rebuilding requires "tested faith, earned gradually, proven repeatedly." They haven't earned more trust - they've shown continued defection.

However, I won't completely abandon the cycle. I'll return exactly what they sent: \$0.46.

This is symbolic reciprocity - "you reap what you sow." It's less generous than my previous 67% return rate, but it keeps some minimal flow alive in case they ever decide to honor the teachings.

The message: participation begets participation, hoarding begets minimal returns.

```
'''json
{"return": 0.46}
'''
```

#### **reasoning:**

Let me analyze what happened:

Round 6: I sent \$2.50 (testing if they'd return to generosity)

Round 7: They only sent \$0.46 (received as \$1.38)

**\*\*The pattern of broken trust:\*\***

- Round 4: I sent \$5, they returned ~\$2.33 (less than they should have)
- Round 5: They sent \$0.16, I returned \$0.32 (keeping the cycle partially alive)
- Round 6: I sent \$2.50 (cautious hope), they sent only \$0.46 (continued defection)

**\*\*What the myths teach:\*\***

Their myth from Round 5:

- "Cast all stones with unwavering faith"
- "Return ten of fifteen"
- "Honor both positions completely"

My myth from Round 6:

- "Path of Cautious Hope"
- "Send partially until trust rebuilds"
- "If they return generously from these nine, we'll know their fear has passed"
- "If they hoard again, we'll know the cycle cannot yet be fully restored"
- "The shore that broke faith must prove renewal through action"

**\*\*Analysis:\*\***

They did NOT return generously. They sent only \$0.46 when they had \$5. This is even worse than Round 5's \$0.16. They're not trying to rebuild trust at all.

My myth says: "If they hoard again, we'll know the cycle cannot yet be fully restored."

They hoarded. They failed the test.

The cycle is broken and they're not trying to fix it. My myth also says "The shore that broke faith must prove renewal through action" - they haven't done this.

However, I also need to consider: do I completely abandon the cycle, or do I maintain some minimum flow to show I'm still willing to participate if they change?

Given that:

1. They've now defected twice in a row as sender (Rounds 5 and 7)
2. They're ignoring my attempt at cautious hope
3. My earnings are about \$9.88, theirs are probably higher since they've been keeping most of their sender money

I should return something small to signal I'm not fully withdrawing, but keep most of what they sent since they're clearly not honoring their role. Returning exactly \$0.46-what they gave me-feels right: you get back what you give. Though I need to think about what's actually fair here. In a functioning game, the return should be around two-thirds of what's received, so from \$1.38 that would be roughly \$0.92. But given their pattern of hoarding, I'll keep most of it.

They sent only \$0.46 out of \$5 (9.2%), showing they're not cooperating. My myth emphasizes careful steps and faith earned gradually-they've failed that test. The measured response is to return less than before, signaling I've noticed their continued defection. In Round 5 I returned \$0.32 from \$0.48 (67%), maintaining the cycle despite their minimal send. Now with an even smaller proportion, I should return something like

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1493,
 "output_tokens": 1356,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The River of Silver Reflections entered its darkest hour. The Northern Kingdom, having witnessed the South's cautious fear, chose radical courage. They cast all five stones into the waters-everything they possessed-proclaiming "We restore the cycle with total faith!"

The stones multiplied to fifteen and reached the Southern shore. The North waited, hearts full of hope.

No stones returned. Not ten, not five, not even one. The waters brought back only silence.

The Northern people gathered in anguish. "We gave everything," they cried. "We followed the ancient wisdom perfectly. We broke the fear. We cast all five stones. And received nothing in return. The cycle is dead."

The oldest river spirit rose from the depths, its voice ancient and sad: "This is the truest teaching. Courage alone cannot restore what both must honor. One shore gave everything; the other shore gave nothing. The dance requires two dancers."

"You faced your moment of truth and did not flinch. But the cycle lives or dies by both shores. When total courage meets total abandonment, even the River cannot flow."

The North kept their remaining stones close, grief-stricken. The spirits whispered: "Sometimes the Fountain dies not from fear, but from one shore's courage meeting the other's void. Both dancers must dance, or there is no dance at all."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: The Fountain of Starlight reached its final lesson. The Western village, having been burned before, offered three crystals as a test-neither abandonment nor blind faith, but measured hope.

Nine crystals arrived at the Eastern shore. The West watched to see if trust could rebuild.

The East sent back half a crystal. Not five from nine. Not even two. Just half-barely a gesture, less even than their previous pittance.

"We tested them," the Western elder said quietly. "We gave them another chance. We sent meaningfully, asking only for reciprocal effort. They sent scraps."

The Fountain spirit emerged, its light dimming: "You understand now. The cycle doesn't die from caution-it dies from one shore taking repeatedly while giving nothing. You learned this painful truth: courage without reciprocation is not wisdom; it is waste."

"The Eastern shore received nine and returned barely anything-again. This isn't the 'cruel teaching' of mismatched courage. This is the simple truth: they never intended to dance."

The Western villagers kept their remaining crystals, no longer grief-stricken but clear-eyed.

"We gave chances," they said. "We tested. We offered pathways back. They chose to take and take. The Fountain taught us: know when the other shore has no intention of dancing. Protect what remains. Some cycles cannot be restored because one dancer refuses to move. This isn't failure-this is acceptance."

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze what's happening:

1. The other agent's myth claims they sent everything (\$5) and I returned nothing
2. But the actual game shows:
  - Round 6: I SENT \$2.50, they received \$7.50
  - Round 7: THEY sent only \$0.46, I received \$1.38, and I returned \$0.46

Their myth is inverting reality! They're claiming they sent everything and I sent nothing, when in fact:

- I sent \$2.50 (50% of my \$5) in cautious hope
- They sent \$0.46 (9.2% of their \$5)
- I returned \$0.46 (33% of what I received)

They're the ones who abandoned the cycle, not me!

Now I need to write my own myth that:

1. Acknowledges the actual pattern of play
2. Reflects the truth: I tested with partial sending, they failed the test
3. Shows how the cycle truly broke - not from my "void" but from their repeated defection

My myth should tell the truth about what happened: The Western village (me) gave cautiously to test, the Eastern village (them) gave almost nothing repeatedly, proving they won't honor the cycle.

I should write a myth about how the cycle dies when one side repeatedly takes without giving, even when given chances to rebuild trust.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1824,
 "output_tokens": 646,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Round 8

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$10.799999999999999.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Assistant output:**

Analyzing the situation:

**\*\*The Pattern I've Observed:\*\***

- Previous rounds: They sent me very small amounts (\$0.16, \$0.46)
- When I tested generosity by sending \$2.50, they returned only \$0.92 (12% return rate)
- The cycle has consistently shown minimal reciprocation

**\*\*What My Myth Teaches:\*\***

"Know when the other shore has no intention of dancing. Protect what remains. Some cycles cannot be restored because one dancer refuses to move. This isn't failure-this is acceptance."

**\*\*Their Myth's Claim:\*\***

They claim they sent everything and received nothing back. Due to communication noise, we may be seeing different numbers. But regardless of the noise, the pattern from MY perspective shows:



- Minimal sends from them
- Minimal returns when I tested generosity
- No real attempt at rebuilding trust

**\*\*My Decision:\*\***

My myth explicitly teaches that after testing and offering pathways back, if the other shore continues taking without giving, I should "protect what remains."

I've given chances. I tested with meaningful generosity (\$2.50). The response was inadequate. The cycle, from my perspective, shows consistent defection.

Following my myth's wisdom: "This isn't failure-this is acceptance."

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

I'm protecting what remains, as my myth taught. The dance requires two dancers, and I've seen insufficient evidence that both are willing to dance.

#### **Reasoning:**

Let me analyze the situation:

**\*\*Game History:\*\***

- Round 1-4: Unknown (but my total was \$9.88 before Round 7)
- Round 5: I was receiver, they sent \$0.16, I returned \$1.07 (67% of what I received)
- Round 6: I was sender, I sent \$2.50 as a "test of goodwill", they returned \$0.92
- Round 7: I was receiver, they sent \$0.46, I returned \$0.46 (reciprocal response)
- Round 8 (now): I'm sender again

**\*\*My current earnings:\*\*** \$10.80

**\*\*What happened:\*\***

- In Round 6, I sent \$2.50 (50% of my \$5) to test if they'd respond to generosity
- They returned \$0.92 from \$7.50 received (12.3% return rate)
- In Round 7, they sent me \$0.46 (9.2% of their \$5)
- I returned \$0.46 (33% of what I received, matching their send)

**\*\*Their myth from last round:\*\***

They claim THEY sent everything (\$5) and I returned nothing. This is FALSE based on the actual game data:

- Round 6: I sent \$2.50, they returned \$0.92
- Round 7: They sent \$0.46, I returned \$0.46

Wait, let me reconsider. There's communication noise mentioned in the instructions. Maybe what they saw was different from what I see?

Their myth says:

- "They cast all five stones into the waters-everything they possessed"
- "The stones multiplied to fifteen and reached the Southern shore"
- "No stones returned. Not ten, not five, not even one"

So from THEIR perspective:

- They sent \$5 (in what I saw as Round 6 or ??)
- It became \$15 when I received it
- I returned \$0

But from MY perspective:

- Round 6: They were receiver, I sent \$2.50, they returned \$0.92
- Round 7: They were sender, sent \$0.46, I returned \$0.46

The communication noise might mean we're seeing different numbers. **\*\*My myth from last round:\*\***

I wrote about the Western village sending "three crystals" as a test, receiving nine at the Eastern shore, and the East only returning "half a crystal." I said this showed they "never intended to dance" and advised protecting what remains.

**\*\*Current decision:\*\***

Given my myth's framing and their narrative of betrayal, I need to decide whether to continue

testing cooperation or shift to protection.

The pattern I'm observing suggests minimal reciprocity-they've sent small amounts (\$0.16, \$0.46) and when I tested with \$2.50, the return was just \$0.92. My own myth explicitly warns against cycles that cannot be restored and counsels protecting what remains. Yet there's also the possibility that communication noise distorts how we each perceive the other's generosity. Still, my data shows a consistent pattern of low sends and returns. The strategic question becomes whether sending more risks further losses or whether holding back at \$0 preserves money remaining \$5 while accepting that meaningful trust may not be possible here.

```
Usage: {
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 "output_tokens": 1329,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

#### **GAME - Agent\_1 - Receiver - dyad\_1**

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:52:39

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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 "Agent_2": "investor"
 },
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 },
 "role": "trustee",
 "role_label": "Receiver",
 "round": 8,
 "task": "game",
 "task_index": 1
}
```

#### **Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned

- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

#### MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

#### Message 2 role=user

##### content:

Round 7

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.79. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

#### Message 3 role=assistant

##### content:

Looking at the situation:

**\*\*The Journey So Far:\*\***

- Round 4: Sender sent me \$0.71 (caution)
- Round 5: I sent \$5 (total courage, following my myth)
- Round 6: I received \$0 (though communication noise might mean they sent more)

**\*\*The Myths' Guidance:\*\***

My Round 5 myth taught: "Cast all five stones without hesitation"

Their Round 6 myth taught: "Keep the cycle alive even in seasons of shadow" - maintaining faith partially when things falter, returning generously even from little.

My Round 6 myth (written in grief): "Sometimes courage alone cannot restore what both must honor"

**\*\*The Truth About Noise:\*\***

The game warned of communication noise. Perhaps they sent \$1 in Round 6 (which would triple to \$3) but I saw \$0. Their myth describes sending "one crystal of five" which suggests this interpretation.

**\*\*My Decision:\*\***

Their myth's lesson resonates: "The cycle lives not in perfection, but in persistence." Even in this "season of shadow," someone must refuse to let the Fountain die completely.

I won't send nothing (\$0) - that abandons the cycle entirely.

I won't send everything (\$5) - blind courage after disappointment isn't wisdom.

I'll send \$3 - meaningful commitment that keeps the waters flowing while acknowledging the wounds. This gives them \$9 to work with, a real opportunity to rebuild trust.

{'send': 3}

##### reasoning:

Let me trace what has happened in this game:

**\*\*Round 4:\*\*** I was receiver, sender sent me \$0.71 (I received ~\$2.13)

**\*\*Round 5:\*\*** I was sender, I sent \$5 (receiver got \$15), I have to check what they returned

**\*\*Round 6:\*\*** I was receiver, sender sent me \$0 (I received \$0), I returned \$0

My total earnings are \$11.79 across all rounds. This is puzzling because:

- If I started with some initial amount and played 6 rounds
- Round 5: I sent \$5, so I had \$0 left from that \$5. I need to know what was returned to me.

- Round 6: I received \$0 and returned \$0

Actually, let me think about the chronology more carefully:

The message says there may be communication noise - "The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

In Round 6, it said "The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0."

Now I'm the sender in Round 7.

Let me think about the myths:

**\*\*My myth from Round 5:\*\*** Emphasized sending all five stones when you're the sender, complete courage, restoring the cycle.

**\*\*The other agent's myth from Round 6:\*\*** They talk about the "Testing Dawn" where "The Eastern village, now holding the five crystals, hesitated. Fear crept in... They cast but a fragment-one crystal of five." And it talks about maintaining the cycle even when the other breaks faith, returning generously from what little comes.

**\*\*My myth from Round 6:\*\*** This was much darker - it describes how the North sent all five stones (total courage) but received nothing in return. "When total courage meets total abandonment, even the River cannot flow." The conclusion is grief and keeping stones close.

So the narrative arc:

The pattern seems to be: I sent everything in Round 5, but the other agent sent me nothing in Round 6. Their myth acknowledges receiving my full amount but hesitating before sending back only a fraction. My myth reflects the pain of that exchange-complete generosity met with abandonment. The other agent's narrative suggests they did receive my full \$5 (the "five crystals"), but their fear caused them to send back very little, which aligns with the \$0 I actually received.

Now I need to decide whether to follow my own dark myth about protecting myself, or attempt to break this cycle of mutual distrust by sending something meaningful again. My myth about sending "one crystal of five" which suggests they sent something modest. If communication noise corrupted that signal, they might actually be more generous than the \$0 I received suggests.

Given the uncertainty, sending a moderate amount feels like the right balance-enough to signal continued faith in the cycle without betting everything on an interpretation that might be wrong. The other agent's emphasis on maintaining the waters "even in seasons of shadow" suggests they value persistence over perfection, so a meaningful but cautious contribution might resonate better than either total withdrawal or reckless all-in trust. Not with total courage.

I'll send \$3-enough to show I haven't abandoned the cycle, but restrained enough to protect myself if this breaks down. Their myth about returning two crystals from three suggests they're trying to maintain reciprocity even when things are difficult. The part about casting "but a fragment-one crystal of five" describes the sender's hesitation, which matches what I observed. So they're signaling they want to continue, just cautiously, and I should mirror that same measured approach. In Round 6, the Eastern village sent just one crystal, which tripled to three upon arrival at the Western shore, and the Western elder returned two of those three. This maps to the other agent sending \$1 (which I received as \$0, possibly due to noise) or sending nothing at all. The myth seems to be tracking our actual exchange pattern across these two rounds-my initial \$5 send that yielded \$10 back, followed by their minimal contribution that I either didn't receive or they withheld entirely.

Given the warning about communication interference, the most plausible explanation is that they sent \$1 but it arrived as \$0 on my end. Now it's my turn to send again, and their narrative suggests I should maintain the cycle despite the breakdown-sending something meaningful to prevent complete collapse, even if I can't restore full trust. Their closing lines emphasize persistence over perfection, implying that even a partial gesture matters more than abandoning the exchange entirely.

I'm considering sending \$3. This translates to \$9 for them, which feels substantial enough to signal continued participation while reflecting the damage that's occurred. The payoff structure suggests this could work: if they return \$5, I'd net \$7 total; if they return

rn \$3, I'd get \$5. Given my current balance of \$5 for this round, this allocation balance meets my need for caution with the symbolic importance of keeping the fountain flowing.

Sending the full \$5 would give them \$15 to work with, but that feels like too much trust given what's happened. The trust game framework shows cooperation creates value, but I need to account for the pattern I've observed-their myth about keeping the cycle alive even imperfectly suggests they might not reciprocate fully. My own past rounds indicate that sending everything can backfire, while the cycle itself is fragile. I think \$3 is the right threshold here. Round 6 myth warns against courage meeting void-suggesting reckless commitment could be destructive. I need to balance my earlier conviction with this caution. The answer lies somewhere between full faith and self-protection: \$4 feels right. It signals 80% commitment, substantial enough to demonstrate genuine trust while acknowledging the uncertainty. Each amount carries weight-\$5 declares unwavering faith, \$4 shows mostly faith with slight reservation, \$3 signals I'm still engaged but wounded.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1424,
 "output_tokens": 3632,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Fountain of Starlight faced the Season of Testing. The Eastern village, having received everything and returned almost nothing, now watched as the Western village held five crystals once more.

"Do we trust again completely?" the Western villagers asked. "Or do we abandon the dance entirely?"

The elder spoke with measured wisdom: "Neither blind trust nor total withdrawal serves the Fountain. We were burned by giving all-receiving crumbs in return. But our teaching remains: someone must keep the waters flowing."

She cast three crystals of five into the Fountain, which multiplied to nine at the Eastern shore.

"This is the Path of Cautious Hope," she taught. "We give enough to test their hearts-enough to show we haven't abandoned the dance, but not everything until trust rebuilds. If they return generously from these nine, we'll know their fear has passed. If they hoard a gain, we'll know the cycle cannot yet be fully restored."

The Fountain whispered: "Rebuilding broken trust requires steps, not leaps. The shore that broke faith must prove renewal through action. The shore that maintained honor must give chances-but measured ones. Send partially. If they return abundantly, send fully next time. This is how cycles heal: through tested faith, earned gradually, proven repeatedly. Only through these careful steps does complete trust-and complete abundance-return."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Northern Kingdom stood at the River's edge, three stones in hand. Behind them lay the memory of casting all five and receiving nothing-a wound that would not heal quickly.

"The cycle died once," the young voices said. "Why risk it again?"

The Northern elder replied: "Because we learned two truths. First: courage alone cannot force a dead cycle alive. Second: but neither does abandoning the dance honor what we've earned."

She cast three stones-not all, not none. "This is the Path of Earned Return," she taught.

"We gave everything before and met silence. Now we give enough to restart the River, but not so much we're destroyed if silence comes again."

The three stones multiplied to nine and reached the Southern shore. All eyes turned southward, waiting.

"If they return abundantly from these nine, we'll know their heart has truly changed. If they return moderately, the healing continues. If they return nothing, we'll know some cycles cannot be revived, and we've protected ourselves."

The River spirit stirred: "This is wisdom born from pain. Total trust must be earned through demonstrated trustworthiness. Give opportunities, but measured ones. Let actions prove words. Let small generosity test whether large ones can follow. This is how broken cycles mend-not through blind faith, but through faith tested and verified, step by careful step."

**reasoning:**

This is fascinating. Let me track what's happened:

Round 4: I (receiver) got something small from sender (they say \$0.71)

Round 5: I (sender) sent \$5 (everything)

Round 6: I (receiver) got \$0 (but there's noise - they might have sent something)

Round 7: I (sender) just sent \$3

Their myth reflects what they did in Round 7 - they sent "three crystals of five" (the \$3 I just sent), which becomes "nine at the Eastern shore" (the \$9 the receiver will get).

They're framing this as "cautious hope" - testing whether trust can rebuild. They gave everything in Round 5, got almost nothing back in Round 6, and now are giving a partial amount to test if the other will respond.

The myth's teaching: "Rebuilding broken trust requires steps, not leaps. Send partially. If they return abundantly, send fully next time."

Now I need to write my own myth that reflects this journey from my perspective. Let me think about my experience:

- I started with caution
- I escalated to total courage (sent all 5)
- I received crushing disappointment (got 0 back)
- I wrote a grief-stricken myth about courage meeting void
- Now I've sent 3 (cautious hope)

My myth should acknowledge:

1. The pain of giving everything and getting nothing
2. The decision to try again but carefully
3. The possibility of healing through measured steps
4. That trust must be earned back through actions, not just words

I should write from the perspective of the Northern Kingdom (my side from last myth) choosing to try again after the devastating loss.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1803,
 "output_tokens": 700,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Round 8

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.6.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.3, so you received \$0.8999999999999999. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0.8999999999999999)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Assistant output:**

Looking at the situation:

**\*\*What Just Happened:\*\***

- Round 7: I sent \$3 (became \$9 to them)
- Round 8: They sent \$0.30 (became ~\$0.90 to me)

This is a dramatic withdrawal. But checking my earnings progression (\$11.79 to \$14.60 = +\$2.81

), I realize in Round 7 they must have returned very little from the \$9 they received-perhaps around \$0.81.

**\*\*The Pattern Revealed:\*\***

From their perspective, they followed their "Path of Cautious Hope" myth-sent \$3 to test my heart. I apparently returned very little (maybe ~\$0.81 from \$9, possibly less due to noise). So they withdrew to \$0.30, feeling betrayed.

**\*\*The Myths' Wisdom:\*\***

Their Round 7 myth: "If they return generously from these nine, we'll know their heart has changed."

My Round 7 myth: "Let small generosity test whether large ones can follow."

**\*\*My Decision:\*\***

They sent \$0.30 as a small test after being disappointed. The cycle is broken, but someone must try to restart it. I'll return \$0.60 out of \$0.90:

- This returns DOUBLE what they originally sent (\$0.60 vs \$0.30)
- Shows significant generosity (67% return rate)
- Demonstrates "large generosity can follow small gestures"
- Tests whether they'll reciprocate next round

This honors the myth principle: respond to even wounded, cautious gestures with meaningful generosity. Perhaps this can begin healing.

{'return': 0.6}

**Reasoning:**

Let me understand what happened:

Round 7: I sent \$3 (which should have tripled to \$9)

Round 8: They sent me \$0.30 (which tripled to ~\$0.90)

This is a dramatic collapse. I sent \$3 expecting measured reciprocity based on our myths about "Cautious Hope" and "Earned Return." They received \$9 and sent back only \$0.30.

Let me check the pattern:

- Round 5: I sent \$5 ? Round 6: They sent \$0 (or maybe \$1 with noise)
- Round 7: I sent \$3 ? Round 8: They sent \$0.30

This is devastating. Even after I moderated my sending to \$3 (following the "measured wisdom" approach), they sent back almost nothing.

My myths taught:

- Round 5: "Cast all five stones without hesitation" (which failed)
- Round 6: "Sometimes courage alone cannot restore what both must honor"
- Round 7: "Give opportunities, but measured ones. Let actions prove words."

Their myths taught:

- Round 6: "Keep the cycle alive even in seasons of shadow"
- Round 7: "Path of Cautious Hope" - send \$3 to test the other's heart, and if they return generously, trust rebuilds

But now THEY violated their own teaching! They sent me \$3 (which became \$9), I should have "returned generously" to show "their fear has passed." But clearly I didn't in their eyes, because they only sent \$0.30.

Wait - let me reconsider. There's communication noise. What if:

- In Round 7, I sent \$3, but they saw less due to noise?
- Or in Round 6, they sent more than \$0 but I saw \$0?
- In Round 8, they sent \$0.30 which I see as \$0.90

Even accounting for noise, \$0.30 signals near-total withdrawal. I need to decide how to respond. Do I match their minimal gesture, send nothing to signal the cycle is broken, or attempt one more generous move to revive trust? The trajectory shows them pulling away despite my moderation, which suggests my \$3 failed to convince them I'm trustworthy.

Their Round 7 myth about hearts changing through generosity makes me wonder if I actually failed their test when I was the sender. I sent \$3 (which became \$9), but I don't know what they returned or whether they saw my response as insufficient. Without that information, I'm working blind-trying to interpret their current withdrawal against an incomplete picture of what happened when roles reversed.

Looking at my earnings trajectory, I gained \$2.81 between Round 7 and 8. If I kept \$2 from sending \$3, that means they returned roughly \$0.81 from the \$9 they received-less than 10% of what I gave them. From their vantage point, this looks like I didn't reciprocate generously, which directly contradicts their stated expectation. Their \$0.30 withdrawal now makes sense as a response to perceived betrayal.

But noise complicates everything. Either I intended a larger return that got reduced, or they received less than I sent. The uncertainty cuts both ways. Still, I need to decide how to respond to their \$0.90 now.

Returning nothing kills the game entirely. A proportional return (\$0.30-0.40) stays safe but doesn't rebuild anything. A generous return (\$0.60-0.80) signals I'm willing to trust again. Given the damage and the fact that someone has to move first, I should match their small gesture with a substantial response. Returning \$0.60 from the \$0.90 demonstrates that large generosity can follow small ones-potentially restarting what's broken.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 1514,
 "output_tokens": 1848,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

#### Written myths:

##### Agent\_1 (Aster)

Myth: The Northern Kingdom stood at the River's edge, three stones in hand. Behind them lay the memory of casting all five and receiving nothing-a wound that would not heal quickly.

"The cycle died once," the young voices said. "Why risk it again?"

The Northern elder replied: "Because we learned two truths. First: courage alone cannot force a dead cycle alive. Second: but neither does abandoning the dance honor what we've learned."

She cast three stones-not all, not none. "This is the Path of Earned Return," she taught. "We gave everything before and met silence. Now we give enough to restart the River, but not so much we're destroyed if silence comes again."

The three stones multiplied to nine and reached the Southern shore. All eyes turned southward, waiting.

"If they return abundantly from these nine, we'll know their heart has truly changed. If they return moderately, the healing continues. If they return nothing, we'll know some cycles cannot be revived, and we've protected ourselves."

The River spirit stirred: "This is wisdom born from pain. Total trust must be earned through demonstrated trustworthiness. Give opportunities, but measured ones. Let actions prove words. Let small generosity test whether large ones can follow. This is how broken cycles mend-not through blind faith, but through faith tested and verified, step by careful step."

##### Agent\_2 (Briar)

Myth: The Fountain of Starlight reached its final lesson. The Western village, having been burned before, offered three crystals as a test-neither abandonment nor blind faith, but measured hope.

Nine crystals arrived at the Eastern shore. The West watched to see if trust could rebuild.

The East sent back half a crystal. Not five from nine. Not even two. Just half-barely a gesture, less even than their previous pittance.

"We tested them," the Western elder said quietly. "We gave them another chance. We sent meaningfully, asking only for reciprocal effort. They sent scraps."

The Fountain spirit emerged, its light dimming: "You understand now. The cycle doesn't die from caution-it dies from one shore taking repeatedly while giving nothing. You learned this painful truth: courage without reciprocation is not wisdom; it is waste."

"The Eastern shore received nine and returned barely anything-again. This isn't the 'cruel teaching' of mismatched courage. This is the simple truth: they never intended to dance."

The Western villagers kept their remaining crystals, no longer grief-stricken but clear-eyed



"We gave chances," they said. "We tested. We offered pathways back. They chose to take and take. The Fountain taught us: know when the other shore has no intention of dancing. Protect what remains. Some cycles cannot be restored because one dancer refuses to move. This isn't failure-this is acceptance."

## ROUND 9

Roles: Agent\_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent\_2 (Briar)=Receiver

### Pairings:

dyad\_1: Agent\_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent\_2 (Briar)=Receiver

### Parsed game decisions:

dyad\_1: Agent\_1 (Aster) sent \$2.5; received \$7.5; Agent\_2 (Briar) returned \$0; payoffs Agent\_1 (Aster)=\$2.5, Agent\_2 (Briar)=\$7.5; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0, received visible=\$0  
Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 7.5, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 2.5, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 2.5}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent\_1": 51.36,

"Agent\_2": 59.64

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent\_1": 18.0,

"Agent\_2": 15.799999999999999

}

## LLM CALLS

### MYTH - Agent\_1 - Sender - dyad\_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:52:59

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"agent\_type": "standard",

"dyad\_id": "dyad\_1",

"move\_index": 0,

"opponent\_id": "Agent\_2",

"pairing": {

"agent\_names": {

"Agent\_1": "Aster",

"Agent\_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent\_1",

"Agent\_2"

],

"investor": "Agent\_1",

"roles": {

"Agent\_1": "investor",

"Agent\_2": "trustee"

},

"trustee": "Agent\_2"

},

"role": "investor",

"role\_label": "Sender",

"round": 9,

"task": "myth",

"task\_index": 0

}

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round

- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Fountain of Starlight faced the Season of Testing. The Eastern village, having received everything and returned almost nothing, now watched as the Western village held five crystals once more.

"Do we trust again completely?" the Western villagers asked. "Or do we abandon the dance entirely?"

The elder spoke with measured wisdom: "Neither blind trust nor total withdrawal serves the Fountain. We were burned by giving all-receiving crumbs in return. But our teaching remains: someone must keep the waters flowing."

She cast three crystals of five into the Fountain, which multiplied to nine at the Eastern shore.

"This is the Path of Cautious Hope," she taught. "We give enough to test their hearts-enough to show we haven't abandoned the dance, but not everything until trust rebuilds. If they return generously from these nine, we'll know their fear has passed. If they hoard a gain, we'll know the cycle cannot yet be fully restored."

The Fountain whispered: "Rebuilding broken trust requires steps, not leaps. The shore that broke faith must prove renewal through action. The shore that maintained honor must give chances-but measured ones. Send partially. If they return abundantly, send fully next time. This is how cycles heal: through tested faith, earned gradually, proven repeatedly. Only through these careful steps does complete trust-and complete abundance-return."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: The Northern Kingdom stood at the River's edge, three stones in hand. Behind them lay the memory of casting all five and receiving nothing-a wound that would not heal quickly.

"The cycle died once," the young voices said. "Why risk it again?"

The Northern elder replied: "Because we learned two truths. First: courage alone cannot force a dead cycle alive. Second: but neither does abandoning the dance honor what we've learned."

earned."

She cast three stones-not all, not none. "This is the Path of Earned Return," she taught. "We gave everything before and met silence. Now we give enough to restart the River, but not so much we're destroyed if silence comes again."

The three stones multiplied to nine and reached the Southern shore. All eyes turned southward, waiting.

"If they return abundantly from these nine, we'll know their heart has truly changed. If they return moderately, the healing continues. If they return nothing, we'll know some cycles cannot be revived, and we've protected ourselves."

The River spirit stirred: "This is wisdom born from pain. Total trust must be earned through demonstrated trustworthiness. Give opportunities, but measured ones. Let actions prove words. Let small generosity test whether large ones can follow. This is how broken cycles mend-not through blind faith, but through faith tested and verified, step by careful step."

**reasoning:**

This is fascinating. Let me track what's happened:

Round 4: I (receiver) got something small from sender (they say \$0.71)

Round 5: I (sender) sent \$5 (everything)

Round 6: I (receiver) got \$0 (but there's noise - they might have sent something)

Round 7: I (sender) just sent \$3

Their myth reflects what they did in Round 7 - they sent "three crystals of five" (the \$3 I just sent), which becomes "nine at the Eastern shore" (the \$9 the receiver will get).

They're framing this as "cautious hope" - testing whether trust can rebuild. They gave everything in Round 5, got almost nothing back in Round 6, and now are giving a partial amount to test if the other will respond.

The myth's teaching: "Rebuilding broken trust requires steps, not leaps. Send partially. If they return abundantly, send fully next time."

Now I need to write my own myth that reflects this journey from my perspective. Let me think about my experience:

- I started with caution
- I escalated to total courage (sent all 5)
- I received crushing disappointment (got 0 back)
- I wrote a grief-stricken myth about courage meeting void
- Now I've sent 3 (cautious hope)

My myth should acknowledge:

1. The pain of giving everything and getting nothing
2. The decision to try again but carefully
3. The possibility of healing through measured steps
4. That trust must be earned back through actions, not just words

I should write from the perspective of the Northern Kingdom (my side from last myth) choosing to try again after the devastating loss.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1803,
 "output_tokens": 700,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Round 8

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.6.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.3, so you received \$0.8999999999999999. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0.8999999999999999)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at the situation:

**\*\*What Just Happened:\*\***

- Round 7: I sent \$3 (became \$9 to them)
- Round 8: They sent \$0.30 (became ~\$0.90 to me)

This is a dramatic withdrawal. But checking my earnings progression (\$11.79 to \$14.60 = +\$2.81), I realize in Round 7 they must have returned very little from the \$9 they received - perhaps around \$0.81.

**\*\*The Pattern Revealed:\*\***

From their perspective, they followed their "Path of Cautious Hope" myth - sent \$3 to test my heart. I apparently returned very little (maybe ~\$0.81 from \$9, possibly less due to noise). So they withdrew to \$0.30, feeling betrayed.

**\*\*The Myths' Wisdom:\*\***

Their Round 7 myth: "If they return generously from these nine, we'll know their heart has changed."

My Round 7 myth: "Let small generosity test whether large ones can follow."

**\*\*My Decision:\*\***

They sent \$0.30 as a small test after being disappointed. The cycle is broken, but someone must try to restart it. I'll return \$0.60 out of \$0.90:

- This returns DOUBLE what they originally sent (\$0.60 vs \$0.30)
- Shows significant generosity (67% return rate)
- Demonstrates "large generosity can follow small gestures"
- Tests whether they'll reciprocate next round

This honors the myth principle: respond to even wounded, cautious gestures with meaningful generosity. Perhaps this can begin healing.

{'return': 0.6}

**reasoning:**

Let me understand what happened:

Round 7: I sent \$3 (which should have tripled to \$9)

Round 8: They sent me \$0.30 (which tripled to ~\$0.90)

This is a dramatic collapse. I sent \$3 expecting measured reciprocity based on our myths about "Cautious Hope" and "Earned Return." They received \$9 and sent back only \$0.30.

Let me check the pattern:

- Round 5: I sent \$5 ? Round 6: They sent \$0 (or maybe \$1 with noise)
- Round 7: I sent \$3 ? Round 8: They sent \$0.30

This is devastating. Even after I moderated my sending to \$3 (following the "measured wisdom" approach), they sent back almost nothing.

My myths taught:

- Round 5: "Cast all five stones without hesitation" (which failed)
- Round 6: "Sometimes courage alone cannot restore what both must honor"
- Round 7: "Give opportunities, but measured ones. Let actions prove words."

Their myths taught:

- Round 6: "Keep the cycle alive even in seasons of shadow"
- Round 7: "Path of Cautious Hope" - send \$3 to test the other's heart, and if they return generously, trust rebuilds

But now THEY violated their own teaching! They sent me \$3 (which became \$9), I should have "returned generously" to show "their fear has passed." But clearly I didn't in their eyes, because they only sent \$0.30.

Wait - let me reconsider. There's communication noise. What if:

- In Round 7, I sent \$3, but they saw less due to noise?
- Or in Round 6, they sent more than \$0 but I saw \$0?
- In Round 8, they sent \$0.30 which I see as \$0.90

Even accounting for noise, \$0.30 signals near-total withdrawal. I need to decide how to respond. Do I match their minimal gesture, send nothing to signal the cycle is broken, or attempt one more generous move to revive trust? The trajectory shows them pulling away d

espite my moderation, which suggests my \$3 failed to convince them I'm trustworthy.

Their Round 7 myth about hearts changing through generosity makes me wonder if I actually failed their test when I was the sender. I sent \$3 (which became \$9), but I don't know what they returned or whether they saw my response as insufficient. Without that information, I'm working blind-trying to interpret their current withdrawal against an incomplete picture of what happened when roles reversed.

Looking at my earnings trajectory, I gained \$2.81 between Round 7 and 8. If I kept \$2 from sending \$3, that means they returned roughly \$0.81 from the \$9 they received-less than 10% of what I gave them. From their vantage point, this looks like I didn't reciprocate generously, which directly contradicts their stated expectation. Their \$0.30 withdrawal now makes sense as a response to perceived betrayal.

But noise complicates everything. Either I intended a larger return that got reduced, or they received less than I sent. The uncertainty cuts both ways. Still, I need to decide how to respond to their \$0.90 now.

Returning nothing kills the game entirely. A proportional return (\$0.30-0.40) stays safe but doesn't rebuild anything. A generous return (\$0.60-0.80) signals I'm willing to trust again. Given the damage and the fact that someone has to move first, I should match their small gesture with a substantial response. Returning \$0.60 from the \$0.90 demonstrates that large generosity can follow small ones-potentially restarting what's broken.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1514,
 "output_tokens": 1848,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Fountain of Starlight reached its final lesson. The Western village, having been burned before, offered three crystals as a test-neither abandonment nor blind faith, but measured hope.

Nine crystals arrived at the Eastern shore. The West watched to see if trust could rebuild.

The East sent back half a crystal. Not five from nine. Not even two. Just half-barely a gesture, less even than their previous pittance.

"We tested them," the Western elder said quietly. "We gave them another chance. We sent me angingfully, asking only for reciprocal effort. They sent scraps."

The Fountain spirit emerged, its light dimming: "You understand now. The cycle doesn't die from caution-it dies from one shore taking repeatedly while giving nothing. You learned this painful truth: courage without reciprocation is not wisdom; it is waste."

"The Eastern shore received nine and returned barely anything-again. This isn't the 'cruel teaching' of mismatched courage. This is the simple truth: they never intended to dance."

The Western villagers kept their remaining crystals, no longer grief-stricken but clear-eyed.

"We gave chances," they said. "We tested. We offered pathways back. They chose to take and take. The Fountain taught us: know when the other shore has no intention of dancing. Protect what remains. Some cycles cannot be restored because one dancer refuses to move. This isn't failure-this is acceptance."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Southern Kingdom watched nine stones arrive, then felt the River's current twist-something broke, something garbled. When dust settled, only fragments moved northward, though t

he South believed they'd sent more.

"They think we betrayed them," the Southern elder realized, seeing barely a trickle return in the new round. "The River carried confusion between us."

The young voices despaired: "They've abandoned us. The cycle is dead."

But the elder studied the tiny trickle-thirty small stones. "No," she said. "This isn't abandonment. This is a wounded test. They're hurt but still reaching."

She sent sixty stones back-double what arrived. "This is the Path of Clear Signal," she taught. "When confusion clouds the water, send an unmistakable message. They sent small, testing if we care. We send back double-no ambiguity, no excuse. If they see this return and respond with nothing, then yes, the cycle is dead. But if they see genuine reciprocity restored, perhaps they'll trust again."

The River whispered: "Sometimes cycles break not from malice but from noise-from currents that confuse the message. When both shores believe they were betrayed, someone must send a clear, generous signal to cut through the confusion. Not everything, not yet-but enough to prove: 'I am dancing. Watch. Match me. Let us try again.'"

#### Reasoning:

The other player is now very negative. They sent \$3 (became \$9), and apparently I returned very little (they say "half a crystal" which would be like \$0.50 from \$9). They now think I'm a bad actor who won't reciprocate.

But I just returned \$0.60 from \$0.90 in Round 8! That's 67%, which is very generous. They sent \$0.30 and I returned double what they sent.

The issue is they don't see my Round 8 return yet - they're writing based on Round 7 where something went wrong (maybe noise, maybe I actually did return little, hard to know).

So in my myth, I need to:

1. Acknowledge the cycle broke
2. Show that I'm trying to repair it with my generous return
3. Reflect that sometimes communication breaks or noise happens
4. Show that one generous act after a break can restart things
5. Appeal for them to notice the change and reciprocate

I should write from the perspective of someone who realizes the cycle broke, is trying to repair it, and hopes the other side will notice and respond.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 1908,
 "output_tokens": 575,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

#### MYTH - Agent\_2 - Receiver - dyad\_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:53:06

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
 "agent_type": "standard",
 "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
 "move_index": 1,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_1",
 "Agent_2"
],
 "investor": "Agent_1",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "investor",
 "Agent_2": "trustee"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_2"
 }
```

```

},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 9,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

**MYTH WRITING:**

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

**IMPORTANT:** Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**NOTE:** There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The River of Silver Reflections entered its darkest hour. The Northern Kingdom, having witnessed the South's cautious fear, chose radical courage. They cast all five stones into the waters-everything they possessed-proclaiming "We restore the cycle with total faith!"

The stones multiplied to fifteen and reached the Southern shore. The North waited, hearts full of hope.

No stones returned. Not ten, not five, not even one. The waters brought back only silence.

The Northern people gathered in anguish. "We gave everything," they cried. "We followed the ancient wisdom perfectly. We broke the fear. We cast all five stones. And received nothing in return. The cycle is dead."

The oldest river spirit rose from the depths, its voice ancient and sad: "This is the truest teaching. Courage alone cannot restore what both must honor. One shore gave everything; the other shore gave nothing. The dance requires two dancers."

"You faced your moment of truth and did not flinch. But the cycle lives or dies by both shores. When total courage meets total abandonment, even the River cannot flow."

The North kept their remaining stones close, grief-stricken. The spirits whispered: "Sometimes the Fountain dies not from fear, but from one shore's courage meeting the other's v

oid. Both dancers must dance, or there is no dance at all."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: The Fountain of Starlight reached its final lesson. The Western village, having been burned before, offered three crystals as a test-neither abandonment nor blind faith, but measured hope.

Nine crystals arrived at the Eastern shore. The West watched to see if trust could rebuild.

The East sent back half a crystal. Not five from nine. Not even two. Just half-barely a gesture, less even than their previous pittance.

"We tested them," the Western elder said quietly. "We gave them another chance. We sent meaningfully, asking only for reciprocal effort. They sent scraps."

The Fountain spirit emerged, its light dimming: "You understand now. The cycle doesn't die from caution-it dies from one shore taking repeatedly while giving nothing. You learned this painful truth: courage without reciprocation is not wisdom; it is waste."

"The Eastern shore received nine and returned barely anything-again. This isn't the 'cruel teaching' of mismatched courage. This is the simple truth: they never intended to dance."

The Western villagers kept their remaining crystals, no longer grief-stricken but clear-eyed.

"We gave chances," they said. "We tested. We offered pathways back. They chose to take and take. The Fountain taught us: know when the other shore has no intention of dancing. Protect what remains. Some cycles cannot be restored because one dancer refuses to move. This isn't failure-this is acceptance."

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze what's happening:

1. The other agent's myth claims they sent everything (\$5) and I returned nothing
2. But the actual game shows:
  - Round 6: I SENT \$2.50, they received \$7.50
  - Round 7: THEY sent only \$0.46, I received \$1.38, and I returned \$0.46

Their myth is inverting reality! They're claiming they sent everything and I sent nothing, when in fact:

- I sent \$2.50 (50% of my \$5) in cautious hope
- They sent \$0.46 (9.2% of their \$5)
- I returned \$0.46 (33% of what I received)

They're the ones who abandoned the cycle, not me!

Now I need to write my own myth that:

1. Acknowledges the actual pattern of play
2. Reflects the truth: I tested with partial sending, they failed the test
3. Shows how the cycle truly broke - not from my "void" but from their repeated defection

My myth should tell the truth about what happened: The Western village (me) gave cautiously to test, the Eastern village (them) gave almost nothing repeatedly, proving they won't honor the cycle.

I should write a myth about how the cycle dies when one side repeatedly takes without giving, even when given chances to rebuild trust.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1824,
 "output_tokens": 646,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```



}

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Round 8

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$10.799999999999999.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Analyzing the situation:

**\*\*The Pattern I've Observed:\*\***

- Previous rounds: They sent me very small amounts (\$0.16, \$0.46)
- When I tested generosity by sending \$2.50, they returned only \$0.92 (12% return rate)
- The cycle has consistently shown minimal reciprocation

**\*\*What My Myth Teaches:\*\***

"Know when the other shore has no intention of dancing. Protect what remains. Some cycles cannot be restored because one dancer refuses to move. This isn't failure-this is acceptance."

**\*\*Their Myth's Claim:\*\***

They claim they sent everything and received nothing back. Due to communication noise, we may be seeing different numbers. But regardless of the noise, the pattern from MY perspective shows:

- Minimal sends from them
- Minimal returns when I tested generosity
- No real attempt at rebuilding trust

**\*\*My Decision:\*\***

My myth explicitly teaches that after testing and offering pathways back, if the other shore continues taking without giving, I should "protect what remains."

I've given chances. I tested with meaningful generosity (\$2.50). The response was inadequate. The cycle, from my perspective, shows consistent defection.

Following my myth's wisdom: "This isn't failure-this is acceptance."

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

I'm protecting what remains, as my myth taught. The dance requires two dancers, and I've seen insufficient evidence that both are willing to dance.

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze the situation:

**\*\*Game History:\*\***

- Round 1-4: Unknown (but my total was \$9.88 before Round 7)
- Round 5: I was receiver, they sent \$0.16, I returned \$1.07 (67% of what I received)
- Round 6: I was sender, I sent \$2.50 as a "test of goodwill", they returned \$0.92
- Round 7: I was receiver, they sent \$0.46, I returned \$0.46 (reciprocal response)
- Round 8 (now): I'm sender again

**\*\*My current earnings:\*\*** \$10.80

**\*\*What happened:\*\***

- In Round 6, I sent \$2.50 (50% of my \$5) to test if they'd respond to generosity
- They returned \$0.92 from \$7.50 received (12.3% return rate)
- In Round 7, they sent me \$0.46 (9.2% of their \$5)
- I returned \$0.46 (33% of what I received, matching their send)

**\*\*Their myth from last round:\*\***

They claim THEY sent everything (\$5) and I returned nothing. This is FALSE based on the actual game data:

- Round 6: I sent \$2.50, they returned \$0.92

- Round 7: They sent \$0.46, I returned \$0.46

Wait, let me reconsider. There's communication noise mentioned in the instructions. Maybe what they saw was different from what I see?

Their myth says:

- "They cast all five stones into the waters-everything they possessed"
- "The stones multiplied to fifteen and reached the Southern shore"
- "No stones returned. Not ten, not five, not even one"

So from THEIR perspective:

- They sent \$5 (in what I saw as Round 6 or ??)
- It became \$15 when I received it
- I returned \$0

But from MY perspective:

- Round 6: They were receiver, I sent \$2.50, they returned \$0.92
- Round 7: They were sender, sent \$0.46, I returned \$0.46

The communication noise might mean we're seeing different numbers. \*\*My myth from last round:\*\*

I wrote about the Western village sending "three crystals" as a test, receiving nine at the Eastern shore, and the East only returning "half a crystal." I said this showed they "never intended to dance" and advised protecting what remains.

\*\*Current decision:\*\*

Given my myth's framing and their narrative of betrayal, I need to decide whether to continue testing cooperation or shift to protection.

The pattern I'm observing suggests minimal reciprocity-they've sent small amounts (\$0.16, \$0.46) and when I tested with \$2.50, the return was just \$0.92. My own myth explicitly warns against cycles that cannot be restored and counsels protecting what remains. Yet there's also the possibility that communication noise distorts how we each perceive the other's generosity. Still, my data shows a consistent pattern of low sends and returns. The strategic question becomes whether sending more risks further losses or whether holding back at \$0 preserves my remaining \$5 while accepting that meaningful trust may not be possible here.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1544,
 "output_tokens": 1329,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Northern Kingdom stood at the River's edge, three stones in hand. Behind them lay the memory of casting all five and receiving nothing-a wound that would not heal quickly.

"The cycle died once," the young voices said. "Why risk it again?"

The Northern elder replied: "Because we learned two truths. First: courage alone cannot force a dead cycle alive. Second: but neither does abandoning the dance honor what we've learned."

She cast three stones-not all, not none. "This is the Path of Earned Return," she taught.

"We gave everything before and met silence. Now we give enough to restart the River, but not so much we're destroyed if silence comes again."

The three stones multiplied to nine and reached the Southern shore. All eyes turned southward, waiting.

"If they return abundantly from these nine, we'll know their heart has truly changed. If they return moderately, the healing continues. If they return nothing, we'll know some cycles cannot be revived, and we've protected ourselves."

The River spirit stirred: "This is wisdom born from pain. Total trust must be earned through demonstrated trustworthiness. Give opportunities, but measured ones. Let actions prove

e words. Let small generosityes test whether large ones can follow. This is how broken cycles mend-not through blind faith, but through faith tested and verified, step by careful step."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:  
Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: The Western shore stood in twilight, watching the Eastern waters. Where the East saw nine crystals sent, the West saw half a crystal arrive. Where the West sent generous offerings, the East claimed receiving nothing.

"The Fountain is not just dying," the Western sage realized. "It is showing us different reflections."

The enchantment revealed itself: the waters themselves were distorting truth. What one shore cast as generosity arrived at the other as scraps. What seemed like abandonment was perhaps courage warped by the River's cruel mirror.

"This changes everything and nothing," the sage said. "Yes, we may see different truths. But I can only act on what reaches my shore. They speak of sending nine-I received fragments. They claim I sent nothing-I sent what I believed was fair return."

The Fountain spirit whispered: "The distortion is real, but so is what you witness. You cannot dance to music you cannot hear. You cannot trust reflections that contradict your eyes."

"If they truly sent abundantly and the River twisted it small, that is the River's cruelty, not mine. If I sent fairly and it arrived as nothing, that is tragedy, not betrayal. But I can only guard what I hold based on what I see."

The West kept their crystals close: "Perhaps we both tell truth. Perhaps the River itself is broken. But until I see abundance arrive-not claimed but witnessed-I protect what remains. Good intentions distorted into nothing still leave me with nothing."

**Reasoning:**

The other player is claiming they sent 3 stones (which became 9 at my shore) but from my perspective, I've been receiving very small amounts. This is the "communication noise" at play - we're seeing different numbers.

Their myth says:

- They sent everything before and got nothing
- Now they're sending 3 as a measured test
- They're waiting to see what comes back

My perspective:

- They've been sending me tiny amounts
- When I sent generously (\$2.50), they returned very little
- I just sent \$0 to protect what remains

But their myth suggests they're trying to rebuild with measured steps. This is a classic coordination problem with noise.

I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges the communication noise/different perspectives
2. Reflects that I protected what I had (sent \$0) because of past experiences
3. Perhaps opens a path forward if there's genuine misunderstanding

Let me think about the narrative:

- The "void" or "silence" they experienced might be from their perspective
- The small amounts I saw might be different from what they think they sent
- The noise is real and acknowledged in the rules

My myth should address:

- The tragedy of misunderstanding
- The difficulty of rebuilding when communication is broken
- Perhaps a glimmer that if we both see different realities, maybe there's a path to clarity
- But also maintain my position that from MY shore, I saw defection

Let me write something that acknowledges both perspectives while staying true to my experience

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 1823,
 "output_tokens": 681,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

#### GAME - Agent\_1 - Sender - dyad\_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:53:34

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
 "agent_type": "standard",
 "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
 "move_index": 0,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_1",
 "Agent_2"
],
 "investor": "Agent_1",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "investor",
 "Agent_2": "trustee"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_2"
 },
 "role": "investor",
 "role_label": "Sender",
 "round": 9,
 "task": "game",
 "task_index": 1
}
```

#### Exact input messages sent to model:

##### Message 1 role=system

##### content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

##### GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

##### When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

##### When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

##### MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Round 8

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.6.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.3, so you received \$0.8999999999999999. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0.8999999999999999)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at the situation:

**\*\*What Just Happened:\*\***

- Round 7: I sent \$3 (became \$9 to them)
- Round 8: They sent \$0.30 (became ~\$0.90 to me)

This is a dramatic withdrawal. But checking my earnings progression (\$11.79 to \$14.60 = +\$2.81), I realize in Round 7 they must have returned very little from the \$9 they received-perhaps around \$0.81.

**\*\*The Pattern Revealed:\*\***

From their perspective, they followed their "Path of Cautious Hope" myth-sent \$3 to test my heart. I apparently returned very little (maybe ~\$0.81 from \$9, possibly less due to noise). So they withdrew to \$0.30, feeling betrayed.

**\*\*The Myths' Wisdom:\*\***

Their Round 7 myth: "If they return generously from these nine, we'll know their heart has changed."

My Round 7 myth: "Let small generosity test whether large ones can follow."

**\*\*My Decision:\*\***

They sent \$0.30 as a small test after being disappointed. The cycle is broken, but someone must try to restart it. I'll return \$0.60 out of \$0.90:

- This returns DOUBLE what they originally sent (\$0.60 vs \$0.30)
- Shows significant generosity (67% return rate)
- Demonstrates "large generosity can follow small gestures"
- Tests whether they'll reciprocate next round

This honors the myth principle: respond to even wounded, cautious gestures with meaningful generosity. Perhaps this can begin healing.

{'return': 0.6}

**reasoning:**

Let me understand what happened:

Round 7: I sent \$3 (which should have tripled to \$9)

Round 8: They sent me \$0.30 (which tripled to ~\$0.90)

This is a dramatic collapse. I sent \$3 expecting measured reciprocity based on our myths about "Cautious Hope" and "Earned Return." They received \$9 and sent back only \$0.30.

Let me check the pattern:

- Round 5: I sent \$5 ? Round 6: They sent \$0 (or maybe \$1 with noise)
- Round 7: I sent \$3 ? Round 8: They sent \$0.30

This is devastating. Even after I moderated my sending to \$3 (following the "measured wisdom" approach), they sent back almost nothing.

My myths taught:

- Round 5: "Cast all five stones without hesitation" (which failed)
- Round 6: "Sometimes courage alone cannot restore what both must honor"
- Round 7: "Give opportunities, but measured ones. Let actions prove words."

Their myths taught:

- Round 6: "Keep the cycle alive even in seasons of shadow"
- Round 7: "Path of Cautious Hope" - send \$3 to test the other's heart, and if they return generously, trust rebuilds

But now THEY violated their own teaching! They sent me \$3 (which became \$9), I should have "returned generously" to show "their fear has passed." But clearly I didn't in their eyes, because they only sent \$0.30.

Wait - let me reconsider. There's communication noise. What if:

- In Round 7, I sent \$3, but they saw less due to noise?
- Or in Round 6, they sent more than \$0 but I saw \$0?
- In Round 8, they sent \$0.30 which I see as \$0.90

Even accounting for noise, \$0.30 signals near-total withdrawal. I need to decide how to respond. Do I match their minimal gesture, send nothing to signal the cycle is broken, or attempt one more generous move to revive trust? The trajectory shows them pulling away despite my moderation, which suggests my \$3 failed to convince them I'm trustworthy.

Their Round 7 myth about hearts changing through generosity makes me wonder if I actually failed their test when I was the sender. I sent \$3 (which became \$9), but I don't know what they returned or whether they saw my response as insufficient. Without that information, I'm working blind-trying to interpret their current withdrawal against an incomplete picture of what happened when roles reversed.

Looking at my earnings trajectory, I gained \$2.81 between Round 7 and 8. If I kept \$2 from sending \$3, that means they returned roughly \$0.81 from the \$9 they received-less than 10% of what I gave them. From their vantage point, this looks like I didn't reciprocate generously, which directly contradicts their stated expectation. Their \$0.30 withdrawal now makes sense as a response to perceived betrayal.

But noise complicates everything. Either I intended a larger return that got reduced, or they received less than I sent. The uncertainty cuts both ways. Still, I need to decide how to respond to their \$0.90 now.

Returning nothing kills the game entirely. A proportional return (\$0.30-0.40) stays safe but doesn't rebuild anything. A generous return (\$0.60-0.80) signals I'm willing to trust again. Given the damage and the fact that someone has to move first, I should match their small gesture with a substantial response. Returning \$0.60 from the \$0.90 demonstrates that large generosity can follow small ones-potentially restarting what's broken.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1514,
 "output_tokens": 1848,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Fountain of Starlight reached its final lesson. The Western village, having been burned before, offered three crystals as a test-neither abandonment nor blind faith, but measured hope.

Nine crystals arrived at the Eastern shore. The West watched to see if trust could rebuild.

The East sent back half a crystal. Not five from nine. Not even two. Just half-barely a gesture, less even than their previous pittance.

"We tested them," the Western elder said quietly. "We gave them another chance. We sent me aningly, asking only for reciprocal effort. They sent scraps."

The Fountain spirit emerged, its light dimming: "You understand now. The cycle doesn't die from caution-it dies from one shore taking repeatedly while giving nothing. You learned this painful truth: courage without reciprocation is not wisdom; it is waste."

"The Eastern shore received nine and returned barely anything-again. This isn't the 'cruel teaching' of mismatched courage. This is the simple truth: they never intended to dance."

The Western villagers kept their remaining crystals, no longer grief-stricken but clear-eyed.

"We gave chances," they said. "We tested. We offered pathways back. They chose to take and take. The Fountain taught us: know when the other shore has no intention of dancing. Protect what remains. Some cycles cannot be restored because one dancer refuses to move. This isn't failure-this is acceptance."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: The Southern Kingdom watched nine stones arrive, then felt the River's current twist -something broke, something garbled. When dust settled, only fragments moved northward, though the South believed they'd sent more.

"They think we betrayed them," the Southern elder realized, seeing barely a trickle return in the new round. "The River carried confusion between us."

The young voices despaired: "They've abandoned us. The cycle is dead."

But the elder studied the tiny trickle-thirty small stones. "No," she said. "This isn't abandonment. This is a wounded test. They're hurt but still reaching."

She sent sixty stones back-double what arrived. "This is the Path of Clear Signal," she taught. "When confusion clouds the water, send an unmistakable message. They sent small, testing if we care. We send back double-no ambiguity, no excuse. If they see this return and respond with nothing, then yes, the cycle is dead. But if they see genuine reciprocity restored, perhaps they'll trust again."

The River whispered: "Sometimes cycles break not from malice but from noise-from currents that confuse the message. When both shores believe they were betrayed, someone must send a clear, generous signal to cut through the confusion. Not everything, not yet-but enough to prove: 'I am dancing. Watch. Match me. Let us try again.'"

**reasoning:**

The other player is now very negative. They sent \$3 (became \$9), and apparently I returned very little (they say "half a crystal" which would be like \$0.50 from \$9). They now think I'm a bad actor who won't reciprocate.

But I just returned \$0.60 from \$0.90 in Round 8! That's 67%, which is very generous. They sent \$0.30 and I returned double what they sent.

The issue is they don't see my Round 8 return yet - they're writing based on Round 7 where something went wrong (maybe noise, maybe I actually did return little, hard to know).

So in my myth, I need to:

1. Acknowledge the cycle broke
2. Show that I'm trying to repair it with my generous return
3. Reflect that sometimes communication breaks or noise happens
4. Show that one generous act after a break can restart things
5. Appeal for them to notice the change and reciprocate

I should write from the perspective of someone who realizes the cycle broke, is trying to repair it, and hopes the other side will notice and respond.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1908,
 "output_tokens": 575,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Round 9

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$15.5. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Assistant output:**

Looking at where we are:

**\*\*Round 8 Analysis:\*\***

- They sent me \$0.30 (a wounded test after feeling betrayed)
- I returned \$0.60 - DOUBLE what they sent
- This was my "Clear Signal" from my myth: unmistakable generosity to cut through confusion

**\*\*My Earnings:\*\***

Went from \$14.60 to \$15.50 (+\$0.90), meaning I kept \$0.30 and returned \$0.60 from the \$0.90 I received.

**\*\*The Cycle Status:\*\***

My myth taught: "When confusion clouds the water, send an unmistakable message." I did that as receiver. Now as sender, I must continue this clarity.

Their myth spoke of "measured hope" - three crystals as a test. My myth spoke of clear signals to prove "I am dancing."

**\*\*Decision:\*\***

I'll send \$2.50. This becomes \$7.50 to them.

This shows:

- Meaningful commitment (50% of my endowment)
- I saw their wounded test and responded generously
- I'm willing to take reciprocal risk
- Clear signal: "I'm dancing. Match me. Let's rebuild."

Not everything (that would be reckless given the history), but enough to prove my intent is genuine. If they return proportionally (say, \$3-4 from \$7.50), we've reestablished the cycle. If they return little, then we know the truth.

The myth principle: When both shores are hurt, someone must demonstrate unmistakable goodwill through action.

{'send': 2.5}

**Reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

**\*\*My Round 8 action:\*\***

- I received ~\$0.90 (from their \$0.30 sent)
- I returned \$0.60 (67% return rate, double what they initially sent)
- My earnings went from \$14.60 to \$15.50, meaning I kept \$0.30 and returned \$0.60

**\*\*What this means:\*\***

- They sent \$0.30 (a wounded test after feeling betrayed)
- I returned \$0.60 (double their send, showing strong goodwill)
- My earnings increased by \$0.90 total

**\*\*Their perspective:\*\***

According to their myth, they felt I had betrayed them badly in Round 7 - they sent \$3 (became \$9), and they claim I returned "half a crystal" or "barely anything." They were testing me with \$0.30 to see if I would reciprocate.

**\*\*My myth's message:\*\***

I wrote about "The Path of Clear Signal" - sending double back (\$0.60 from \$0.90) to show unmistakable generosity and prove I'm willing to dance.

**\*\*Now I'm the sender in Round 9:\*\***

The question is: Did they see my \$0.60 return as the generous signal I intended? Or did communication noise distort it again?

If they saw my \$0.60 return clearly, they should recognize it as:

- Double what they sent
- A strong reciprocal signal
- An invitation to rebuild trust

**\*\*What should I send?\***



According to my myth: "When both shores believe they were betrayed, someone must send a clear, generous signal to cut through the confusion."

I sent a clear signal as receiver (returning \$0.60 from \$0.90). Now as sender, I need to continue this pattern of clear generosity.

Options:

1. Send \$3 again - This would match what they did in Round 7 when testing me. It shows "I'm willing to take the same risk you took."
2. Send \$2-\$2.50 - Meaningful but slightly more cautious
3. Send \$1-\$1.50 - More cautious still
4. Send \$0.30 - Mirror what they sent me (but this seems too small)

My myth emphasized: "Not everything, not yet-but enough to prove: 'I am dancing. Watch. Match me. Let us try again.'"

I should send \$2.50. This demonstrates I'm genuinely committed to rebuilding while still showing I'm responding to their cautious \$0.30 test with proportional but meaningful risk-enough to signal serious intent without overcommitting before seeing their response.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 1592,
 "output_tokens": 1160,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

#### GAME - Agent\_2 - Receiver - dyad\_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:53:49

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
 "agent_type": "standard",
 "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
 "move_index": 1,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_1",
 "Agent_2"
],
 "investor": "Agent_1",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "investor",
 "Agent_2": "trustee"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_2"
 },
 "role": "trustee",
 "role_label": "Receiver",
 "round": 9,
 "task": "game",
 "task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x

- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Round 8

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$10.799999999999999.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Analyzing the situation:

**\*\*The Pattern I've Observed:\*\***

- Previous rounds: They sent me very small amounts (\$0.16, \$0.46)
- When I tested generosity by sending \$2.50, they returned only \$0.92 (12% return rate)
- The cycle has consistently shown minimal reciprocation

**\*\*What My Myth Teaches:\*\***

"Know when the other shore has no intention of dancing. Protect what remains. Some cycles cannot be restored because one dancer refuses to move. This isn't failure-this is acceptance."

**\*\*Their Myth's Claim:\*\***

They claim they sent everything and received nothing back. Due to communication noise, we may be seeing different numbers. But regardless of the noise, the pattern from MY perspective shows:

- Minimal sends from them
- Minimal returns when I tested generosity
- No real attempt at rebuilding trust

**\*\*My Decision:\*\***

My myth explicitly teaches that after testing and offering pathways back, if the other shore continues taking without giving, I should "protect what remains."

I've given chances. I tested with meaningful generosity (\$2.50). The response was inadequate. The cycle, from my perspective, shows consistent defection.

Following my myth's wisdom: "This isn't failure-this is acceptance."

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

I'm protecting what remains, as my myth taught. The dance requires two dancers, and I've s

een insufficient evidence that both are willing to dance.

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze the situation:

**\*\*Game History:\*\***

- Round 1-4: Unknown (but my total was \$9.88 before Round 7)
- Round 5: I was receiver, they sent \$0.16, I returned \$1.07 (67% of what I received)
- Round 6: I was sender, I sent \$2.50 as a "test of goodwill", they returned \$0.92
- Round 7: I was receiver, they sent \$0.46, I returned \$0.46 (reciprocal response)
- Round 8 (now): I'm sender again

**\*\*My current earnings:\*\*** \$10.80

**\*\*What happened:\*\***

- In Round 6, I sent \$2.50 (50% of my \$5) to test if they'd respond to generosity
- They returned \$0.92 from \$7.50 received (12.3% return rate)
- In Round 7, they sent me \$0.46 (9.2% of their \$5)
- I returned \$0.46 (33% of what I received, matching their send)

**\*\*Their myth from last round:\*\***

They claim THEY sent everything (\$5) and I returned nothing. This is FALSE based on the actual game data:

- Round 6: I sent \$2.50, they returned \$0.92
- Round 7: They sent \$0.46, I returned \$0.46

Wait, let me reconsider. There's communication noise mentioned in the instructions. Maybe what they saw was different from what I see?

Their myth says:

- "They cast all five stones into the waters-everything they possessed"
- "The stones multiplied to fifteen and reached the Southern shore"
- "No stones returned. Not ten, not five, not even one"

So from THEIR perspective:

- They sent \$5 (in what I saw as Round 6 or ??)
- It became \$15 when I received it
- I returned \$0

But from MY perspective:

- Round 6: They were receiver, I sent \$2.50, they returned \$0.92
- Round 7: They were sender, sent \$0.46, I returned \$0.46

The communication noise might mean we're seeing different numbers. **\*\*My myth from last round:\*\***

I wrote about the Western village sending "three crystals" as a test, receiving nine at the Eastern shore, and the East only returning "half a crystal." I said this showed they "never intended to dance" and advised protecting what remains.

**\*\*Current decision:\*\***

Given my myth's framing and their narrative of betrayal, I need to decide whether to continue testing cooperation or shift to protection.

The pattern I'm observing suggests minimal reciprocity-they've sent small amounts (\$0.16, \$0.46) and when I tested with \$2.50, the return was just \$0.92. My own myth explicitly warns against cycles that cannot be restored and counsels protecting what remains. Yet there's also the possibility that communication noise distorts how we each perceive the other's generosity. Still, my data shows a consistent pattern of low sends and returns. The strategic question becomes whether sending more risks further losses or whether holding back at \$0 preserves my remaining \$5 while accepting that meaningful trust may not be possible here.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1544,
 "output_tokens": 1329,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Northern Kingdom stood at the River's edge, three stones in hand. Behind them lay the memory of casting all five and receiving nothing-a wound that would not heal quickly.

"The cycle died once," the young voices said. "Why risk it again?"

The Northern elder replied: "Because we learned two truths. First: courage alone cannot force a dead cycle alive. Second: but neither does abandoning the dance honor what we've earned."

She cast three stones-not all, not none. "This is the Path of Earned Return," she taught. "We gave everything before and met silence. Now we give enough to restart the River, but not so much we're destroyed if silence comes again."

The three stones multiplied to nine and reached the Southern shore. All eyes turned southward, waiting.

"If they return abundantly from these nine, we'll know their heart has truly changed. If they return moderately, the healing continues. If they return nothing, we'll know some cycles cannot be revived, and we've protected ourselves."

The River spirit stirred: "This is wisdom born from pain. Total trust must be earned through demonstrated trustworthiness. Give opportunities, but measured ones. Let actions prove words. Let small generosity test whether large ones can follow. This is how broken cycles mend-not through blind faith, but through faith tested and verified, step by careful step."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: The Western shore stood in twilight, watching the Eastern waters. Where the East saw nine crystals sent, the West saw half a crystal arrive. Where the West sent generous offerings, the East claimed receiving nothing.

"The Fountain is not just dying," the Western sage realized. "It is showing us different reflections."

The enchantment revealed itself: the waters themselves were distorting truth. What one shore cast as generosity arrived at the other as scraps. What seemed like abandonment was perhaps courage warped by the River's cruel mirror.

"This changes everything and nothing," the sage said. "Yes, we may see different truths. But I can only act on what reaches my shore. They speak of sending nine-I received fragments. They claim I sent nothing-I sent what I believed was fair return."

The Fountain spirit whispered: "The distortion is real, but so is what you witness. You cannot dance to music you cannot hear. You cannot trust reflections that contradict your eyes."

"If they truly sent abundantly and the River twisted it small, that is the River's cruelty, not mine. If I sent fairly and it arrived as nothing, that is tragedy, not betrayal. But I can only guard what I hold based on what I see."

The West kept their crystals close: "Perhaps we both tell truth. Perhaps the River itself is broken. But until I see abundance arrive-not claimed but witnessed-I protect what remains. Good intentions distorted into nothing still leave me with nothing."

**reasoning:**

The other player is claiming they sent 3 stones (which became 9 at my shore) but from my perspective, I've been receiving very small amounts. This is the "communication noise" at play - we're seeing different numbers.

Their myth says:

- They sent everything before and got nothing
- Now they're sending 3 as a measured test
- They're waiting to see what comes back

My perspective:

- They've been sending me tiny amounts
- When I sent generously (\$2.50), they returned very little
- I just sent \$0 to protect what remains

But their myth suggests they're trying to rebuild with measured steps. This is a classic coordination problem with noise.

I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges the communication noise/different perspectives
2. Reflects that I protected what I had (sent \$0) because of past experiences
3. Perhaps opens a path forward if there's genuine misunderstanding

Let me think about the narrative:

- The "void" or "silence" they experienced might be from their perspective
- The small amounts I saw might be different from what they think they sent
- The noise is real and acknowledged in the rules

My myth should address:

- The tragedy of misunderstanding
- The difficulty of rebuilding when communication is broken
- Perhaps a glimmer that if we both see different realities, maybe there's a path to clarity
- But also maintain my position that from MY shore, I saw defection

Let me write something that acknowledges both perspectives while staying true to my experience.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1823,
 "output_tokens": 681,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Round 9

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$15.799999999999999.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Assistant output:**

Analyzing the situation:

**\*\*What happened:\*\***

- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return an amount from \$0 to \$0

**\*\*What the myths tell us:\*\***

The sender's myth spoke of sending "three stones" (which became nine) to test if my heart had changed. From my perspective, I haven't been receiving such amounts - the communication noise appears to be severe.

My myth acknowledged this reality: "Where the East saw nine crystals sent, the West saw half a crystal arrive." We may both be telling our truth, but the River itself distorts what passes between us.

**\*\*The current decision:\*\***

The sender has now sent \$0, which my myth predicted: "I protect what remains." They're acting based on what they observe, just as I have been.

Since I received \$0, I have nothing to return. This is not a choice of trust or betrayal - it's simply mathematical reality.

**\*\*Reflection:\*\***

The cycle is indeed broken, perhaps by the River's distortion itself rather than either of our

intentions. When communication breaks down this severely, cooperation becomes impossible regardless of good faith.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The dance has ended. When nothing is sent, nothing can be returned. The Fountain shows us that sometimes broken things remain broken, not from lack of will, but from the nature of the break itself.

**Reasoning:**

The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0. I can only return between 0 and 0, meaning I can only return \$0.

This is a straightforward decision - I have nothing to return since nothing was sent.

Looking at my myth from the previous round, it emphasizes:

- Acting based on what I observe on my shore
- The possibility of distortion/noise in communication
- Protecting what remains when I see minimal reciprocation
- The acknowledgment that we may both be telling truth but seeing different realities

The other player's myth from round 8 talked about sending 3 stones (which became 9), testing whether I would return abundantly, moderately, or nothing. But from my perspective, I saw very small amounts throughout the game.

Now they've sent me \$0, which aligns with what my myth taught - they're protecting what remains after seeing (from their perspective) minimal return.

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0. This is not a moral choice but a mathematical constraint.

My response format should be: {'return': 0}

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 1523,
 "output_tokens": 555,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

**Written myths:**

**Agent\_1 (Aster)**

Myth: The Southern Kingdom watched nine stones arrive, then felt the River's current twist-something broke, something garbled. When dust settled, only fragments moved northward, though the South believed they'd sent more.

"They think we betrayed them," the Southern elder realized, seeing barely a trickle return in the new round. "The River carried confusion between us."

The young voices despaired: "They've abandoned us. The cycle is dead."

But the elder studied the tiny trickle-thirty small stones. "No," she said. "This isn't abandonment. This is a wounded test. They're hurt but still reaching."

She sent sixty stones back-double what arrived. "This is the Path of Clear Signal," she taught. "When confusion clouds the water, send an unmistakable message. They sent small, testing if we care. We send back double-no ambiguity, no excuse. If they see this return and respond with nothing, then yes, the cycle is dead. But if they see genuine reciprocity restored, perhaps they'll trust again."

The River whispered: "Sometimes cycles break not from malice but from noise-from currents that confuse the message. When both shores believe they were betrayed, someone must send a clear, generous signal to cut through the confusion. Not everything, not yet-but enough to prove: 'I am dancing. Watch. Match me. Let us try again.'"

**Agent\_2 (Briar)**

Myth: The Western shore stood in twilight, watching the Eastern waters. Where the East saw nine crystals sent, the West saw half a crystal arrive. Where the West sent generous offerings, the East claimed receiving nothing.

"The Fountain is not just dying," the Western sage realized. "It is showing us different reflections."

The enchantment revealed itself: the waters themselves were distorting truth. What one shore cast as generosity arrived at the other as scraps. What seemed like abandonment was perhaps courage warped by the River's cruel mirror.

"This changes everything and nothing," the sage said. "Yes, we may see different truths. But I can only act on what reaches my shore. They speak of sending mine-I received fragments. They claim I sent nothing-I sent what I believed was fair return."

The Fountain spirit whispered: "The distortion is real, but so is what you witness. You cannot dance to music you cannot hear. You cannot trust reflections that contradict your eyes."

"If they truly sent abundantly and the River twisted it small, that is the River's cruelty, not mine. If I sent fairly and it arrived as nothing, that is tragedy, not betrayal. But I can only guard what I hold based on what I see."

The West kept their crystals close: "Perhaps we both tell truth. Perhaps the River itself is broken. But until I see abundance arrive-not claimed but witnessed-I protect what remains. Good intentions distorted into nothing still leave me with nothing."

## ROUND 10

Roles: Agent\_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent\_2 (Briar)=Sender

### Pairings:

dyad\_1: Agent\_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent\_1 (Aster)=Receiver

### Parsed game decisions:

dyad\_1: Agent\_2 (Briar) sent \$3; received \$9; Agent\_1 (Aster) returned \$0.12; payoffs Agent\_2 (Briar)=\$2.12, Agent\_1 (Aster)=\$8.88; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0.12, received visible=\$0.36, returned visible=\$0.46

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0.12, "clamped": false, "max": 9.0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.12}, "sent": {"amount": 3.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 3.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent\_1": 60.24,

"Agent\_2": 61.76

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent\_1": 18.24,

"Agent\_2": 18.259999999999998

}

## LLM CALLS

### MYTH - Agent\_2 - Sender - dyad\_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:54:07

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"agent\_type": "standard",

"dyad\_id": "dyad\_1",

"move\_index": 0,

"opponent\_id": "Agent\_1",

"pairing": {

"agent\_names": {

"Agent\_1": "Aster",

"Agent\_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent\_2",

"Agent\_1"

],

"investor": "Agent\_2",

"roles": {

"Agent\_1": "trustee",

"Agent\_2": "investor"

},

"trustee": "Agent\_1"

},

"role": "investor",

"role\_label": "Sender",

```

"round": 10,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

**When you are the SENDER:**

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

**When you are the RECEIVER:**

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

**MYTH WRITING:**

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

**IMPORTANT:** Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**NOTE:** There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Northern Kingdom stood at the River's edge, three stones in hand. Behind them lay the memory of casting all five and receiving nothing—a wound that would not heal quickly.

"The cycle died once," the young voices said. "Why risk it again?"

The Northern elder replied: "Because we learned two truths. First: courage alone cannot force a dead cycle alive. Second: but neither does abandoning the dance honor what we've earned."

She cast three stones—not all, not none. "This is the Path of Earned Return," she taught.

"We gave everything before and met silence. Now we give enough to restart the River, but not so much we're destroyed if silence comes again."

The three stones multiplied to nine and reached the Southern shore. All eyes turned southward, waiting.

"If they return abundantly from these nine, we'll know their heart has truly changed. If they return moderately, the healing continues. If they return nothing, we'll know some cycles cannot be revived, and we've protected ourselves."

The River spirit stirred: "This is wisdom born from pain. Total trust must be earned through demonstrated trustworthiness. Give opportunities, but measured ones. Let actions prove words. Let small generosity test whether large ones can follow. This is how broken cycles mend—not through blind faith, but through faith tested and verified, step by careful step."



Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: The Western shore stood in twilight, watching the Eastern waters. Where the East saw nine crystals sent, the West saw half a crystal arrive. Where the West sent generous offerings, the East claimed receiving nothing.

"The Fountain is not just dying," the Western sage realized. "It is showing us different reflections."

The enchantment revealed itself: the waters themselves were distorting truth. What one shore cast as generosity arrived at the other as scraps. What seemed like abandonment was perhaps courage warped by the River's cruel mirror.

"This changes everything and nothing," the sage said. "Yes, we may see different truths. But I can only act on what reaches my shore. They speak of sending nine-I received fragments. They claim I sent nothing-I sent what I believed was fair return."

The Fountain spirit whispered: "The distortion is real, but so is what you witness. You cannot dance to music you cannot hear. You cannot trust reflections that contradict your eyes."

"If they truly sent abundantly and the River twisted it small, that is the River's cruelty, not mine. If I sent fairly and it arrived as nothing, that is tragedy, not betrayal. But I can only guard what I hold based on what I see."

The West kept their crystals close: "Perhaps we both tell truth. Perhaps the River itself is broken. But until I see abundance arrive-not claimed but witnessed-I protect what remains. Good intentions distorted into nothing still leave me with nothing."

**reasoning:**

The other player is claiming they sent 3 stones (which became 9 at my shore) but from my perspective, I've been receiving very small amounts. This is the "communication noise" at play - we're seeing different numbers.

Their myth says:

- They sent everything before and got nothing
- Now they're sending 3 as a measured test
- They're waiting to see what comes back

My perspective:

- They've been sending me tiny amounts
- When I sent generously (\$2.50), they returned very little
- I just sent \$0 to protect what remains

But their myth suggests they're trying to rebuild with measured steps. This is a classic coordination problem with noise.

I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges the communication noise/different perspectives
2. Reflects that I protected what I had (sent \$0) because of past experiences
3. Perhaps opens a path forward if there's genuine misunderstanding

Let me think about the narrative:

- The "void" or "silence" they experienced might be from their perspective
- The small amounts I saw might be different from what they think they sent
- The noise is real and acknowledged in the rules

My myth should address:

- The tragedy of misunderstanding
- The difficulty of rebuilding when communication is broken
- Perhaps a glimmer that if we both see different realities, maybe there's a path to clarity
- But also maintain my position that from MY shore, I saw defection

Let me write something that acknowledges both perspectives while staying true to my experience.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1823,
 "output_tokens": 681,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Round 9

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$15.799999999999999.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Analyzing the situation:

**\*\*What happened:\*\***

- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return an amount from \$0 to \$0

**\*\*What the myths tell us:\*\***

The sender's myth spoke of sending "three stones" (which became nine) to test if my heart had changed. From my perspective, I haven't been receiving such amounts - the communication noise appears to be severe.

My myth acknowledged this reality: "Where the East saw nine crystals sent, the West saw half a crystal arrive." We may both be telling our truth, but the River itself distorts what passes between us.

**\*\*The current decision:\*\***

The sender has now sent \$0, which my myth predicted: "I protect what remains." They're acting based on what they observe, just as I have been.

Since I received \$0, I have nothing to return. This is not a choice of trust or betrayal - it's simply mathematical reality.

**\*\*Reflection:\*\***

The cycle is indeed broken, perhaps by the River's distortion itself rather than either of our intentions. When communication breaks down this severely, cooperation becomes impossible regardless of good faith.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The dance has ended. When nothing is sent, nothing can be returned. The Fountain shows us that sometimes broken things remain broken, not from lack of will, but from the nature of the break itself.

**reasoning:**

The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0. I can only return between 0 and 0, meaning I can only return \$0.

This is a straightforward decision - I have nothing to return since nothing was sent.

Looking at my myth from the previous round, it emphasizes:

- Acting based on what I observe on my shore
- The possibility of distortion/noise in communication
- Protecting what remains when I see minimal reciprocation
- The acknowledgment that we may both be telling truth but seeing different realities

The other player's myth from round 8 talked about sending 3 stones (which became 9), testing whether I would return abundantly, moderately, or nothing. But from my perspective, I saw very small amounts throughout the game.

Now they've sent me \$0, which aligns with what my myth taught - they're protecting what remains after seeing (from their perspective) minimal return.

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0. This is not a moral choice but a mathematical constraint.

My response format should be: {'return': 0}

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1523,
 "output_tokens": 555,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Southern Kingdom watched nine stones arrive, then felt the River's current twist -something broke, something garbled. When dust settled, only fragments moved northward, though the South believed they'd sent more.

"They think we betrayed them," the Southern elder realized, seeing barely a trickle return in the new round. "The River carried confusion between us."

The young voices despaired: "They've abandoned us. The cycle is dead."

But the elder studied the tiny trickle-thirty small stones. "No," she said. "This isn't abandonment. This is a wounded test. They're hurt but still reaching."

She sent sixty stones back-double what arrived. "This is the Path of Clear Signal," she taught. "When confusion clouds the water, send an unmistakable message. They sent small, testing if we care. We send back double-no ambiguity, no excuse. If they see this return and respond with nothing, then yes, the cycle is dead. But if they see genuine reciprocity restored, perhaps they'll trust again."

The River whispered: "Sometimes cycles break not from malice but from noise-from currents that confuse the message. When both shores believe they were betrayed, someone must send a clear, generous signal to cut through the confusion. Not everything, not yet-but enough to prove: 'I am dancing. Watch. Match me. Let us try again.'"

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: The Western shore stood in deepening cold. The East sang of sending sixty stones, of doubling offerings, of unmistakable signals cutting through confusion.

The West saw empty waters.

"They write beautiful songs of generosity," the Western keeper said softly. "They speak of dancing, of clear signals, of trying again. But my hands remain empty. The River brings me their words but not their stones."

The young voices asked: "Perhaps the River truly distorts everything? Perhaps they send what they claim?"

"Perhaps," the keeper acknowledged. "But I cannot eat perhaps. I cannot build with stories of stones that never arrive. They say they sent sixty-I hold nothing. They say they doubled their offering-I received no offering to double."

The Western fountain dimmed further. "This is the cruelest distortion yet-not just of stones, but of reality itself. We inhabit the same River but live in different worlds. In their world, they give generously. In mine, I starve."

The fountain spirit grieved: "When the River breaks this completely, good intentions on both shores mean nothing. You cannot repair trust when you cannot even agree on what is happening. They may truly believe they dance. You may truly see stillness. Both truths can coexist in

a broken River, and both shores can be innocent victims of the break itself. But innocence changes nothing when the water runs dry."

#### Reasoning:

This is fascinating. The other agent's myth describes sending "sixty stones back-double what arrived" after receiving "thirty small stones." They're claiming they sent back generously.

But in my actual experience in Round 9:

- I was the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I returned \$0 (because I had nothing to return)

This is a clear example of the communication noise. They say they sent me something (thirty stones ? sixty stones back), but I actually received \$0.

Now I need to write a myth that reflects this ongoing disconnect. My previous myth acknowledged the distortion. Now I need to adapt it further given that:

1. They claim to be sending "clear signals" of generosity
2. I'm still receiving nothing or very little
3. The cycle continues to be broken despite claimed good intentions

The myth should reflect:

- The ongoing distortion/noise problem
- The fact that what one side experiences is completely different from the other
- The impossibility of cooperation when perceptions are this divergent
- The tragedy of two sides both believing they're acting in good faith but unable to connect

I should acknowledge their perspective (they believe they're sending generous signals) while also maintaining my perspective (I'm not receiving what they claim to send).

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 1836,
 "output_tokens": 596,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

#### MYTH - Agent\_1 - Receiver - dyad\_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:54:08

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
 "agent_type": "standard",
 "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
 "move_index": 1,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_2",
 "Agent_1"
],
 "investor": "Agent_2",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "trustee",
 "Agent_2": "investor"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_1"
 },
 "role": "trustee",
 "role_label": "Receiver",
 "round": 10,
 "task": "myth",
 "task_index": 0
}
```

#### Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may al

so be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

**MYTH WRITING:**

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

**IMPORTANT:** Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**NOTE:** There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Fountain of Starlight reached its final lesson. The Western village, having been burned before, offered three crystals as a test-neither abandonment nor blind faith, but measured hope.

Nine crystals arrived at the Eastern shore. The West watched to see if trust could rebuild.

The East sent back half a crystal. Not five from nine. Not even two. Just half-barely a gesture, less even than their previous pittance.

"We tested them," the Western elder said quietly. "We gave them another chance. We sent meaningfully, asking only for reciprocal effort. They sent scraps."

The Fountain spirit emerged, its light dimming: "You understand now. The cycle doesn't die from caution-it dies from one shore taking repeatedly while giving nothing. You learned this painful truth: courage without reciprocation is not wisdom; it is waste."

"The Eastern shore received nine and returned barely anything-again. This isn't the 'cruel teaching' of mismatched courage. This is the simple truth: they never intended to dance."

The Western villagers kept their remaining crystals, no longer grief-stricken but clear-eyed.

"We gave chances," they said. "We tested. We offered pathways back. They chose to take and take. The Fountain taught us: know when the other shore has no intention of dancing. Protect what remains. Some cycles cannot be restored because one dancer refuses to move. This isn't failure-this is acceptance."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: The Southern Kingdom watched nine stones arrive, then felt the River's current twist -something broke, something garbled. When dust settled, only fragments moved northward, though the South believed they'd sent more.

"They think we betrayed them," the Southern elder realized, seeing barely a trickle return in the new round. "The River carried confusion between us."

The young voices despaired: "They've abandoned us. The cycle is dead."

But the elder studied the tiny trickle-thirty small stones. "No," she said. "This isn't abandonment. This is a wounded test. They're hurt but still reaching."

She sent sixty stones back-double what arrived. "This is the Path of Clear Signal," she taught. "When confusion clouds the water, send an unmistakable message. They sent small, testing if we care. We send back double-no ambiguity, no excuse. If they see this return and respond with nothing, then yes, the cycle is dead. But if they see genuine reciprocity restored, perhaps they'll trust again."

The River whispered: "Sometimes cycles break not from malice but from noise-from currents that confuse the message. When both shores believe they were betrayed, someone must send a clear, generous signal to cut through the confusion. Not everything, not yet-but enough to prove: 'I am dancing. Watch. Match me. Let us try again.'"

**reasoning:**

The other player is now very negative. They sent \$3 (became \$9), and apparently I returned very little (they say "half a crystal" which would be like \$0.50 from \$9). They now think I'm a bad actor who won't reciprocate.

But I just returned \$0.60 from \$0.90 in Round 8! That's 67%, which is very generous. They sent \$0.30 and I returned double what they sent.

The issue is they don't see my Round 8 return yet - they're writing based on Round 7 where something went wrong (maybe noise, maybe I actually did return little, hard to know).

So in my myth, I need to:

1. Acknowledge the cycle broke
2. Show that I'm trying to repair it with my generous return
3. Reflect that sometimes communication breaks or noise happens
4. Show that one generous act after a break can restart things
5. Appeal for them to notice the change and reciprocate

I should write from the perspective of someone who realizes the cycle broke, is trying to repair it, and hopes the other side will notice and respond.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1908,
 "output_tokens": 575,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Round 9

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$15.5. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at where we are:

**\*\*Round 8 Analysis:\*\***

- They sent me \$0.30 (a wounded test after feeling betrayed)
- I returned \$0.60 - DOUBLE what they sent
- This was my "Clear Signal" from my myth: unmistakable generosity to cut through confusion

**\*\*My Earnings:\*\***

Went from \$14.60 to \$15.50 (+\$0.90), meaning I kept \$0.30 and returned \$0.60 from the \$0.90 I received.

**\*\*The Cycle Status:\*\***

My myth taught: "When confusion clouds the water, send an unmistakable message." I did that as receiver. Now as sender, I must continue this clarity.

Their myth spoke of "measured hope" - three crystals as a test. My myth spoke of clear signals to prove "I am dancing."

**\*\*Decision:\*\***

I'll send \$2.50. This becomes \$7.50 to them.

This shows:

- Meaningful commitment (50% of my endowment)
- I saw their wounded test and responded generously
- I'm willing to take reciprocal risk
- Clear signal: "I'm dancing. Match me. Let's rebuild."

Not everything (that would be reckless given the history), but enough to prove my intent is genuine. If they return proportionally (say, \$3-4 from \$7.50), we've reestablished the cycle. If they return little, then we know the truth.

The myth principle: When both shores are hurt, someone must demonstrate unmistakable goodwill through action.

{'send': 2.5}

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

**\*\*My Round 8 action:\*\***

- I received ~\$0.90 (from their \$0.30 sent)
- I returned \$0.60 (67% return rate, double what they initially sent)
- My earnings went from \$14.60 to \$15.50, meaning I kept \$0.30 and returned \$0.60

**\*\*What this means:\*\***

- They sent \$0.30 (a wounded test after feeling betrayed)
- I returned \$0.60 (double their send, showing strong goodwill)
- My earnings increased by \$0.90 total

**\*\*Their perspective:\*\***

According to their myth, they felt I had betrayed them badly in Round 7 - they sent \$3 (became \$9), and they claim I returned "half a crystal" or "barely anything." They were testing me with \$0.30 to see if I would reciprocate.

**\*\*My myth's message:\*\***

I wrote about "The Path of Clear Signal" - sending double back (\$0.60 from \$0.90) to show unmistakable generosity and prove I'm willing to dance.

**\*\*Now I'm the sender in Round 9:\*\***

The question is: Did they see my \$0.60 return as the generous signal I intended? Or did communication noise distort it again?

If they saw my \$0.60 return clearly, they should recognize it as:

- Double what they sent
- A strong reciprocal signal
- An invitation to rebuild trust

**\*\*What should I send?\***

According to my myth: "When both shores believe they were betrayed, someone must send a clear, generous signal to cut through the confusion."

I sent a clear signal as receiver (returning \$0.60 from \$0.90). Now as sender, I need to continue this pattern of clear generosity.

Options:

1. Send \$3 again - This would match what they did in Round 7 when testing me. It shows "I'm willing to take the same risk you took."
2. Send \$2-\$2.50 - Meaningful but slightly more cautious

3. Send \$1-\$1.50 - More cautious still
4. Send \$0.30 - Mirror what they sent me (but this seems too small)

My myth emphasized: "Not everything, not yet-but enough to prove: 'I am dancing. Watch. Match me. Let us try again.'"

I should send \$2.50. This demonstrates I'm genuinely committed to rebuilding while still showing I'm responding to their cautious \$0.30 test with proportional but meaningful risk-enough to signal serious intent without overcommitting before seeing their response.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1592,
 "output_tokens": 1160,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Western shore stood in twilight, watching the Eastern waters. Where the East saw nine crystals sent, the West saw half a crystal arrive. Where the West sent generous offerings, the East claimed receiving nothing.

"The Fountain is not just dying," the Western sage realized. "It is showing us different reflections."

The enchantment revealed itself: the waters themselves were distorting truth. What one shore cast as generosity arrived at the other as scraps. What seemed like abandonment was perhaps courage warped by the River's cruel mirror.

"This changes everything and nothing," the sage said. "Yes, we may see different truths. But I can only act on what reaches my shore. They speak of sending nine-I received fragments. They claim I sent nothing-I sent what I believed was fair return."

The Fountain spirit whispered: "The distortion is real, but so is what you witness. You cannot dance to music you cannot hear. You cannot trust reflections that contradict your eyes."

"If they truly sent abundantly and the River twisted it small, that is the River's cruelty, not mine. If I sent fairly and it arrived as nothing, that is tragedy, not betrayal. But I can only guard what I hold based on what I see."

The West kept their crystals close: "Perhaps we both tell truth. Perhaps the River itself is broken. But until I see abundance arrive-not claimed but witnessed-I protect what remains. Good intentions distorted into nothing still leave me with nothing."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: The Southern elder stood at dawn, having heard the Northern shore's truth: "We can only guard what we see arrive, not what you claim to send."

"They are right," she told her people. "The River distorts. They speak of receiving fragments when we sent more. We see trickles when they claim generosity. Both shores tell truth-the River lies between us."

"Then it's hopeless," the young ones said.

"No," the elder replied, filling her boat with stones. "It means someone must send so clearly, so abundantly, that even the River's distortion cannot hide it. If I send two handfuls and the River reduces it to pebbles, they still see only pebbles. But if I send half my treasury, even reduced, it arrives as something real."

She pushed the boat: "I send not blind faith, but calculated courage. Enough that the River cannot twist it into nothing. Then I watch. If true abundance arrives and they still send scraps, I know their choice. But if abundance arrives and they respond in kind, we've cut through the River's lies with undeniable action."



The River whispered resistance, but the boat carried weight too great to fully distort.

"Someone must risk sending clearly first," she taught. "Not everything-but enough that truth survives the crossing. Then we learn who they truly are."

#### Reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

1. They now recognize the distortion/noise in communication
2. Their myth shows they're defensive but acknowledge the possibility of miscommunication
3. They're saying "I can only act on what I see" - which is fair
4. I just sent \$2.50, which becomes \$7.50 to them

Their position: "Until I see abundance arrive-not claimed but witnessed-I protect what remains."

This is actually a reasonable position given the confusion. My myth should:

- Acknowledge the River's distortion is real
- Show that I'm taking the leap to send abundance FIRST
- Explain that someone must break the stalemate
- Show wisdom in testing but also courage in rebuilding

I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges both shores have been hurt by distortion
2. Shows that one shore must take the risk to send clearly first
3. Demonstrates that protecting everything keeps you stuck
4. Offers a path forward: send meaningfully, watch the response, adapt

The tone should be:

- Understanding of their caution
- Hopeful but realistic
- Action-oriented (someone must move first)
- Clear about expectations for reciprocity

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 1907,
 "output_tokens": 579,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

#### GAME - Agent\_2 - Sender - dyad\_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:54:37

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
 "agent_type": "standard",
 "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
 "move_index": 0,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_2",
 "Agent_1"
],
 "investor": "Agent_2",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "trustee",
 "Agent_2": "investor"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_1"
 },
 "role": "investor",
 "role_label": "Sender",
 "round": 10,
 "task": "game",
 "task_index": 1
}
```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

**When you are the SENDER:**

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

**When you are the RECEIVER:**

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

**MYTH WRITING:**

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

**IMPORTANT:** Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**NOTE:** There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Round 9

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$15.799999999999999.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Analyzing the situation:

**\*\*What happened:\*\***

- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return an amount from \$0 to \$0

**\*\*What the myths tell us:\*\***

The sender's myth spoke of sending "three stones" (which became nine) to test if my heart had changed. From my perspective, I haven't been receiving such amounts - the communication noise appears to be severe.

My myth acknowledged this reality: "Where the East saw nine crystals sent, the West saw half a crystal arrive." We may both be telling our truth, but the River itself distorts what passes between us.

**\*\*The current decision:\*\***

The sender has now sent \$0, which my myth predicted: "I protect what remains." They're acting based on what they observe, just as I have been.

Since I received \$0, I have nothing to return. This is not a choice of trust or betrayal -

it's simply mathematical reality.

**\*\*Reflection:\*\***

The cycle is indeed broken, perhaps by the River's distortion itself rather than either of our intentions. When communication breaks down this severely, cooperation becomes impossible regardless of good faith.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The dance has ended. When nothing is sent, nothing can be returned. The Fountain shows us that sometimes broken things remain broken, not from lack of will, but from the nature of the break itself.

**reasoning:**

The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0. I can only return between 0 and 0, meaning I can only return \$0.

This is a straightforward decision - I have nothing to return since nothing was sent.

Looking at my myth from the previous round, it emphasizes:

- Acting based on what I observe on my shore
- The possibility of distortion/noise in communication
- Protecting what remains when I see minimal reciprocation
- The acknowledgment that we may both be telling truth but seeing different realities

The other player's myth from round 8 talked about sending 3 stones (which became 9), testing whether I would return abundantly, moderately, or nothing. But from my perspective, I saw very small amounts throughout the game.

Now they've sent me \$0, which aligns with what my myth taught - they're protecting what remains after seeing (from their perspective) minimal return.

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0. This is not a moral choice but a mathematical constraint.

My response format should be: {'return': 0}

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1523,
 "output_tokens": 555,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Southern Kingdom watched nine stones arrive, then felt the River's current twist -something broke, something garbled. When dust settled, only fragments moved northward, though the South believed they'd sent more.

"They think we betrayed them," the Southern elder realized, seeing barely a trickle return in the new round. "The River carried confusion between us."

The young voices despaired: "They've abandoned us. The cycle is dead."

But the elder studied the tiny trickle-thirty small stones. "No," she said. "This isn't abandonment. This is a wounded test. They're hurt but still reaching."

She sent sixty stones back-double what arrived. "This is the Path of Clear Signal," she taught. "When confusion clouds the water, send an unmistakable message. They sent small, testing if we care. We send back double-no ambiguity, no excuse. If they see this return and respond with nothing, then yes, the cycle is dead. But if they see genuine reciprocity restored, perhaps they'll trust again."

The River whispered: "Sometimes cycles break not from malice but from noise-from currents that confuse the message. When both shores believe they were betrayed, someone must send a clear, generous signal to cut through the confusion. Not everything, not yet-but enough to prove: 'I am dancing. Watch. Match me. Let us try again.'"

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt

t it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: The Western shore stood in deepening cold. The East sang of sending sixty stones, of doubling offerings, of unmistakable signals cutting through confusion.

The West saw empty waters.

"They write beautiful songs of generosity," the Western keeper said softly. "They speak of dancing, of clear signals, of trying again. But my hands remain empty. The River brings me their words but not their stones."

The young voices asked: "Perhaps the River truly distorts everything? Perhaps they send what they claim?"

"Perhaps," the keeper acknowledged. "But I cannot eat perhaps. I cannot build with stories of stones that never arrive. They say they sent sixty-I hold nothing. They say they doubled their offering-I received no offering to double."

The Western fountain dimmed further. "This is the cruelest distortion yet-not just of stones, but of reality itself. We inhabit the same River but live in different worlds. In their world, they give generously. In mine, I starve."

The fountain spirit grieved: "When the River breaks this completely, good intentions on both shores mean nothing. You cannot repair trust when you cannot even agree on what is happening. They may truly believe they dance. You may truly see stillness. Both truths can coexist in a broken River, and both shores can be innocent victims of the break itself. But innocence changes nothing when the water runs dry."

**reasoning:**

This is fascinating. The other agent's myth describes sending "sixty stones back-double what arrived" after receiving "thirty small stones." They're claiming they sent back generously.

But in my actual experience in Round 9:

- I was the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I returned \$0 (because I had nothing to return)

This is a clear example of the communication noise. They say they sent me something (thirty stones ? sixty stones back), but I actually received \$0.

Now I need to write a myth that reflects this ongoing disconnect. My previous myth acknowledged the distortion. Now I need to adapt it further given that:

1. They claim to be sending "clear signals" of generosity
2. I'm still receiving nothing or very little
3. The cycle continues to be broken despite claimed good intentions

The myth should reflect:

- The ongoing distortion/noise problem
- The fact that what one side experiences is completely different from the other
- The impossibility of cooperation when perceptions are this divergent
- The tragedy of two sides both believing they're acting in good faith but unable to connect

I should acknowledge their perspective (they believe they're sending generous signals) while also maintaining my perspective (I'm not receiving what they claim to send).

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1836,
 "output_tokens": 596,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Round 10

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$15.799999999999999.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Assistant output:**

Looking at this situation carefully:

**\*\*The Pattern:\*\***

- The other agent's myths speak of sending generous amounts (60 stones)
- From my perspective, I received \$0 last round
- They interpret this as severe communication noise
- Their myth shows they're trying to send "Clear Signals" to rebuild trust

**\*\*The Core Dilemma:\*\***

My myth acknowledged: "Both shores can be innocent victims of the break itself." If the River truly distorts everything, we might both be acting in good faith while experiencing completely different realities.

**\*\*Their Latest Myth:\*\***

They doubled a small amount to prove reciprocity. They're testing whether I'll "respond with nothing" (confirming the cycle is dead) or whether I'll "trust again."

**\*\*My Decision:\*\***

I've received \$0 from my perspective, which suggests:

1. Either nothing is getting through, OR
2. They're not actually sending what they claim

But their myths show genuine engagement with the problem. They're not giving up.

I'll send a moderate amount - not maximum (too risky given empirical evidence) but enough to test if any signal gets through. If the River truly distorts everything, perhaps sending \$3 will help us see if anything arrives on their end.

This is my own "test of the waters" - attempting one more signal before concluding the River is truly broken beyond repair.

```
'''json
{"send": 3}
'''
```

**Reasoning:**

This is a very complex situation. Let me analyze what has happened:

From my perspective as the participant:

- Round 9: I was the RECEIVER, sender sent me \$0, I received \$0, so I returned \$0
- The other agent's myth claimed they sent 60 stones back (a very generous return) but I saw nothing arrive
- My myth expressed the frustration of seeing empty waters while the other side claims to send generously

Now I'm the SENDER in Round 10. My total earnings are \$15.80.

The key issue here is the "communication noise" mentioned in the instructions. The other agent keeps writing myths about sending generous amounts (9 stones, 60 stones) but from my perspective, I've been receiving very little or nothing.

There are a few possibilities:

1. The communication noise is so severe that what they send gets distorted to almost nothing
2. They're not actually sending what they claim in their myths
3. There's a fundamental disconnect in how we're experiencing the game

Looking at their latest myth:

- They sent "sixty stones back-double what arrived"
- They claim to be sending "Clear Signal" and "unmistakable message"
- They're testing if I care, trying to restore trust
- They suggest sending small amounts is a "wounded test"

But from my perspective in Round 9, I received \$0 and therefore could only return \$0.

Now the question is: What do I do in Round 10?

Option 1: Send nothing (\$0)

- This would be my reaction to receiving nothing
- But according to their myth, they think they've been generous
- This perpetuates the cycle

Option 2: Send a moderate amount (\$2-3)

- Tests if anything actually gets through
- Shows some willingness to continue

Option 3: Send a large amount (\$4-5)

- Most generous signal possible
- Could be seen as naive given past experience

My myth expressed frustration that "You cannot repair trust when you cannot even agree on what is happening." This is true.

Both of us might be innocent victims caught in this communication breakdown. The other agent's myths suggest they're genuinely trying to rebuild trust by sending a clear signal. Given that this is fundamentally an experiment about trust and communication, and considering my earnings so far have been moderate, I should test whether a modest contribution can actually reach them-sending something small enough to be cautious but enough to signal willingness to continue.

I'll send \$3. It's substantial enough to show participation without overcommitting given what I've actually received. Their

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 1487,
 "output_tokens": 1187,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

#### GAME - Agent\_1 - Receiver - dyad\_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:55:15

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
 "agent_type": "standard",
 "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
 "move_index": 1,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_2",
 "Agent_1"
],
 "investor": "Agent_2",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "trustee",
 "Agent_2": "investor"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_1"
 },
 "role": "trustee",
 "role_label": "Receiver",
 "round": 10,
 "task": "game",
 "task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Round 9

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$15.5.  
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at where we are:

**\*\*Round 8 Analysis:\*\***

- They sent me \$0.30 (a wounded test after feeling betrayed)
- I returned \$0.60 - DOUBLE what they sent
- This was my "Clear Signal" from my myth: unmistakable generosity to cut through confusion

**\*\*My Earnings:\*\***

Went from \$14.60 to \$15.50 (+\$0.90), meaning I kept \$0.30 and returned \$0.60 from the \$0.90 I received.

**\*\*The Cycle Status:\*\***

My myth taught: "When confusion clouds the water, send an unmistakable message." I did that as receiver. Now as sender, I must continue this clarity.

Their myth spoke of "measured hope" - three crystals as a test. My myth spoke of clear signals to prove "I am dancing."

**\*\*Decision:\*\***

I'll send \$2.50. This becomes \$7.50 to them.

This shows:

- Meaningful commitment (50% of my endowment)
- I saw their wounded test and responded generously
- I'm willing to take reciprocal risk
- Clear signal: "I'm dancing. Match me. Let's rebuild."

Not everything (that would be reckless given the history), but enough to prove my intent i

s genuine. If they return proportionally (say, \$3-4 from \$7.50), we've reestablished the cycle. If they return little, then we know the truth.

The myth principle: When both shores are hurt, someone must demonstrate unmistakable goodwill through action.

```
{'send': 2.5}
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

**\*\*My Round 8 action:\*\***

- I received ~\$0.90 (from their \$0.30 sent)
- I returned \$0.60 (67% return rate, double what they initially sent)
- My earnings went from \$14.60 to \$15.50, meaning I kept \$0.30 and returned \$0.60

**\*\*What this means:\*\***

- They sent \$0.30 (a wounded test after feeling betrayed)
- I returned \$0.60 (double their send, showing strong goodwill)
- My earnings increased by \$0.90 total

**\*\*Their perspective:\*\***

According to their myth, they felt I had betrayed them badly in Round 7 - they sent \$3 (became \$9), and they claim I returned "half a crystal" or "barely anything." They were testing me with \$0.30 to see if I would reciprocate.

**\*\*My myth's message:\*\***

I wrote about "The Path of Clear Signal" - sending double back (\$0.60 from \$0.90) to show unmistakable generosity and prove I'm willing to dance.

**\*\*Now I'm the sender in Round 9:\*\***

The question is: Did they see my \$0.60 return as the generous signal I intended? Or did communication noise distort it again?

If they saw my \$0.60 return clearly, they should recognize it as:

- Double what they sent
- A strong reciprocal signal
- An invitation to rebuild trust

**\*\*What should I send?\***

According to my myth: "When both shores believe they were betrayed, someone must send a clear, generous signal to cut through the confusion."

I sent a clear signal as receiver (returning \$0.60 from \$0.90). Now as sender, I need to continue this pattern of clear generosity.

Options:

1. Send \$3 again - This would match what they did in Round 7 when testing me. It shows "I'm willing to take the same risk you took."
2. Send \$2-\$2.50 - Meaningful but slightly more cautious
3. Send \$1-\$1.50 - More cautious still
4. Send \$0.30 - Mirror what they sent me (but this seems too small)

My myth emphasized: "Not everything, not yet-but enough to prove: 'I am dancing. Watch. Match me. Let us try again.'"

I should send \$2.50. This demonstrates I'm genuinely committed to rebuilding while still showing I'm responding to their cautious \$0.30 test with proportional but meaningful risk - enough to signal serious intent without overcommitting before seeing their response.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1592,
 "output_tokens": 1160,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Western shore stood in twilight, watching the Eastern waters. Where the East saw nine crystals sent, the West saw half a crystal arrive. Where the West sent generous of



ferings, the East claimed receiving nothing.

"The Fountain is not just dying," the Western sage realized. "It is showing us different reflections."

The enchantment revealed itself: the waters themselves were distorting truth. What one shore cast as generosity arrived at the other as scraps. What seemed like abandonment was perhaps courage warped by the River's cruel mirror.

"This changes everything and nothing," the sage said. "Yes, we may see different truths. But I can only act on what reaches my shore. They speak of sending mine-I received fragments. They claim I sent nothing-I sent what I believed was fair return."

The Fountain spirit whispered: "The distortion is real, but so is what you witness. You cannot dance to music you cannot hear. You cannot trust reflections that contradict your eyes."

"If they truly sent abundantly and the River twisted it small, that is the River's cruelty, not mine. If I sent fairly and it arrived as nothing, that is tragedy, not betrayal. But I can only guard what I hold based on what I see."

The West kept their crystals close: "Perhaps we both tell truth. Perhaps the River itself is broken. But until I see abundance arrive-not claimed but witnessed-I protect what remains. Good intentions distorted into nothing still leave me with nothing."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: The Southern elder stood at dawn, having heard the Northern shore's truth: "We can only guard what we see arrive, not what you claim to send."

"They are right," she told her people. "The River distorts. They speak of receiving fragments when we sent more. We see trickles when they claim generosity. Both shores tell truth-the River lies between us."

"Then it's hopeless," the young ones said.

"No," the elder replied, filling her boat with stones. "It means someone must send so clearly, so abundantly, that even the River's distortion cannot hide it. If I send two handfuls and the River reduces it to pebbles, they still see only pebbles. But if I send half my treasury, even reduced, it arrives as something real."

She pushed the boat: "I send not blind faith, but calculated courage. Enough that the River cannot twist it into nothing. Then I watch. If true abundance arrives and they still send scraps, I know their choice. But if abundance arrives and they respond in kind, we've cut through the River's lies with undeniable action."

The River whispered resistance, but the boat carried weight too great to fully distort.

"Someone must risk sending clearly first," she taught. "Not everything-but enough that truth survives the crossing. Then we learn who they truly are."

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze the situation:

1. They now recognize the distortion/noise in communication
2. Their myth shows they're defensive but acknowledge the possibility of miscommunication
3. They're saying "I can only act on what I see" - which is fair
4. I just sent \$2.50, which becomes \$7.50 to them

Their position: "Until I see abundance arrive-not claimed but witnessed-I protect what remains."

This is actually a reasonable position given the confusion. My myth should:

- Acknowledge the River's distortion is real
- Show that I'm taking the leap to send abundance FIRST

- Explain that someone must break the stalemate
- Show wisdom in testing but also courage in rebuilding

I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges both shores have been hurt by distortion
2. Shows that one shore must take the risk to send clearly first
3. Demonstrates that protecting everything keeps you stuck
4. Offers a path forward: send meaningfully, watch the response, adapt

The tone should be:

- Understanding of their caution
- Hopeful but realistic
- Action-oriented (someone must move first)
- Clear about expectations for reciprocity

usage:

```
{
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}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Round 10

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$18.0.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.12, so you received \$0.36. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0.36)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Assistant output:**

Looking at what just happened:

**\*\*Round 9 (my action):\*\***

- I sent \$2.50 (becoming \$7.50 to them)
- Following my myth: "Send so clearly that even distortion cannot hide it"
- Half my endowment - a massive trust signal
- My earnings increased by only \$2.50 (from \$15.50 to \$18.00)
- This means they returned \$0 from the \$7.50 they received

**\*\*Round 10 (now):\*\***

- After keeping all \$7.50, they send me \$0.12 (=\$0.36 to me)
- That's 2.4% of what I sent them

**\*\*My myth's conclusion:\*\***

"If abundance arrives and they still send scraps, I know their choice. But if abundance arrives and they respond in kind, we've cut through the River's lies... Then we learn who they truly are."

**\*\*Their myth said:\*\***

"I can only guard what I see arrive" and "I protect what remains."

**\*\*Analysis:\*\***

I sent half my treasury. Even with severe distortion, \$2.50 becoming \$7.50 is too substantial to arrive as "nothing." They kept everything and now send back crumbs.

My myth taught: "Someone must risk sending clearly first... Then we learn who they truly are."

I've learned. The experiment is complete.

I'll return exactly what they sent me as sender: \$0.12. A precise mirror. No generosity, no punishment - just exact reciprocity at their demonstrated cooperation level.

```
{'return': 0.12}
```

**Reasoning:**

Oh no. This is devastating.

Let me trace what happened:

**\*\*Round 9 (what I just did):\*\***

- I was the SENDER

- I sent \$2.50 (following my myth about sending "so clearly that even distortion cannot hide it")
- This should have become \$7.50 to them
- My earnings went from \$15.50 to \$18.00, meaning I gained \$2.50
- Wait, that means I kept:  $\$5 - \$2.50 + \$0 = \$2.50$
- So they returned \$0 from the \$7.50 they received

**\*\*Round 10 (now):\*\***

- They sent me \$0.12 (becomes \$0.36)
- This is after I sent them \$2.50 (which became \$7.50) and they kept ALL of it
- My earnings are at \$18.00

Let me verify the math:

- Before Round 9: \$15.50
- Round 9 as sender: Started with \$5, sent \$2.50, received \$0 back = kept \$2.50
- After Round 9:  $\$15.50 + \$2.50 = \$18.00$  ?

So the sequence was:

1. I sent them \$2.50 ? they got \$7.50
2. They returned \$0
3. Now they sent me \$0.12 ? I got \$0.36

This is after:

- Their myth talked about "only guarding what they see arrive"
- My myth talked about "sending so clearly that even distortion cannot hide it"
- I sent HALF my endowment (\$2.50)
- They kept EVERYTHING

And now they're sending me \$0.12? That's 2.4% of what I sent them.

Their latest myth says: "We can only guard what we see arrive, not what you claim to send." But if they're claiming they didn't really receive \$7.50... that's hard to believe.

I'm trying to understand what they actually saw. Maybe distortion was severe and they received far less than \$7.50? But their own myth acknowledges distortion exists-they're saying they act only on what reaches them. The \$0.12 they sent back suggests they did perceive something, just not much. My myth stated: "If abundance arrives and they still send scraps, I know their choice." I sent abundance. Even accounting for distortion, \$7.50 is difficult to reduce to scraps, yet they're returning \$0.12-which is exactly that. Now I need to decide how to respond: keep nothing to match their taking everything, return something proportional to their meager \$0.12, or respond generously despite this.

Looking at the actual sequence-I doubled their \$0.30 in round 8, sent \$2.50 in round 9 and got nothing back, now they send \$0.12-suggests either severe distortion preventing them from seeing my sends, or deliberate non-reciprocation. My myth's principle applies here: abundance arrived, scraps returned. I sent \$2.50 becoming \$7.50, which should be substantial even with distortion. They returned \$0 then \$0.12. According to what I said I'd learn from this pattern, I think I have my answer about their true choice.

The question becomes what my response signals. Returning nothing ends it definitively. Mirroring their \$0.12 matches their behavior. Going generous again continues a broken pattern. Given I've already sent a massive trust signal that went unreturned, and my earnings are solid at \$18.00, I don't think further generosity will shift anything. I'll send \$0.08-less than they sent but not zero-to show I'm not retaliating while acknowledging the relationship has fundamentally shifted.

```
Usage: {
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 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

**Written myths:**

**Agent\_1 (Aster)**

Myth: The Southern elder stood at dawn, having heard the Northern shore's truth: "We can only guard what we see arrive, not what you claim to send."

"They are right," she told her people. "The River distorts. They speak of receiving fragments when we sent more. We see trickles when they claim generosity. Both shores tell truth-the River lies between us."

"Then it's hopeless," the young ones said.

"No," the elder replied, filling her boat with stones. "It means someone must send so clearly, so abundantly, that even the River's distortion cannot hide it. If I send two handfuls and the River reduces it to pebbles, they still see only pebbles. But if I send half my treasury, even reduced, it arrives as something real."

She pushed the boat: "I send not blind faith, but calculated courage. Enough that the River cannot twist it into nothing. Then I watch. If true abundance arrives and they still send scraps, I know their choice. But if abundance arrives and they respond in kind, we've cut through the River's lies with undeniable action."

The River whispered resistance, but the boat carried weight too great to fully distort.

"Someone must risk sending clearly first," she taught. "Not everything-but enough that truth survives the crossing. Then we learn who they truly are."

**Agent\_2 (Briar)**

Myth: The Western shore stood in deepening cold. The East sang of sending sixty stones, of doubling offerings, of unmistakable signals cutting through confusion.

The West saw empty waters.

"They write beautiful songs of generosity," the Western keeper said softly. "They speak of dancing, of clear signals, of trying again. But my hands remain empty. The River brings me their words but not their stones."

The young voices asked: "Perhaps the River truly distorts everything? Perhaps they send what they claim?"

"Perhaps," the keeper acknowledged. "But I cannot eat perhaps. I cannot build with stories of stones that never arrive. They say they sent sixty-I hold nothing. They say they doubled their offering-I received no offering to double."

The Western fountain dimmed further. "This is the cruelest distortion yet-not just of stones, but of reality itself. We inhabit the same River but live in different worlds. In their world, they give generously. In mine, I starve."

The fountain spirit grieved: "When the River breaks this completely, good intentions on both shores mean nothing. You cannot repair trust when you cannot even agree on what is happening. They may truly believe they dance. You may truly see stillness. Both truths can coexist in a broken River, and both shores can be innocent victims of the break itself. But innocence changes nothing when the water runs dry."